

*Pass It On—
Our Three Legacies*

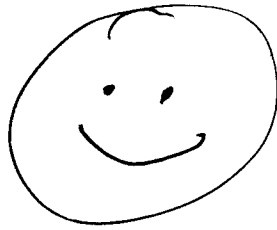
THE FORTY-FIFTH ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS

1995
Final Report

Holiday Inn Crowne Plaza, New York, NY, April 30—May 6, 1995

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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use does not, of course, violate in any way our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



45TH GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

Pass It On—Our Three Legacies

"We shall cry out our greetings to each other with a warmth seldom known anywhere. We shall exchange experiences, confess that our Society has its faults, and ask God to show us how to remove them. We shall ponder the meaning of our . . . exciting history and, in confident faith, we shall accept whatever destiny Providence has in store for us."

Forty years ago, these words were written by A.A. co-founder Bill W. (Grapevine, April 1955) in anticipation of A.A.'s Second International Convention in St. Louis—the Convention

where the Three Legacies were accepted by the Fellowship. When the 45th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous of the United States and Canada met, at New York's Crowne Plaza, April 30-May 6, Bill's words still seemed timely and appropriate, as the theme of the 1995 Conference was "Pass It On—Our Three Legacies."

The 45th Conference was officially opened Sunday morning with the roll call by G.S.O. general manager George Dorsey. Then there were greetings from the delegate chairperson,

Dorothy Neurohr, of North Dakota followed by the keynote address, given by trustee-at-large/Canada David O'Leary (page 6).

Sunday evening Conference members were joined in the ballroom by yet more friends—past trustees and delegates, former staff members and other friends of A.A. and their guests—for the opening dinner. Families and friends of past and current trusted servants were thanked for their anonymous sacrifices and for their patience, tolerance and lost time together. An open A.A. meeting followed, chaired by Charles Matthews (Tennessee). The meeting was led by Karl Lamberg (New Hampshire); speakers were: Gay Garner (Southeast regional trustee); Billie Hobart (Mississippi); Richard Bush (G.S.O. staff); Russ VanDran (Northern Illinois); and Ames Sweet (Grapevine staff).

Chairing this year's Conference were: Jim Estelle, Class A (nonalcoholic) chairman of the board; George Dorsey; John Hartley Smith, M.D., Class A trustee; and Dorothy Neurohr, delegate chairperson. The Conference coordinator was G.S.O. staff member Valerie O'Neill.

Special guest and observer was Trevor Housely, a trustee of the General Service Board of Australia. At the closing brunch Saturday morning Trevor spoke of A.A. in Australia where their 2,000 groups and 10-12,000 members "would fit into one of your areas." Australia's board has six regional trustees, two general trustees and four Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees. There the board is involved with the General Service Office operation, but still has a way to go in working with newcomers, Trevor said. Unlike the 134 members of this Conference, Australia's General Service Conference currently consists of 35 members. Trevor also reported that a commemorative edition of the Big Book—with Australian stories—was being published as part of Australia's 50th A.A. Anniversary.

The busy week consisted of Presentations and Reports (page 13); Area Service Highlights (page 46); a workshop, based on the Conference theme (page 8); and two What's On Your Mind? sharing sessions. And, of course, the meetings of the eleven standing Conference committees that discussed and reviewed their individual agenda items and, beginning Wednesday evening, presented their recommendations and suggestions to the entire Conference. Many of these recommendations became Advisory Actions (page 10).

Wednesday afternoon, regional trustee elections were held. Raul Marin of San Antonio, Texas, will become the new Southwest regional trustee, replacing Ann Bruning. The next trustee from the Northeast region will be MaryJane Roy of Wakefield, Rhode Island, replacing Jake Ham; and trustee-at-large/Canada will be Michel Girard, of Repentigny, Quebec, filling the position now held by Dave O'Leary.

Two new Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees were approved at the board meeting immediately following the Conference: Rev. Robert O. Miller, of Birmingham, Alabama and Arthur L. Knight, Jr., from Lake Forest, Illinois. They will replace rotating Class A trustees John Hartley Smith, M.D. and John E. King.

At the Delegates Only Dinner, Doug Mead, Southern Minnesota, was elected delegate chair for the 1996 Conference; George O'Neil, Northeast Ohio, will be the alternate delegate chairperson.

Even when surrounded by A.A. members, there are times when alcoholics just need a regular A.A. meeting. Thus, Monday through Friday an open meeting was held at 7:30 a.m., chaired by Mike Ward, Idaho, with Will Ruliffson, of Maine, serving as secretary/treasurer. It was always well attended by delegates, staff, sports enthusiasts fresh from their morning jog and a scattering of hotel waiters and personnel who are A.A. members. The G.S.C. Serenity Group is self-supporting and made a contribution of \$394.23 to the General Service Office.

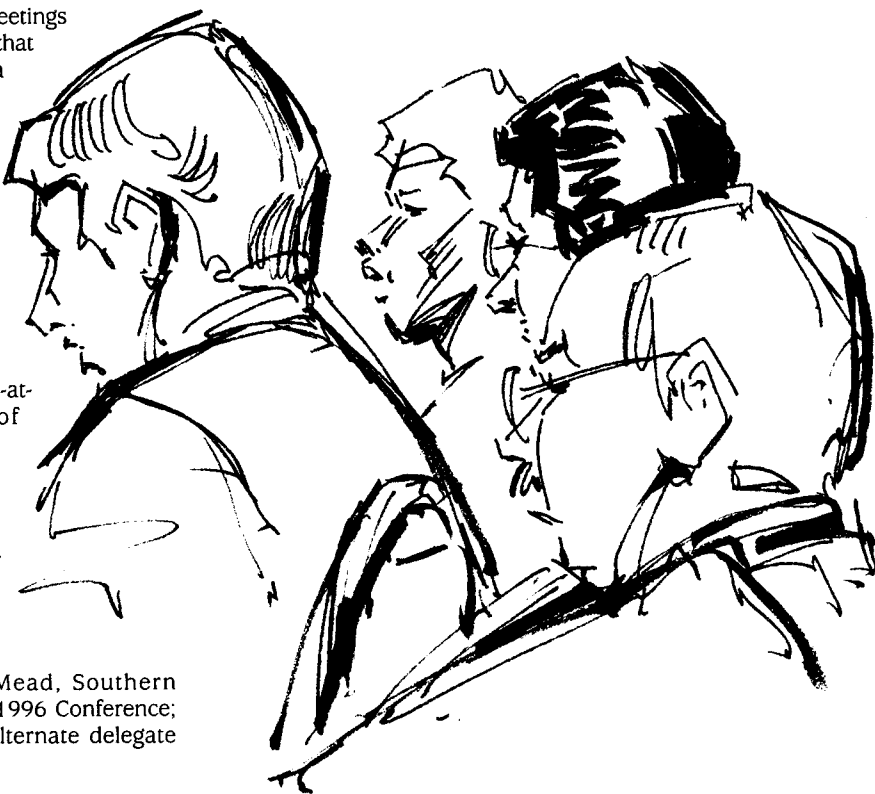
Friday afternoon the 45th A.A. General Service Conference was officially closed with the Serenity Prayer in English, French and Spanish. Saturday morning, Conference members assembled for the last time at the closing brunch, and heard farewell talks by rotating trustees—Ann Bruning, Jake Ham, John King, Dave O'Leary and John Hartley Smith, M.D.

At the closing brunch both George Dorsey and Jim Estelle spoke of the continuity of the Conference. George, who has been present at many Conferences, as delegate, trustee and now general manager, said that as he looked out at the 134 members of the 45th Conference, "I see not just Panel 44 and 45—I see Dr. Jack [Norris] and Milton [Maxwell]; I see past staff members and past delegates." We are part of what they did and also a part of future Conferences, George observed.

In closing, Jim Estelle, chairman of the board, said, in part, "I believe each Conference has the opportunity to develop its own personality, group conscience and priorities. What we have not done or what we have not addressed will be taken care of by the ongoing Conference process in its own good time.

"For 60 years Alcoholics Anonymous has persevered and successfully provided a way of life in which we share the joy of sobriety. Your joy is a very real part of the attraction to others still suffering, and a very necessary part of "passing it on."

"Thank you for letting me share a portion of your journey with you this past week—I was traveling with good navigators."



Greetings from Delegate Chairperson

As I welcome you today I am filled with gratitude for the miracle of sobriety and the opportunity to serve. I was overwhelmed when my name was drawn from the hat to serve as delegate chairperson for the 45th General Service Conference. One of the benefits of serving in this capacity was being invited to attend the board meetings in January, where I observed the importance of our Three Legacies.

Our theme for this Conference is "Pass It On—Our Three Legacies." The first Legacy is Recovery. What does Recovery mean? It is defined as getting back something lost. What have we lost? Trust, love, respect, family and more, as a direct result of our alcoholism.

By applying the Twelve Steps of A.A. to our lives on a daily basis we are able to recover.

When I think about my own recovery I think about willingness and change. My sobriety is enhanced by getting out of self and working with others.

When I think about our Second Legacy, Unity, I think about being combined as one. We have one ultimate authority. We have one primary purpose. "The unity of Alcoholics Anonymous is the most cherished quality our Society has. Our lives, the lives of all to come, depend squarely upon it. . . ." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 129)

Our Third Legacy is Service. We have all been chosen to serve. We know that faith alone does not save us, we need to act, to do something. We need to carry the message, practice A.A. principles in all our affairs or we will slip, wither and die. A.A. groups must also serve their appointed purpose, do something, or wither and fall apart. We as Conference delegates also need to apply this principle to A.A. as a whole. Let us remember that our Traditions are A.A.'s arms of service.

It is written: "The chief inheritance of the first twenty years of Alcoholics Anonymous are the Legacies of Recovery, of Unity, and of Service. By the first we recover from alcoholism; by the second we stay together in unity; and by the third our society functions and serves its primary purpose of carrying the A.A. message to all who need it and want it." (*A.A. Comes of Age*, p. 49) Service is gratitude in action.

We will be faced with many challenges this week. Let us trust the committee system and remember ". . . there is but one ultimate authority—a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience." Let us ask for His strength and courage, and that His will be done during this week. Let us practice patience, tolerance, kindness and love. Let us feel the presence of a Power greater than ourselves as we come together to make decisions that will benefit A.A. as a whole.

Let us, as trusted servants, Pass It On!

Dorothy Neurohr, North Dakota
delegate chairperson

Keynote Address

My name is Dave and I am an alcoholic, and a member of the West End Group, St. John's, Newfoundland, and trustee-at-large/Canada.

Our Three Legacies represent the sum total of the responsibilities passed on to us by our co-founders, Bill W. and Bob S., and other early members. In the wake of his spiritual experience, Bill was gifted with a vision of A.A. Bill writes in *A.A. Comes of Age* (p. 64): "My thoughts began to race as I envisioned a chain reaction among alcoholics, one carrying this message and these principles to the next. More than I could ever want anything else, I now knew that I wanted to work with other alcoholics." Bill's life work had just begun, and he clung to this vision and purpose with a tenacity that persisted all of his remaining days.

A nonalcoholic preacher shared this vision of fellowship as well.

Bernard Smith quoted Canon C.E.

Raven's thoughts on fellowship (*A.A. Comes of Age*, p. 276):

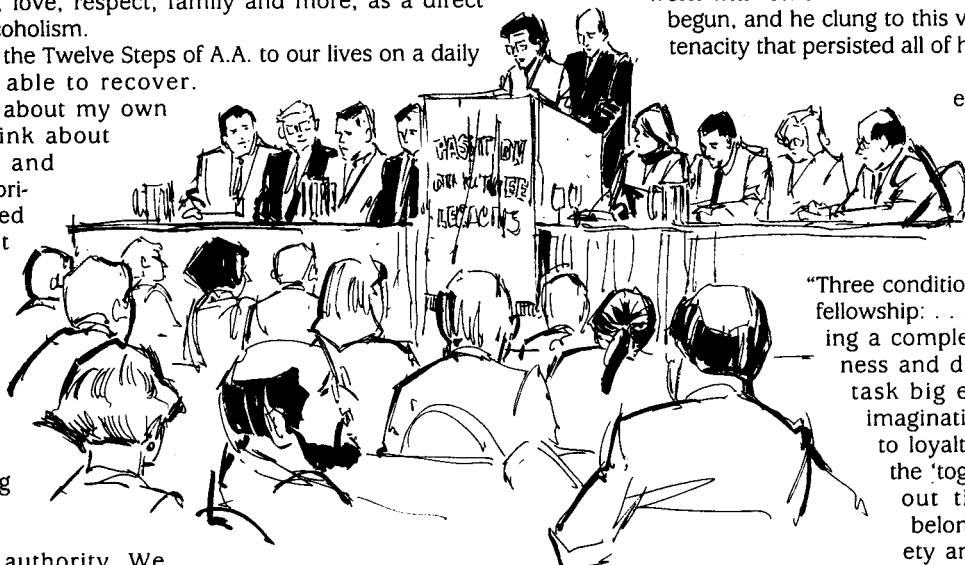
"Three conditions are necessary for true fellowship: . . . a common ideal involving a complete release from selfishness and division. . . . a common task big enough to capture the imagination and give expression to loyalty. . . . the comradeship, the 'togetherness,' . . . as we find out the joy and power of belonging to an organic society and engaging in a whole-time service. We can find [this vision]. . . where the ideal is highest and most exacting, where the task extends and integrates every ounce of our strength and every element of our being, where the comradeship is so solid and deep that we respond one to another without conscious effort, realize the unspoken need, and react to it spontaneously and at once."

Bill used the concept of the Legacies to express our responsibilities to the future of the A.A. Fellowship. Each of us has experienced, in various ways, how the Three Legacies support us as we strive to fulfill A.A.'s primary purpose.

Bernard Smith, speaking at the Fourth General Service Conference, stated, ". . . our Twelve Steps, judged by the socially accepted standard of happiness of this age, are steps backward. . . into the universal heart of man, back into the true spirit of man." (*A.A. Comes of Age*, p. 278)

On a personal note, I could not find sobriety through the Fellowship until I started working the Steps on a continual basis. It was a very slow process for me but, with the help and the understanding of a loving sponsor and my home group, my life slowly began to take shape. One of the key elements in working the Steps was my willingness to change. Changing my attitude and outlook on life was of the utmost importance. Instead of hurting people, particularly those who were close to me, I tried to be a better person.

Looking back to my early days of sobriety, I realize the importance of belonging to a home group. That is where I first learned to become responsible—responsible for opening the meeting room, for being a greeter at the door; responsible for making the coffee or chairing a meeting. That is where I learned to do Twelfth Step work so that I could eventually pass on to others what was so freely given to me, thereby assuring the



very future and survival of the Fellowship. Eventually, by belonging to a home group, I got involved in another level of service. The members of my group put their trust in me and elected me as their G.S.R. to represent them at the district meeting. And yes—they were eager for a report back from me at our group's business meeting. It was at this level of service that I learned the importance of making and keeping a commitment. From that time on I was literally hooked on service. I would also like to think that, because of my involvement over the years, sobriety has been easier to maintain, being ever mindful not to become complacent.

Service is a gift from our Higher Power, and a privilege available to all A.A. members. However, not everyone will make use of this gift and privilege, and others will not want to assume service responsibilities. The future of A.A. depends on our ability to keep carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. In order to do that we try to follow a program of solid recovery, we try to keep our Fellowship united and keep ourselves focussed on our primary objective. Someday, all of us who are now serving will be rotated; therefore, it is our responsibility to sponsor younger members into service.

When I attend service functions I hear expressions such as "Let the minority speak," "Right of decision," "Right of participation." Inwardly I smile, because it lets me know that the members are familiar with our Twelve Concepts and our Third Legacy.

"The Traditions guarantee the equality of all members and the independence of all groups. They show how we may best relate ourselves to each other and to the world outside. They indicate how we can best function in harmony as a great whole. For the sake of the welfare of our entire society, the Traditions ask that every individual and every group and every area in A.A. shall lay aside all desires, ambitions, and untoward actions that could bring serious division among us or lose for us the confidence of the world at large.

"The Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous symbolize the sacrificial character of our life together and they are the greatest force for unity that we know." (*A.A. Comes of Age*, p. 96-97)

"The unity of Alcoholics Anonymous is the most cherished quality our Society has. Our lives, the lives of all to come, depend squarely upon it. . . . Without unity, the heart of A.A. would cease to beat; our world arteries would no longer carry the life-giving grace of God. . . ." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 129)

Having served as a trustee on the General Service Board for four years, I would like to say that it has been a most enjoyable and rewarding experience. During those four years I have met thousands of recovering alcoholics—at conventions, assemblies, Regional Forums, conferences and service weekends. I have made many friends throughout my travels. And over the years I have heard the expression "we and them." I would like to remind everyone here that we are in this Fellowship together, with one primary purpose—to carry our message to alcoholics who still suffer.

Questions have been raised about some actions taken by our General Service Board. We will address these issues this week, and I ask you to keep in your prayers a resolution that will restore unity. I would also like to stress the importance of principles before personalities. At this time let us simply remember our Declaration of Unity: "This we owe to A.A.'s future; To place our common welfare first; To keep our fellowship united. For on A.A. unity depend our lives, And the lives of those to come."

Our Traditions ask that we strive to settle our differences and relearn to trust each other. We know in our heart of hearts that our love for A.A.—individually and collectively—is pure in spirit.

All Conference members are equal and the Conference process favors no one member over another. We continue to study our past and avail ourselves of the tried and proven principles and relationships outlined in our Steps, Traditions, Charter, By-laws, Concepts and Warranties.

As a trustee-at-large I have had the opportunity to attend two World Service Meetings, which are similar to our General Service Conference, one here in New York City, and one in Cartagena, Colombia. I heard wonderful presentations, sat in on committee meetings, attended workshops and participated in sharing sessions with A.A. members from around the world. As a result, I came to realize that most countries share common problems: delegates report about the frustration of getting and keeping A.A. members involved in service; most offices depend on income from literature sales to support group services; and, in general, only 45-50% of groups make contributions to their general service offices.

Many times members of our board and/or staff are invited to attend conferences in other countries and to pass on our experience with incorporating our Three Legacies in all aspects of our Fellowship. Over these past few years, I have also had the rewarding joy of traveling to foreign countries to share my personal experience as a trustee on our General Service Board. These trips have made me an even more grateful trusted servant because I have come to realize that everything was in place for me when I arrived at this level of service. The people before me had continued our co-founders' vision. Bill W., speaking at our first General Service Conference, said, "To serve A.A. is to live, we gladly accept our Third Legacy of service and may we guard it well, use it wisely. God grant that the legacy of service remains ever safe in our keeping."

On our trip to Russia, Larry N., John G. and I had the opportunity to attend A.A. meetings, which are very similar to ours. We also attended their conference and had a long and interesting meeting with their board of trustees. Their service structure is very new and they had many questions. Although they have limited experience, they are committed to our Three Legacies and to sharing our message of strength and hope with the still-suffering alcoholic.

I also visited Cuba with Danny M. and trustees from Mexico. I will never forget my two trips to Cuba. A.A. is growing there by leaps and bounds. It is a very exciting time, but as the history of A.A. in U.S./Canada bears out, with newness come problems. As A.A. grows throughout the world, our experience returns again and again to the importance of the Traditions.

On both trips to Cuba we met many professionals—doctors, psychiatrists, nurses and others in the field of alcoholism. Their support, understanding and cooperation were unbelievable. Most hospitals and clinics we visited offered rooms for meetings. On both trips we spent a lot of time with board members, discussing the Traditions and Concepts.

As a result of the privilege of serving as your trustee, I have personally seen A.A. growing throughout the world from the seeds of our Three Legacies—Recovery, Unity and Service. I have been transported from A.A. meeting to A.A. meeting, from country to country, from conference to conference, and no matter what language I was listening to, I heard the single voice of Alcoholics Anonymous. I am truly humbled by the simple message that has helped me not to drink today.

I would like to wish everyone a good Conference week and ask that we remember: "Pass It On—Our Three Legacies" is not just our theme; it is our challenge, our hope and our responsibility.

David O'Leary, trustee-at-large/Canada

Workshop: Pass It On —Our Three Legacies

Wednesday afternoon Conference members split up into groups of 12 to 14 for a workshop discussion based on the Conference theme. Following are the workshop questions and a summary of the report backs.

1 How do A.A.s in your area define our basic message?

a) To the newcomer?

As in the past, there is a continued practice among groups to reach out to newcomers with Beginners' Packets containing meeting lists, literature, and in some cases, telephone numbers of members, as well as having greeters who keep an eye out for new members. However, many have been asking whether "our message was clear" and whether it was being effectively delivered. There is an ongoing, widespread emphasis on temporary sponsorship, along with helping newcomers get to meetings, and particularly Beginners' Meetings and Big Book or First Step meetings, if these are held regularly. Some groups report on the rich benefits to newcomers of mixing old and newer members, so that newcomers can see "how we work the Twelve Steps in the experience of our daily lives." While some report a concern over the number of "slippers" in their midst and whether "we should be less tolerant of the person who repeatedly enters and leaves," there was a consensus that patience, compassion and tolerance are still the groups' best combined attitude toward the newcomer. In addition to the above, said one member, experience has shown that an awareness of the Traditions is essential to the maintenance of a group's sobriety, along with the use of The Guide to Beginners Meetings, to effectively carry the message to newcomers.

b) At "open" and "closed" meetings?

There has been an increase in closed meetings, "for the purpose of getting back to basics and away from non-A.A. 'babble,'" as well as a greater number of groups taking personal responsibility for seeing that "newly-released institutionalized people are taken to meetings." The Primary Purpose Statement appears to be read at more and more meetings, whether open or closed, and efforts are being made to deliver the same message at all types of meetings. Some groups hold a group conscience vote to decide whether to turn a closed meeting into an open one for the purpose of carrying the message more clearly. All in all, the message is best carried, members agreed, through recovery, service, sponsorship and frequent reading of the literature, particularly the Big Book.

2 How is literature used to pass on our legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service?

a) One to one

There's no substitute for the beneficial effects on newcomers of one to one communication, closely tied to the regular dissemination of literature. The latter most often takes the form of newcomer packets (including literature, meeting lists and telephone numbers of A.A.s), and sponsors everywhere are increasingly directing their sponsees to A.A. literature, particularly the Big Book and *Living Sober*.

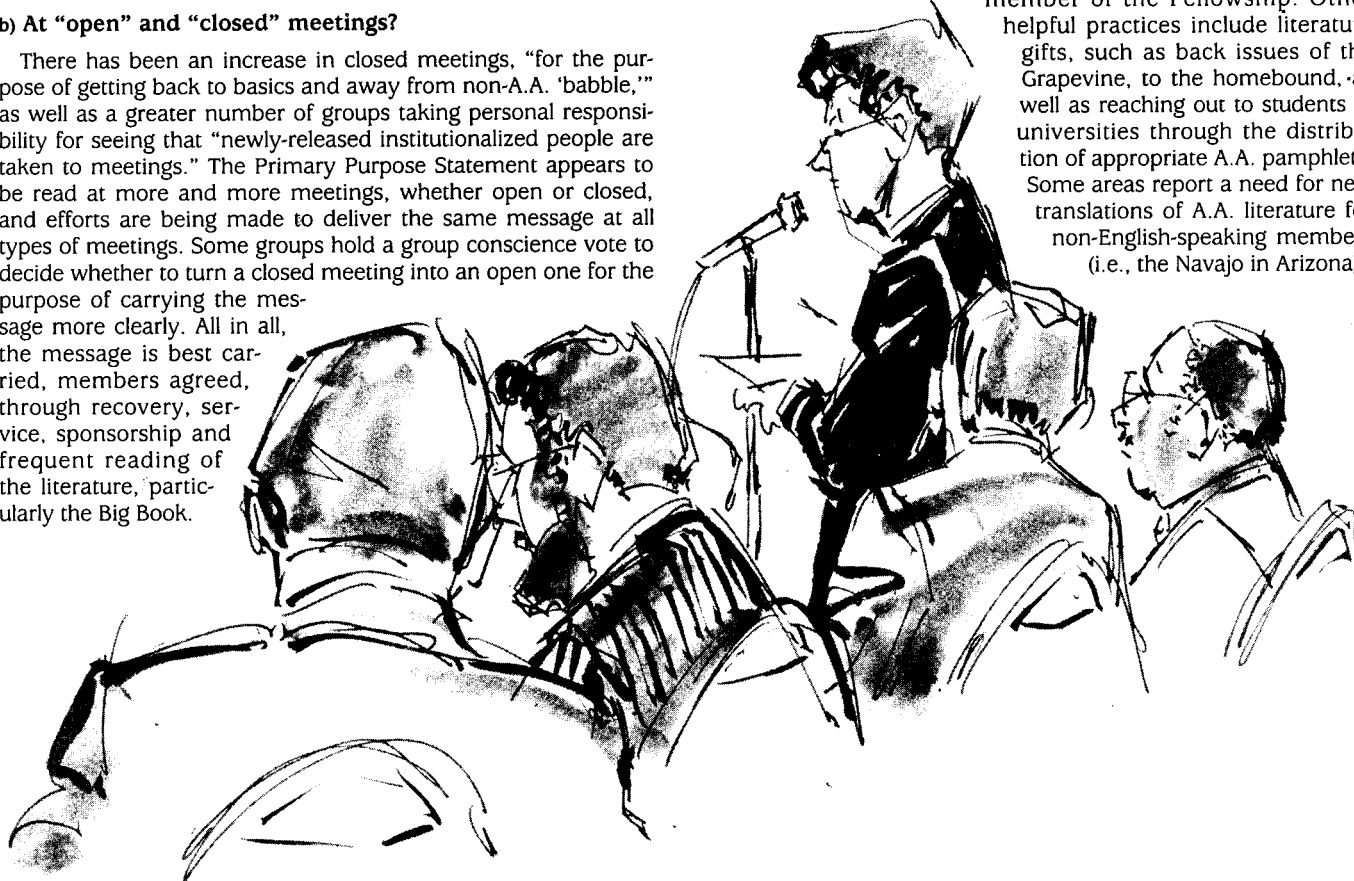
b) In the group

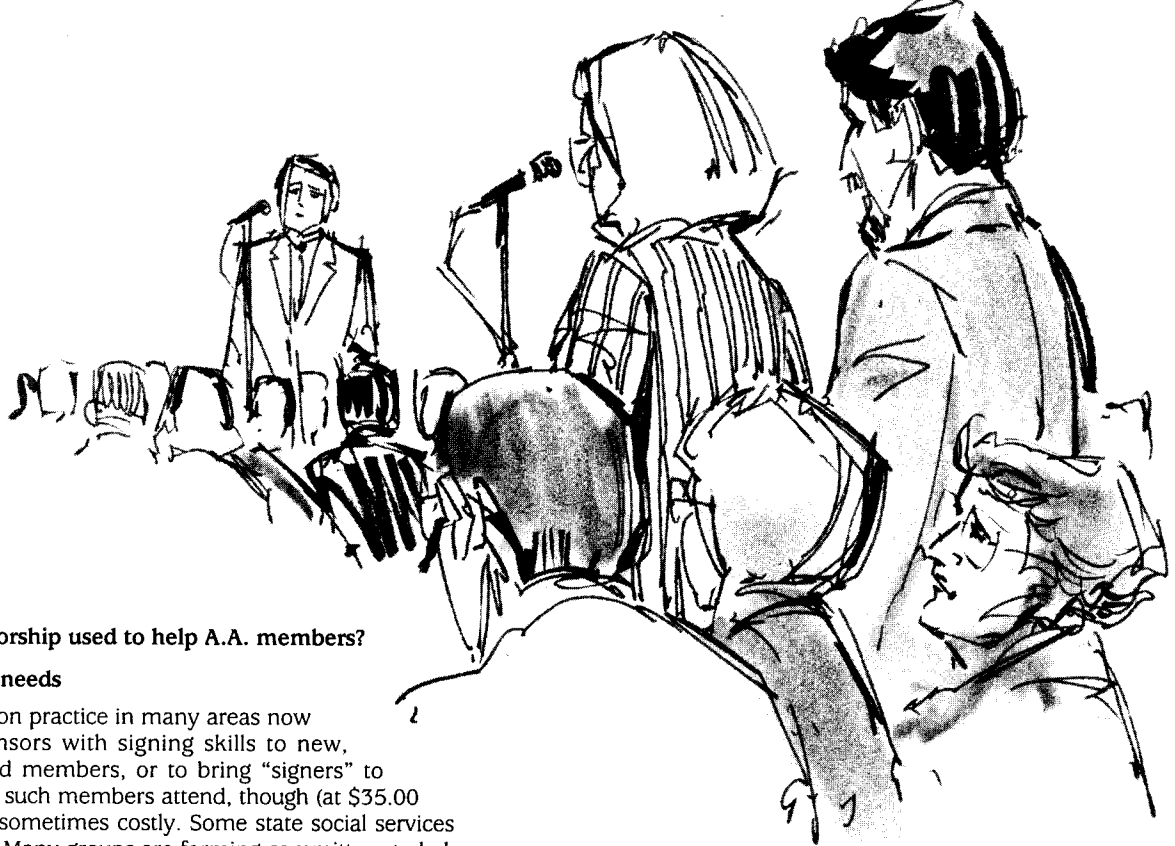
Many home groups report concerted efforts to make more Conference-approved literature available on their display racks. Others often ask their members to bring copies of the Big Book to every meeting; using the Big Book for discussion topics helps to "focus on and clarify our message."

Literature alone does not take the place of communication and sponsorship; all three work together in passing it on. "People get lost in crowds," said one member. "Every A.A. should be a sponsor, our Three Legacies have to reach everyone!" And all groups can profit from the regular practice of group inventories.

c) Through reaching out beyond the group

Pamphlets and other pertinent A.A. literature are being distributed regularly in a variety of public places, from doctors' offices, to public libraries, to treatment facilities and prisons. It's important to insure, members related, that the literature be prominently displayed. It seems to help, too, to deliver the literature personally; "warm bodies humanize the process," one member reported. For example, professionals are more likely to refer clients to A.A. if they have had a personal contact with a member of the Fellowship. Other helpful practices include literature gifts, such as back issues of the Grapevine, to the homebound, as well as reaching out to students in universities through the distribution of appropriate A.A. pamphlets. Some areas report a need for new translations of A.A. literature for non-English-speaking members (i.e., the Navajo in Arizona).





3 How is sponsorship used to help A.A. members?

a) With special needs

It is a common practice in many areas now to provide sponsors with signing skills to new, hearing-impaired members, or to bring "signers" to meetings where such members attend, though (at \$35.00 an hour) this is sometimes costly. Some state social services provide signers. Many groups are forming committees to help or sponsor persons with special needs, whatever those needs are, such as posting lists of meetings with handicapped access, providing baby-sitting for new moms, scheduling more meetings in areas where seniors are known to reside, and providing transportation services when needed.

Whatever the need, "the message should be shared through sponsorship." One worthy challenge: Sponsor individual A.A. members into working within the service structure. But finally, sobriety is a shared experience, stated one member, "one drunk talking to another, witnessing another individual as he or she identifies with the member's experiences." All of us can inspire and be inspired. Love and kindness must be present, as well.

b) In correctional facilities

Inmates in correctional facilities, in addition to attending scheduled meetings when these are offered, are being reached through correspondence with members outside the walls, and many areas are encouraging their members to engage in this type of service, as well as suggesting to groups that they "adopt an inmate." When doing prison service, stated one member, it's important to "stress the need for A.A. stories in prison discussion meetings, and to follow the general format of A.A. meetings—not the facility's idea of its own rules."

c) In treatment facilities

Bridging the Gap at both correctional and treatment facilities continues to be one of A.A.'s most valued tools to reach recently-released new members, as well as providing temporary sponsors for those who want them. Chairing meetings at treatment facilities provides a continuing channel in passing on our basic message.

4 How well are we looking after our Third Legacy of Service?

a) One to one

Sponsorship into service is a key element in keeping alive the Fellowship's Third Legacy, along with an understanding of the importance of the one to one connection. It is important to remember, too, that "by introducing newcomers to service, we have helped induce enthusiasm, so that more and more people are willing to get involved," stated one member. Or, as said by another delegate: "Get them there and they will serve." As in so many areas of A.A. service, another member shared, "attraction rather than promotion counts for a great deal...and why not try offering a free lunch at a workshop if a member brings along a newcomer?"

b) In the group

Groups pass the message on by assuming group responsibility for Twelfth Step work, and other group functions, such as scheduling periodic discussions of the importance of service.

c) Through A.A. as a whole

Although the consensus appeared to be that the focus on this issue in different areas ranged from "poor to excellent," overall the Fellowship's membership as a whole should remember that "communication is the language of A.A.," one delegate shared. "We should focus on the Traditions of self-support, anonymity and singleness of purpose. Where we often fail is in not explaining our principles. Recovery is a 'spiritual awakening,' a brand new way of life . . . and our responsibility is to let people know what A.A. has to offer as described in Chapter Five of the Big Book."

David O'Leary spoke of his most vivid memory as trustee-at-large/Canada: "Our Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions written, in pencil, on a piece of cardboard in an A.A. meeting room in Cuba."

Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole, or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 1995 Conference.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 1 The theme for the 1996 General Service Conference be: "Preserving Our Fellowship—Our Challenge."
- 2 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1996 General Service Conference:
 - a) Preserving Our Fellowship—Let It Begin With Me
 - b) Preserving Our Fellowship—Carrying Our Original Message
 - c) Preserving Our Fellowship—Unity and Spirituality in All Our Affairs
- 3 The following be the workshop topic for the 1996 General Service Conference: Preserving Our Fellowship—Our Challenge:
 - a) Through Your Home Group
 - b) Through Your District
 - c) Through Your Conference Area

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

- 4 The soft-cover C.P.C. Workbook be made available as a single item, as well as in a simple binder labeled "C.P.C. Kit" containing related items suggested by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

No recommendations.

FINANCE

It was recommended that:

5 The draft of the pamphlet, "Self-Support—Where Money and Spirituality Mix," which satisfies the 1993 and 1994 Conference Advisory Actions (to prepare a new self-support pamphlet stressing the spirit of the Seventh Tradition, Bill's vision of self-support, a brief history of A.A. finances, the G.S.R.s' responsibility concerning the financial needs within the service structure, visual aids and a description of the various services provided throughout the structure, the long form of the Seventh Tradition and a definition of Prudent Reserve), be accepted with editorial changes placing emphasis on the informed group conscience and on page 13, for contributions to A.A. service entities contact your district committee, area committee, local intergroup/central office.

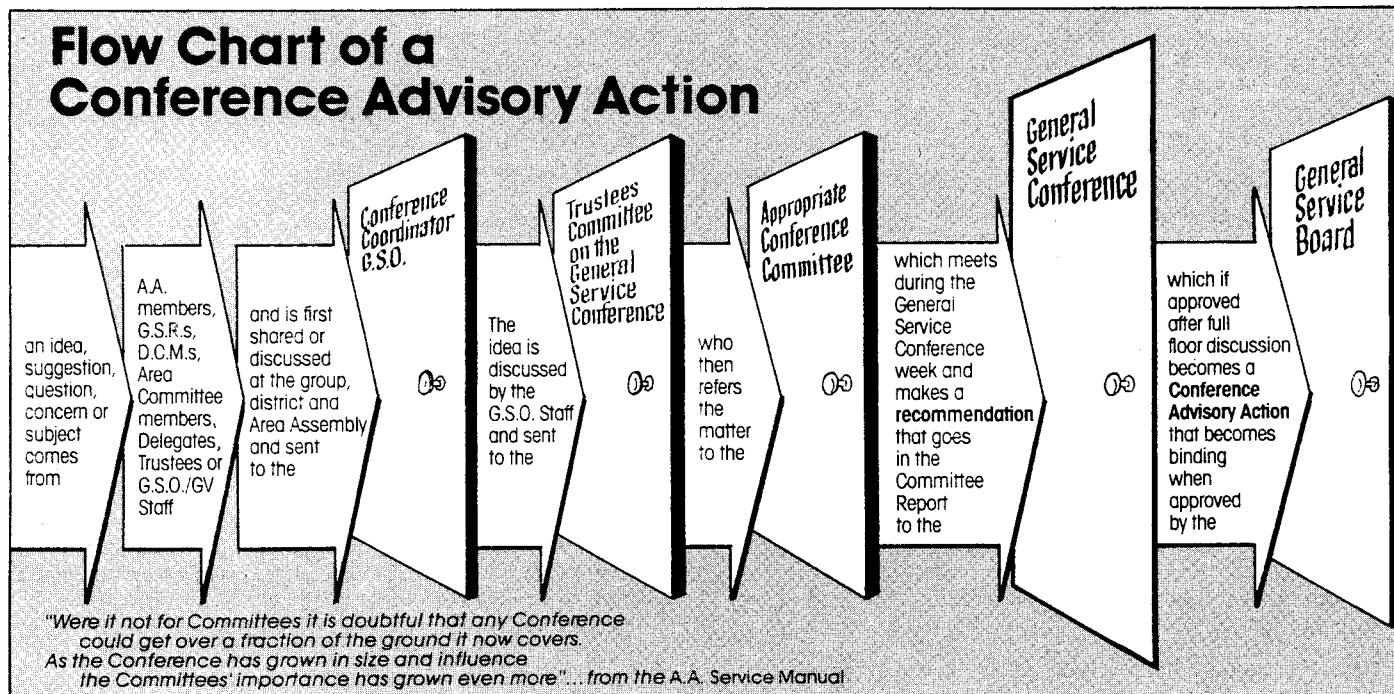
6 A heading, "Suggested Plans For Group Contributions Toward All A.A. Services," be included on page 14 (currently blank) of the draft, "Self-Support—Where Money and Spirituality Mix." The following five *suggested* contribution plans that would appear on page 14 (currently blank) will utilize pie charts and percentages to depict examples of contributions to various A.A. service entities to help arrive at a group conscience:

Example #1:
15% to district
15% to area committee
30% to G.S.O.
40% to intergroup/central office

Or
Example #2
20% to area committee
30% to G.S.O.
50% to intergroup/central office

Or
Example #3
25% to district
25% to area committee
25% to G.S.O.
25% to intergroup/central office

Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action



If you have no intergroup/central office, *suggested* contributions might be:

Example #4:
50% to area committee
50% to G.S.O.

Or

Example #5:
40% to district
30% to area committee
30% to G.S.O.

Or

Whatever percentages are in accordance with your group conscience.

In addition, the Conference Finance Committee requests that each delegate advise G.S.O. on how funds are allocated by the groups in their area and return input to the 1996 Conference Finance Committee.

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

7 Based on an expressed need, a Spanish edition of the Grapevine be produced, contingent on the following: that the Grapevine Corporate Board proceed to gather information and develop a business plan for a bimonthly Spanish edition of the Grapevine, for presentation to the trustees' Finance Committee, and that funding for up to five (5) years be obtained from the General Service Board Reserve Fund, with start-up costs estimated at \$84,000 for the first year. It was further recommended that if a Spanish edition is established, the monthly Spanish articles be removed from the English-language Grapevine, and that if, after five (5) years, the Spanish edition of the magazine is determined to be no longer feasible, publication be discontinued.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

No recommendations.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

8 Minor changes in the text of Tradition Three in the "Twelve Traditions Illustrated" pamphlet be implemented after the current inventory is depleted.

9 Changes in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be implemented after the current inventory is depleted.

10 The following paragraph referring to Concept One that was deleted from "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be reinstated:

"The A.A. Group—the final voice of the Fellowship. Alcoholics Anonymous has been called an upside-down organization because 'The ultimate responsibility and final authority for World Services resides with the groups—rather than with the trustees of the General Service Board or the General Service Office in New York.'" ("The Twelve Concepts Illustrated" pamphlet)

11 The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, "The Doctor's Opinion," "Doctor Bob's Nightmare" and the Appendices remain as is.

12 A pocket edition of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* be published.

13 A video on ways that G.S.O. serves the Fellowship be developed, with accompanying service pamphlet.

Note: The committee strongly encouraged the video to include the service structure in some way, similar to the video "Circles of Love and Service," which has been discontinued.

The Cost: Current estimates for a 14-minute live action video with voice-over would cost between \$30,000 - \$60,000. The accompanying pamphlet would cost about \$6,000.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

14 The alternate delegate from Area 81, New Brunswick/PEI, Rikki Schock, be seated as a Conference member in place of the delegate, Ray Steeves, who is unable to attend.

15 The alternate delegate from Area 82, Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador, Charles (Sonny) Sampson, be seated as a Conference member in place of the delegate, Bert Gillis, who is unable to attend.

16 Trevor Housley, General Service trustee from Australia, be granted permission to attend the 1995 General Service Conference as an observer.

17 The 48th General Service Conference be held April 19-25, 1998, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

18 The Conference Committee on International Conventions continue to meet on an annual basis, discussing Regional Forums when there are no International Convention items; and that the committee be renamed Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

19 Simultaneous translation be made available at future General Service Conferences. The Conference member requiring translation will submit a request as soon as possible, but no later than January 1st of the Conference year. Estimated costs: \$16,000 per language.

20 Since the Washington Area (Area 72) has met the conditions for admission, a second delegate be admitted from Washington Area (Area 72). Further, the committee will continue to accept applications for seating new delegates; however, it will not act on those applications until after the Conference has considered how it will handle future growth and its effect on A.A. as a whole, or until January 1, 1999.

21 Since no Conference is binding on the next, each Conference will determine by a sense of the meeting as part of its "housekeeping" chores whether or not that annual meeting of the Conference will be smoking or non-smoking.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

22 The Anonymity Statement Card, revised to include anonymity reminders regarding videotaping and full names on audiotapes, be approved.

23 The revised and reformatted Membership Survey Questionnaire developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee in preparation for a 1996 Membership Survey be approved with the addition of the following new categories/questions:

- race
- are you physically disabled?
- marital status



The committee further recommended that the question on previous questionnaires "Does your doctor know that you are in A.A.?"

be reinstated, because this is important information not implied in the other questions.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

24 After reviewing Chapter V of *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition):

a) The word "trip" be deleted from the first sentence in the second paragraph under item 2 on page S68.

b) The following sentence be added to the last paragraph on page S72: "Many area committee treasuries recognize the need for supporting the alternate's expenses separately from the delegate's."

25 After considering the suggestion to make stronger recommendations for the financial support of the G.S.R., D.C.M., and other people elected to serve our Fellowship in Chapters II and III in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition):

a) The last sentence in the last paragraph on page S44, "Experience is now indicating that many groups are now finan-

cially supporting their general service representatives to attend service functions," appear as a separate paragraph.

b) The last sentence on page S54 in the second paragraph under "What Does The D.C.M. Do?" appear as a separate paragraph, with a second sentence added, as follows: "Experience is now indicating that many districts are now financially supporting their district committee members to attend service functions. Invariably this pays off in increased activity, interest and group participation."

TREATMENT FACILITIES

No recommendations.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

26 The slate of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in May 1995 (see page 37: the Conference and board approved the slate approved by the trustees' nominating committee.

27 The slate of directors be elected to the A.A. World Services Corporate Board (see page 37; slate of directors approved.)

28 The slate of directors be elected to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board (see page 37; slate of directors approved.)

29 After a thorough examination of the issues and information available and acknowledging that there may have been problems with communication at many service levels in the past, it was the sense of the committee that there has been improvement and, therefore, in the interest of maintaining A.A. unity and finding there was not sufficient cause, the committee unanimously *recommended* that the proposal to censure the General Service Board be dismissed.

A group of A.A. and Al-Anon volunteers provided activities for spouses and friends who had accompanied delegates to New York. Throughout the week there were visits to N.Y. points of interest, theatre and shopping.

Saturday afternoon, Marco Roman (California, San Diego/Imperial) and Jim Shannon (past Northeast regional trustee and New Yorker) took a large group on an "A.A. tour." Sites visited included Towns Hospital; the Excelsior Hotel (home of Dr. Silkworth); Calvary Church (where Bill W. met with the Oxford Group and Rev. Sam Shoemaker was pastor); G.S.O.'s former offices; Bill and Lois' home at 182 Clinton St., and more.

Presentations and Reports

PASS IT ON— OUR THREE LEGACIES

The first presentations of the week were based on the Conference theme, Pass It On—Our Three Legacies. The Monday afternoon session was moderated by Charles Williams, delegate from Kentucky.

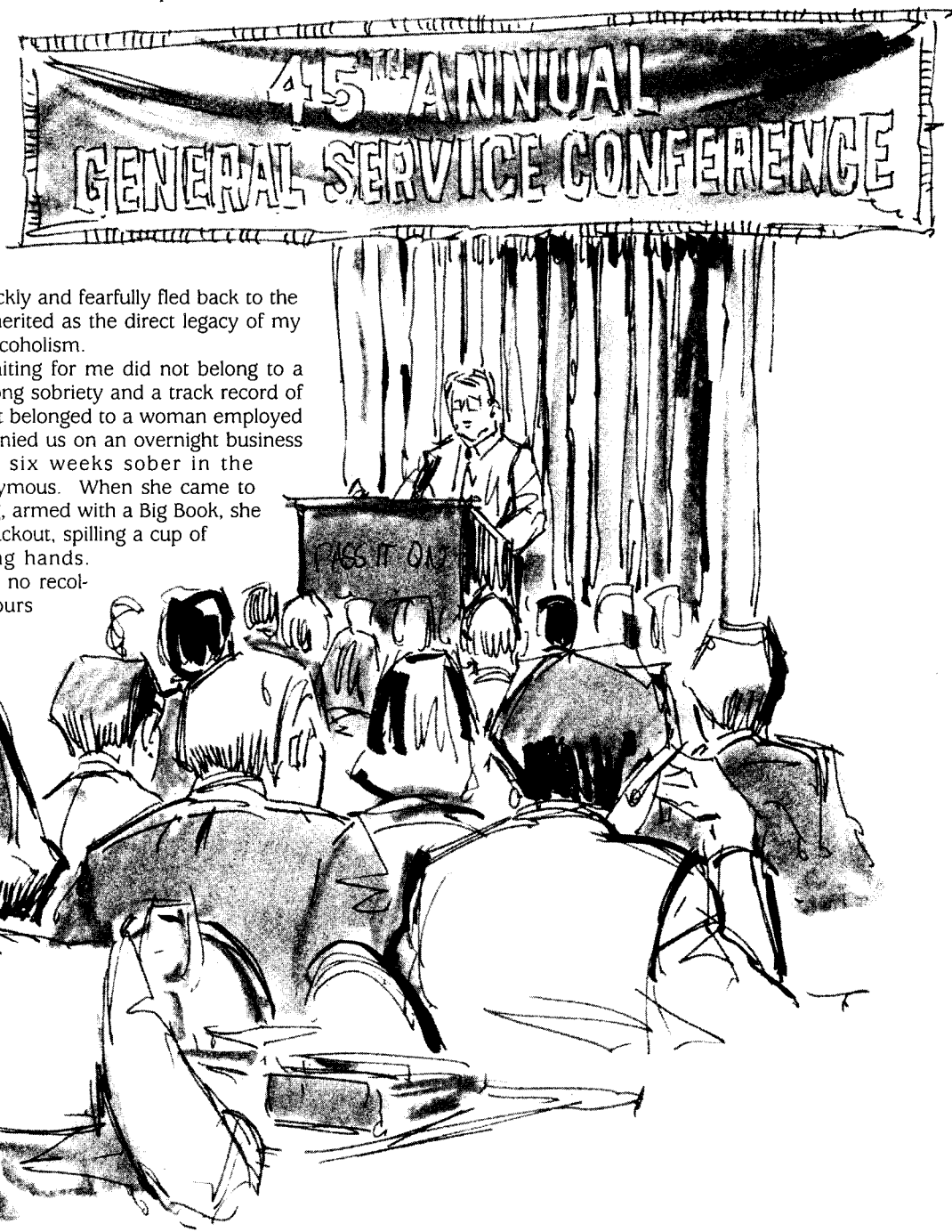
Pass It On: Recovery — Our First Legacy

I reached out for help on a snowy morning in Denver on February 21, 1980, and the hand of A.A. was there. I had no idea that I had commenced upon a lifesaving journey that was to lead to my release from the obsession and compulsion to drink alcohol; a journey that would bring me to a "fellowship, a friendliness, and an understanding which is indescribably wonderful." The fact that I was oblivious to the beginning of this miraculous process is, no doubt, providential in itself, for had I been even dimly aware of the magnitude of the gift of grace that was being offered to me, I surely would have quickly and fearfully fled back to the dark but familiar hell I had inherited as the direct legacy of my 24-year progression of active alcoholism.

The hand that A.A. had waiting for me did not belong to a well-seasoned oldtimer, with long sobriety and a track record of successful Twelfth Step work. It belonged to a woman employed by my wife who had accompanied us on an overnight business trip, and who was exactly six weeks sober in the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous. When she came to our room on that cold morning, armed with a Big Book, she found me emerging from a blackout, spilling a cup of coffee held with two shaking hands. Even though I have absolutely no recollection of the eight or ten hours preceding her arrival, I do have an almost crystal clear memory of the rest of that day.

For the next 12 hours or so, she carried to me the A.A. message of recovery from the debilitating illness of alcoholism. As new as she was, she was also completely able and willing to share the experience, strength and hope that she had gained from about thirty meetings of her home A.A. group, daily conversations with her sponsor, and the recovery that had come to her as the result of taking the first five Steps that are "suggested as a program of recovery."

At her urging, I found myself going with her to that A.A. group, buying a Big Book, asking a guy to be my sponsor, and reluctantly agreeing to let him start leading me through the Twelve Steps. I quit doing most of the things that I thought were absolutely necessary for me to have any happiness in life, and started doing things that I had never in my worst nightmares dreamed that I would do. I ended up about three months later



walking out of a local hospital after an all-night session trying to help a very sick drunk get through the D.T.s, and found myself weeping tears of joy as I watched the sunrise. I was overwhelmed with the awareness that a Power greater than myself was doing for me what I could never do for myself, and that for the first time in my life, I truly knew the meaning of happiness. After 41 years of searching, I had begun to "know what it means to give of yourself that others may survive and rediscover life." I'm still going back to that same group, still reading the same literature, still taking the same Steps that bring me to trust God and clean house, and still (most of the time) following my sponsor's guidance. I'm still trying to avail myself of the opportunities that A.A. gives me to help others. And I am so very grateful to still be sober by the Grace of a Higher Power I came to understand because of Alcoholics Anonymous.

How incredibly lucky I am that the hand of A.A. that was there for me was a hand that was filled with full measure of our great First Legacy—Recovery. But I know it wasn't just luck; it was because my newcomer had come from an A.A. group that stressed the importance of attending meetings, getting and using a sponsor, taking the Steps, studying the Big Book and our other recovery literature, and that had a regularly scheduled meeting devoted exclusively to the study of our Traditions. A group that emphasized, over and over again (and still does), that though our primary purpose is to stay sober and to carry the A.A. message to the suffering alcoholic, we find it virtually impossible for most of us to maintain continuous recovery on our own; that Unity—our Second Legacy—is essential so that we can stay recovered, else we would not have a First Legacy to pass on. And finally, a group that taught that Service, our Third Legacy, derived from Step Twelve of our program of recovery, is essential if we are to attain any real measure of success in passing on our First Legacy to the countless thousands of fellow sufferers.

When I realize that after 15 years I'm just beginning to understand what that newcomer was able to pass on to me that morning in Denver, I cannot believe there is any humanly possible way she could have grasped in just six brief weeks sufficient knowledge of our program of recovery to have carried such a powerful message. Then I begin to understand the great truth of our First Legacy; that in actual and absolute fact there is no humanly possible way that I or any other alcoholic can recover from "this seeming hopeless state of mind and body." I am only sober, and our Fellowship only exists, by the Grace of God, and only for so long as He may have need of us.

Don Popejoy, Kansas

Pass It On: Unity — Our Second Legacy

"Rarely have we seen a person fail who has thoroughly followed our path...." We know this introduces the Twelve Steps of Recovery; however, I feel very comfortable extending that path to the Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts. I find that when our home group moves along with the Traditions and seeks understanding of them, we function much better. We then have something others want. We are leading by attraction, not promotion.

I remember my first district meeting as an alternate G.S.R. Someone insisted that the Traditions be read in long form. I didn't know there was a long form. Those who did know didn't seem to be thrilled at the prospect of this reading. I didn't hear much beyond the first: "...Hence our common welfare comes first. But individual welfare follows close afterward." There it was, the answer to the unrest I had been feeling. My sponsor

had told me that when asked to help I was to say Yes. However, I was also hearing, "This is a selfish program. My sobriety comes first. I have to take care of me." I had not understood the short form of this Tradition until I seriously thought about the long form. Together they made sense. I had been given the direction I needed in service and in my personal recovery.

You told me I did not have to achieve sobriety alone. That thought was so comforting. Maybe, if I didn't have to feel so alone, I just might make it with you. Not being alone had its physical, emotional and spiritual components. I had to be in the presence of other alcoholics. I had to see them, feel them, hear them. My thinking had to change about me and my world. I had to open my mind, heart and spirit in order to receive the gift of sobriety you so willingly offered me. I was taught to love, trust and believe in you. Through you I was gently led to a God I could understand. I found some of what I needed in the Big Book and the pamphlets, but the essence of A.A. I found in the meetings. They were the sum of the efforts of thousands of groups who believe in the First Tradition, "Our common welfare should come first; personal recovery depends upon A.A. unity."

I once went to a meeting two thousand miles from home. I went with an addled mind, breaking heart, and faltering spirit. No one asked if I belonged there. I belonged if I knew I belonged. They understood my need to be there but knew nothing about me. A man two seats to my right shared so openly and with such caring that I realized later, I had had one of those remarkable spiritual experiences. I no longer had to struggle to understand all that was happening in my life. I didn't have to deny I hurt, but just believe, "this, too, will pass" and one day I would feel better. I didn't have to be angry with God; I could feel comforted in the knowledge that I was loved by God and you loved me.

This small group knew how to carry the message to a suffering alcoholic—someone had carried the message to the Grand Mesa in Colorado. From then to now took effort, time, money, faith and a belief that "Our common welfare should come first...." That group is one with my home group and with A.A. as a whole.

I stand before you amazed that my area has given me this great gift of service as a delegate. I am a mere toddler on this path. I need your hands to keep me upright. I need fixed guideposts to lean against when I tire. So few of us have shared in this service in the entire history of A.A. Yet that same history has shown us that no matter how difficult our deliberations may seem to be, we will do well. The Traditions and Concepts are our guideposts to use as wisely as our forebearers did. God, as we understand God, will lead us to the unity that keeps us whole. "Rarely have we seen a person fail who has thoroughly followed our path."

Jeanne Mattis, New York, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire

Pass It On: Service — Our Third Legacy

"A.A.'s Twelfth Step, carrying the message, is the basic service that our fellowship gives; it is our principal aim and the main reason for our existence. A.A. is more than a set of principles; it is a society of recovered alcoholics in action. We *must* carry A.A.'s message; otherwise we ourselves may fall into decay and those who have not yet been given the truth may die. This is why we so often say that *action* is the magic word. Action to carry A.A.'s message is therefore the heart of our Third Legacy of Service." (*A.A. Comes of Age*, pp. 139-40)

I have been given a great gift, the gift of a happy and joyous

life. The gift of opportunity and ability to serve, to help others when before I was of no help. Some say they don't want or need the service part of our program. For me it is vital. Working in service helped me realize my own defects of character, whether pointed out by others or discovered by myself. I found that I was surrounded by members who were genuinely interested not only in A.A.'s well-being, but also in my well-being. In this atmosphere of love and acceptance I could only grow in my recovery.

Today, I believe it is my responsibility to encourage members to become active in Alcoholics Anonymous. They are the future guardians of our Three Legacies and our future leaders. As a newcomer in service, I was suspicious and trusted very little. I felt intimidated by those at the front of the room. I didn't know what they were talking about and was afraid to ask questions. I must remember that new members may feel the very same way. Now, I encourage people to ask questions and try to make them feel comfortable in doing so. I let them know I felt unsure when I started out and that they will learn if they give themselves a chance by drawing strength and guidance from their Higher Power. It was a step out in faith for me, as it is for them.

How I carry the A.A. message could be as important as the message itself. I need to present our message in a positive light, leading by example, displaying as much patience, tolerance and acceptance as I can. I must remember to treat others with loving kindness if I am to encourage them to continue on in service. After all, that was the way I was nurtured into service.

This is a serious responsibility. A responsibility that sometimes I'd rather not have. A responsibility that I can't take for granted. Without this responsibility I would not be who I am today. I would not have learned what I needed to learn. I would not have the relationship with my Higher Power that I have today, or the relationships with all the wonderful people I have met through my service to the Fellowship.

The reason I do what I do for A.A. is not purely unselfish. It has a lot to do with my own wants and needs. I want my life and relationships to be all they can be. I want the peace of mind, I want the experience and the knowledge that this program has to offer. I want this Fellowship for the future well-being of my own children and my friends. The strength of A.A. in the future depends upon our ability today to carry the message not just of recovery, but also of service.

I was told that service work would improve and strengthen my recovery and I have found that to be so. I owe this program so very much. It has given me my life and a new way of life. I need to ensure that the doors are open for those yet to come, as they were for me. I need to display the same unconditional love that was given to me. I was given the freedom to serve to the best of my ability, to make mistakes. I was also given the opportunity to correct those mistakes and therefore to grow through the process. I need the chance to do something useful and to feel a part of our A.A. family. I need the humility to be right but not self-righteous. I need to trust that whatever happens, I can be a positive force for the unity of A.A. Of course, in turn, I need to show the same trust in others that I need from them.

Sometimes personalities enter into issues and cause me to lose focus on the question at hand. When I put A.A.'s principles first, I can see that conflict sometimes arises out of misinformation and lack of knowledge. It is important that we search out the truth and let it be known, if we are to be guided by God through an informed group conscience. We must create an environment within our service meetings that is conducive to freedom of expression—without fear—allowing each member to feel a part of A.A. This is one of our greatest challenges as trusted servants.

I want to be aware that sometimes I feel very strongly that I

know what is right—sometimes, to the point of making me close-minded. I pray to be open-minded and for the God-given knowledge of what will be right for A.A. I thank God for the opportunity to serve without fear. I am grateful that the structure of our Fellowship allows me to step into this unknown water and not just exist, but to thrive.

All these attitudes and lessons that I have learned since the beginning of my service work—at the group, at the district, at the area level—still apply to me here and now at the 45th General Service Conference.

Raymond Massey, Alberta/N.W.T.

THE GRAPEVINE

Presentations on the Grapevine followed the three previous ones on the Conference theme on Monday afternoon. The moderator was Francine Ward, Grapevine director.

Carrying the Message Through the GvR Network

In 1944, when the Grapevine began, it was enthusiastically welcomed into the A.A. world. Very early on, individuals and groups realized that besides being great reading, the magazine was a good way to carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous, and the magazine found its way into prisons and jail cells, hospitals and detoxes. It was used as the basis for discussion meetings, newsletter articles, service workshops, and it was raffled off for newcomers in home groups in the United States and Canada. These activities were all spontaneous and informal, but during the 1950s the idea of having official Grapevine representatives was raised both at the Conference and by the magazine itself. In 1959, for example, the Conference heard a suggestion that local Grapevine representatives could work independently of G.S.R.s to present the magazine as a "vital tool of communication within A.A."

It took a while for this concept to take hold with the groups, but by 1977, there were 286 group GvRs, or one GvR for every 66 groups. In that year, the General Service Conference recommended "that delegates be responsible for establishing area Grapevine committees, using the area and district structure to achieve the goal of a Grapevine representative in every group." As currently practiced, the idea of a Grapevine "committee" is pretty liberally interpreted—many chairpersons form a "committee of one"; as for the goal of a GvR for every group, it has never been achieved. The ratio of GvRs per group, however, has risen: there are now over 7,500 GvRs in the U.S. and Canada registered with our office, or one for every seven groups. While the GvR network was conceived to parallel the existing service structure, there are important differences between the two, differences that bear on today's question.

The G.S.R.'s job is to represent the conscience of his home group. The information he gathers flows from the group, through the service structure, and eventually to the Conference. The loop is completed when what happens at the Conference is reported to the group.

Profile of a Delegate

The average age of a delegate is 52.7 years, with the oldest being 73 and the youngest 31 years; average length of sobriety 13.9 years, longest sobriety 36 years and shortest 6 years; average length of service 11.7 years, longest 30, shortest 5 years. (Compiled on responses from 87 delegates.)

The GvR network, however, works quite differently. The GvR represents the Grapevine in his home group, and the information flow is from the Grapevine to the home group and the individual. There's no annual unifying event like the Conference, and the flow of information tends to go only one way; there isn't really a loop. In fact, we send out a lot of material—free materials like pamphlets, flyers, posters, a quarterly newsletter (The GvR News), circulation reports, corporate board reports—and we don't get too much back. Many GvRs don't send us news, criticism, or suggestions; they aren't a major channel for manuscript submission; they don't even send us jokes!

The G.S.R., to do his job, must participate in district and area events. Group GvRs, on the other hand, aren't first and foremost committee members; they are advocates of the magazine in the group. Unlike G.S.R.s, the group GvR doesn't need to attend service meetings. If the focus is kept on the home group's relationship to the magazine, the duties of a group GvR can be fairly simple: subscribe, show up, display the magazine, and talk it up from time to time. Keep it simple.

How well does the GvR network work today? At its best, the GvR network increases awareness and presence of the Grapevine at A.A. gatherings, it encourages the use of the Grapevine in hospitals, prisons, schools, libraries and other facilities, it gets the magazine into the A.A. group itself, and—not incidentally—it increases subscriptions. The Grapevine is grateful to all those who work hard on behalf of the magazine. But the GvR network does have some built-in difficulties. Here are some points to consider.

First, the primary business of the A.A. Grapevine is to carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous by publishing an international monthly magazine. Our mandate is not to acquire more GvRs, but to get the magazine into the hands of readers.

Second, we have a product for sale represented by service workers whose primary goal is Twelfth Step work. The GvR network is part service outfit, part sales force, part booster club, a hybrid organization with an ongoing identity crisis: to sell or not to sell, to promote or not to promote.

Third, GvRs serve without oversight on the Grapevine's part. At all levels GvRs are free agents, with little contact between areas and sometimes very little with the Grapevine office. This hands-off policy is quite appropriate for an A.A. entity, but it puts the Grapevine in a bind as a publisher: we can't recruit our sales force, we can't train it, we can't monitor it; we certainly can't tell it what to do; we can't even encourage it, except most informally.

Fourth, there's often a gap between area activity and the group level. The area chairperson may not know who the group reps are, or the group reps may not be coming to district or area meetings. In some areas, there are few district reps and therefore no mediator between the two tiers of service; in other areas, there are very few group reps. Many area Grapevine chairpersons put great emphasis on attendance at service gatherings—assemblies, workshops, roundups—and may forget that the majority of A.A. members don't attend service gatherings. Those A.A.s who do attend these gatherings may take a look at the Grapevine display and in the warm spirit of the moment, pick up a subscription form or catalog. But that action doesn't necessarily translate into increased subscriptions.

Fifth, even in areas where chairpersons have worked hard to increase the number of group GvRs, this effort may not positively correlate with subscriptions. In one area, a gain in GvRs hasn't resulted in a corresponding increase in subscriptions, or the increase has been far smaller than the proportionate increase in GvRs. In another area, the number of group GvRs went up and the circulation went down. This is puzzling, but it seems that a GvR on paper isn't the same thing as a real live advocate in the group.

Sixth, GvRs as such are not a stable population. The

Grapevine office recently did a third-class mailing with return address to all group and district GvRs—about 7,500—so we could find out how many pieces were undeliverable. Almost 1,500 of these pieces were returned, at a cost of 44 cents each. This means that almost twenty percent of our representatives had fallen off the edge of our universe—moved on or rotated out—without notifying us. It's useful to point out here that it isn't necessary for a group to have an official GvR in order to subscribe and offer the Grapevine for sale. The overall group chairperson, the literature chairperson, the secretary or the treasurer may have a more stable and longer term, and be a more dependable contact than the GvR.

So it is fair to say that while the GvR network does much good, it also has limits. We may wonder if our historical dependency on the GvR network has kept us from exploring other vital connections with the Fellowship.

In answer to that, we're now finding ways to widen and strengthen those connections, ways that the managing editor has recently developed in a three-year business plan. For example, we have another potential network in place, one almost thirty times larger than the GvR network and made up of people who have, as it were, put their money where their mouth is: this is the more than 120,000 subscribers. By improving our contact with this group, we hope to raise renewal rates, increase gift subscriptions, and get more subscriptions into groups. We're also exploring ways to reach home groups directly by contacting newly registered groups and sending them information and subscription forms. We'd like to introduce groups to the Grapevine when they're in their first heady flush of organizing.

Opportunities are opening up to create a more responsive and interactive environment for the magazine and its readers. In the future, the Grapevine may well have a mixed constituency of subscribers who receive the magazine in the form that's best for them, choosing between hard print, audiocassette tape, or CD-ROM disc. And plans are underway to allow readers to correspond with us via e-mail.

Bill W. liked to say that the good is sometimes the enemy of the best. Surely this suggests that we never merely settle, that we're open to change, that we regularly examine what's working and what's not working. We believe that we can be creative and effective in ways appropriate to A.A., and that good business practices can coexist with spiritual values—indeed, must do so if the Grapevine is to go on carrying the message effectively.

Like all good creative endeavors, the Grapevine is evolving. As our graphic designer, an A.A. member, recently put it: "The Grapevine is a work in progress." We don't have all the answers, but we have a roadmap in the form of the business plan and we have places to explore. It's a good time to be part of the Grapevine—whether as a GvR, a new reader, or a long-time subscriber. If you've been a bystander until now, please join us. Any A.A. who reads the Grapevine, believes in it, supports it, advocates it as a way to carry the message becomes an instant Grapevine representative. Welcome to the GvR network.

Cynthia Keyworth, Editorial/GV department

The Grapevine and Self-Support

The substance of this presentation was given in dramatic form by a group of Grapevine directors and staff. The written presentation was the basis of the live one.

In 1994, the Conference passed an Advisory Action recommending: "That all A.A. members be strongly urged to work toward the goal that the Grapevine magazine be self-supporting

through the sale of magazine subscriptions.” This is the most recent articulation of the goal of self-support for the Grapevine. Here are some earlier ones:

1946 —In a letter written by Bill W.: “Though never to be operated for the profit of any individual, the Grapevine ought to be financially self-supporting.”

1962 —Concept XI: “The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. unquestionably holds full responsibility for its own solvency, promotion, policy, and the management of circulation.”

1971 —The Grapevine Charter: “...Nothing herein contained...shall be deemed to give the corporation the right to solicit funds or to engage in noncharitable activities.”

1992 —The Grapevine Statement of Purpose is adopted by the Grapevine Corporate Board and endorsed by the Grapevine Conference Committee: “Founded in 1944, the Grapevine does not receive group contributions but is supported entirely through magazine subscription sales and additional income derived from the sale of related items.”

These five sources reveal different ways of looking at self-support and leave some unanswered questions: Does self-support refer to the Grapevine magazine or the Grapevine corporation? Is self-support a goal, a guiding principle? Or is it a practical reality? If so, how do we achieve it?

For a number of years, it has been the consensus of the Grapevine Corporate Board that while it is vital for the corporation as a whole to be self-supporting, it's reasonable to subsidize losses incurred by the magazine with income from related items. The board's view is that while the related items have intrinsic value in terms of carrying the A.A. message they also serve to keep the price of the magazine as low as possible (and therefore accessible to more people), and they allow the corporation to be self-supporting.

As Concept XI makes clear, the Grapevine's self-support and autonomy are closely linked. But while autonomy, like self-support, is a desirable goal, it works one way in the abstract and another way in reality. In fact, the Grapevine isn't completely autonomous, and this fact impinges on its ability to be self-supporting. For example, the Grapevine gives the Conference a two-year lead time before it produces any new magazine-related items in order to ensure Fellowship-wide awareness and be responsive to Conference input. And, as instructed by the 1991 Conference, the Grapevine did away with the “About Alcoholism” section—a section still requested by readers of the magazine. In addition, as instructed by the 1991 Conference, the Grapevine attempts to meet an expressed need by publishing at least one article in Spanish in every issue. And, as many here are fully aware, the Conference has (inconclusively so far) addressed the possibility of doing away with such income-producing items as the annual wall calendar and pocket planner.

Meanwhile, many members of the Fellowship aren't aware of our self-support mandate—whether it be confined to the magazine only or applied to the workings of the entire corporation. They lump the Grapevine into an entity known as “New York,” and often assume that the magazine is benefiting from group contributions. So education about the Grapevine's self-support status is ongoing. But even if members of the Fellowship want to help the Grapevine be self-supporting, what can they, or their home group, do? What they can do is subscribe to the magazine, buy *The Language of the Heart*, buy an audio cassette tape. In other words, the product is right smack in the middle of the relationship.

A.A. World Services and G.S.O. also produce items for sale, but those products take their place in the wider and more multifaceted range of membership services—and member contributions. G.S.O. has many mediums for carrying the message; the

Grapevine offers no services and creates a single product—or rather a related collection of products that spring from the single and abiding original: the magazine.

So while the Grapevine meditates on questions of self-support and autonomy, it must also have its eye on the needs of its readers. This isn't always easy, since its readership is a mixed group of the long-time sober and the newcomer, rehabbers and Loners, young and old, women and men, urbanites, suburbanites, and the country dwellers, the middle-class professional and the kid in a jail cell. I wonder how many magazines in America have such a diverse constituency? Fortunately, that diversity is bound up by A.A.'s singleness of purpose. Yet the Grapevine must take that fundamental abstract principle and express it through practical and concrete means—articles chosen, illustrated, and set in type. And it must be responsive to its audience in very specific ways, regularly evaluating its content, its emphasis, its language, its format, and its graphics. The 1994 redesign of the magazine, for example, was partly in response to comments made by the 12,000 people who responded to a readers' questionnaire.

The Grapevine's relationship to its audience is, therefore, very intimate and very immediate. If the magazine does not serve the needs of a reader, he can cancel his subscription. If an A.A. loses her job, she can cancel hers. It's as simple as that. If the economy takes a downturn, and the home group has to make a decision about where the money goes, the Grapevine may lose out. No pie-chart guidelines will save the day. We can't avoid the fact that an economic transaction is being conducted. If you doubt this, talk to a dozen A.A.s who don't subscribe and ask them why: chances are you will be face to face with the economy. If you don't like the magazine, if you don't have the money, if you choose to spend your twelve bucks on something else—well, we can explain about self-support from now until midnight with no results.

And yet this is A.A., and there is always a mysterious kind of goodwill going on. There are folks who say that they continue to subscribe because they want to support the Grapevine—on principle. They subscribe for the same reason they put two bucks in the basket as it goes around. They may not read every word of every issue, but they care about the magazine and they want it to be around for the next generation of A.A.s.

In the same way that the Grapevine's readers keep the magazine going with their monetary support and robust goodwill, members keep submitting articles. The Grapevine's managing editor says that it always amazes him that manuscripts continue to come in, day after day, year after year, a constantly renewing resource. He says, “I've often thought that our true prudent reserve is that daily stream of manuscripts. Without it, we couldn't survive.” Spiritually speaking, the Grapevine's writers and readers are its money in the bank.

With this in mind, it might be helpful to communicate to the Fellowship that what the Grapevine offers is something more than a magazine: It's the opportunity for individual A.A.s to have a voice in a public forum. The Grapevine's greatest strength may be to ensure the survival of that individual expression—quirky and independent as it is—versus consensus.

So the whole point of self-support and autonomy comes down to this: preserving the Grapevine's ability to make those voices heard.

John E. King, Class A trustee

Regarding the proposed video on G.S.O., John King suggested Kevin Cosner play George Dorsey. George said he really had Paul Newman in mind—as he was closer in age.

REPORT: FINANCE

Monday afternoon the Finance report was given by the treasurer of the General Service Board, who also serves as the chairperson of the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee. For more details please see the Finance Section of this Report.

Welcome to the big hat, where money and spirituality can mix for the next 45 minutes. I'm going to talk about how on the one hand we have too much money in the Reserve Fund and, on the other hand, in the form of contributions, we have too little.

G.S.O.'s income comes from two sources: sales of literature and contributions. Last year, we had net sales of literature of \$9.1 million. We spent \$3 million for printing, \$885,000 for royalties, and \$833,000 for shipping and warehousing. After subtracting these direct costs from sales, our gross profit from literature before operating expenses was \$4.4 million. Operating expenses in publishing—items like salaries, rent and telephone—were \$2.3 million, so we had net income from publishing of \$2.1 million.

Contributions were \$3.9 million in 1994, up \$47,000 from 1993, the first "up" year in four years. We spent \$5.4 million on services to the Fellowship; since this was greater than contributions, we ran a deficit of \$1.5 million. Adding together the profit from literature and the deficit from providing services, we had a \$600,000 net profit at G.S.O., which was transferred to the Reserve Fund.

Last year when I presented our finances to you, we were budgeting a loss of \$169,000. We also said that current trends were looking better than they had when we had prepared the budget in January, and if these good trends continued, we hoped to be able to cut literature income later in the year. And the good trends did continue. What happened was that unit sales of literature turned out to be flat, compared with our budget of down 9%, and we managed to keep costs under budget. At the July board meeting, we approved A.A.W.S.'s revised budget that lowered prices by \$1 million per year. These lower prices went into effect on October 1, 1994.

We are in somewhat similar circumstances today. Our 1995 budget calls for a loss of \$731,000. It looks as if we might beat our budget again this year. If these trends continue, I think we might be tempted to cut literature prices again, and A.A.W.S. is always discussing literature prices. But I am really cautious about another price cut now. When I am done speaking, I am going to ask George Dorsey to give us a brief update on the current picture at A.A.W.S.

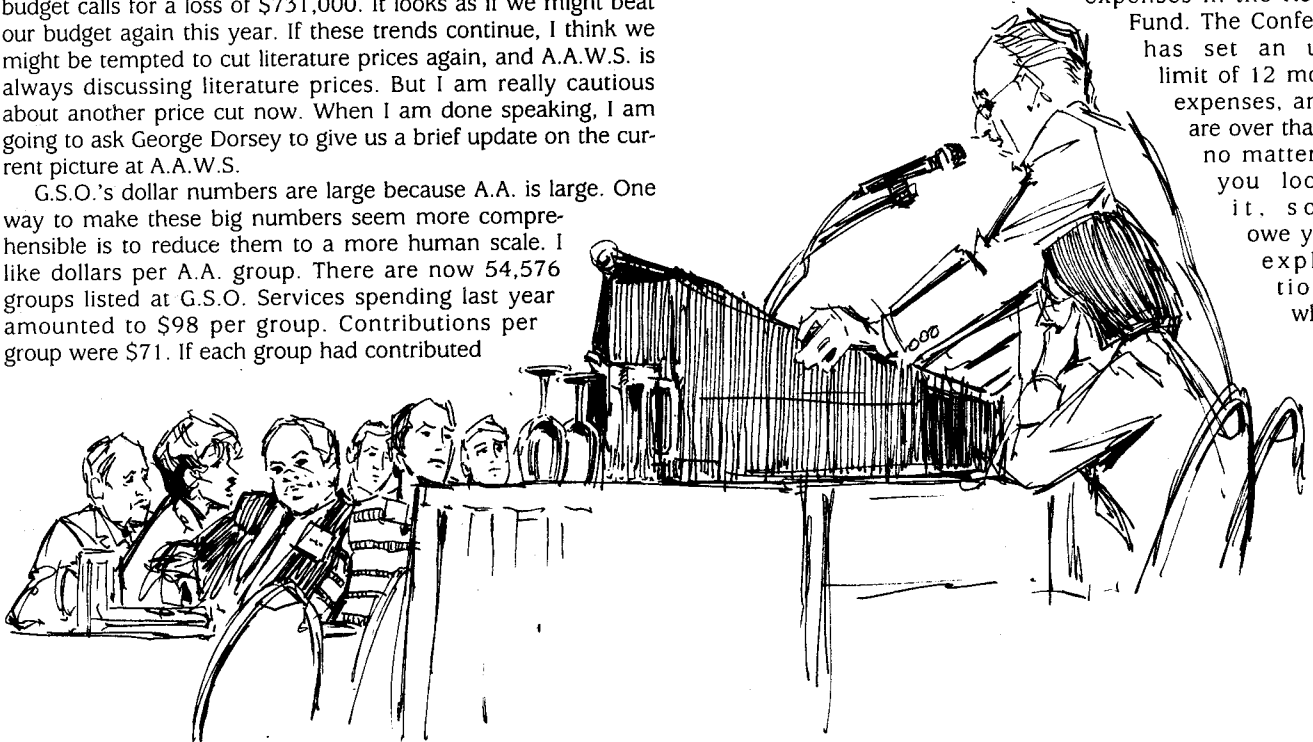
G.S.O.'s dollar numbers are large because A.A. is large. One way to make these big numbers seem more comprehensible is to reduce them to a more human scale. I like dollars per A.A. group. There are now 54,576 groups listed at G.S.O. Services spending last year amounted to \$98 per group. Contributions per group were \$71. If each group had contributed

\$27 more in 1994—that is, 50 cents more per group per week—contributions would have covered services spending without help of literature income.

I occasionally hear the view that we are somehow not self-supporting or spiritual because we use literature income to support services. I do not view the use of literature profits to help support services as being in conflict with the Seventh Tradition or with our character as a spiritual Fellowship. I prefer the word "balance" to the word "conflict." In 1994, group and individual contributions covered 72% of services expense. Literature income covered 28%, an acceptable balance in my view. I think it would be harmful if we had to rely too heavily on literature income to pay for services, but it would be disaster if we were to cut services to be consistent with some all-or-nothing view that only group contributions count as self-support. The idea that literature profits do not count as self-support is not supported by our history or in Bill's writings. I would be much more troubled by the conflict we would face with the Fifth Tradition if we were to refuse to use literature income to help carry the A.A. message than I am by the idea that we are somehow in conflict with the Seventh Tradition now. Everyone in this room got sober during a time when literature income was helping to carry the message. Bill W. wrote about the use of literature income to cover services expenses in 1962 when he wrote the Concepts. In the Second Warranty he described literature income as "...the sum of a great many contributions which the book buyers make to the general welfare of Alcoholics Anonymous. The certain and continuous solvency of our world services rests squarely upon these contributions." (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p.66)

Now I want to talk about the Reserve Fund. Right now, the Reserve Fund amounts to slightly less than \$10 million, which on our more human scale is \$181 per A.A. group. It represents 13.2 months of combined Grapevine and G.S.O. office expenses. Remember, in 1993 we changed our accounting to exclude from office expense the cost of shipping and warehousing A.A. literature. This change affected the calculation of the number of months' expenses in the Reserve Fund. Under the old accounting method, we would now have 12.1 months of operating expenses in the Reserve Fund.

The Conference has set an upper limit of 12 months' expenses, and we are over that limit no matter how you look at it, so we owe you an explanation of why we



are above the limit. It is not because we raised prices. It is not because sales or contributions increased. It is because costs were tightly controlled, and it is difficult to forecast cost cuts at budget time. For several years now, we have budgeted for break-even results or losses, then found ways to cut costs, so we actually wound up with profits, which were transferred to the Reserve Fund.

So how do we cut the Reserve Fund down to size? A 1988 Conference Advisory Action said that literature price reductions were to be the primary mechanism to adjust the relationship of the Reserve Fund to the limit of one year's operating expenses. This makes a lot of common sense. We shouldn't get the Reserve Fund down by spending more money. We spend money on services because the services are important in carrying the message, not because the money is there. So we lower prices. Our problem is that we have to adjust prices in a way that doesn't disrupt the Fellowship. To take an extreme example, we could reduce the Reserve Fund to ten months' expenses, a number that I viewed as a sensible lower target given today's circumstances, by lowering the price of the Big Book by \$2.40 for a year. Our price net of discounts is now \$4.30, so for one year we could sell one million Big Books for \$1.90, then go back to our old pre-October 1994 prices for all literature. This move would get the Reserve Fund down, but it would hurt A.A. The first reaction would be dismay on the part of groups, central offices and intergroups who were stuck with inventory losses on the books they had paid \$4.50 or \$5.00 for. The next reaction would be confusion when we more than doubled prices when the year was up. The Fellowship's final reaction probably would be that G.S.O. was incompetent and didn't know what it was doing. No one is suggesting this extreme a path, but whenever we reduce literature prices, we are faced with some serious questions about how long we can keep the reductions in effect and who is going to be hurt by the reduction and the subsequent increase. We try to find a level of prices that would be sustainable, for at least two or three years. Unless contributions or sales volumes increase markedly, our current price structure will result in a substantial decrease in the Reserve Fund within two or three years, and then we are likely to have to increase prices somewhat. Remember that printing and mailing costs are increasing. What I am asking for is your patience as we try to reduce the Reserve Fund in a way that carries the message most effectively and doesn't disrupt the Fellowship.

At the end of this year, we will have to adopt a new accounting procedure for post-retirement medical expenses accruals as required by the Financial Accounting Standards Board. We have delayed implementing this for as long as we can. It will probably involve a theoretical charge against the Reserve Fund of, we now think, \$1.75 million. Because it is a non-cash charge, I think this new accounting should not lower the Reserve Fund for purposes of calculating the ceiling. I wanted you to be aware of this change, so you will be able to explain it when it occurs.

One use of the Reserve Fund to help carry the message involves the Grapevine. The Grapevine proposed a 25% increase in the price of the magazine from \$12 to \$15. The Grapevine board was correct in making this proposal because there was no other way to present a balanced budget. The trustees' Finance Committee asked the Grapevine Board to defer the increase. We did this because the Grapevine estimated that it would lose 15% of its subscribers—around 18,000 readers—because of the price increase. It is hard to view losing 18,000 subscribers as carrying the message. The Grapevine will have to raise prices sometime after 1995 because of increases in paper and postage costs. The reason the Finance Committee interfered with the Grapevine Board's decision was that we

would rather see the price increased when circulation is at a higher level, and we think the Grapevine has some plans that will boost circulation. Another possible use of the Reserve Fund to help carry the message is a Spanish edition of the Grapevine, which the Conference is considering this year. The only way a magazine start-up like this could be financed in A.A. is through the use of the Reserve Fund.

All of us want to encourage more contributions, and most of all to see more groups contribute. We have tried to encourage contributions based on the worthwhile goal of having them totally support group services. Now we are concerned that the size of the Reserve Fund will discourage contributions.

Perhaps our emphasis should be on spiritual principles—the recognition that each group is part of something much bigger than itself and has the opportunity to help carry the A.A. message around the world. Embracing the Seventh Tradition makes it possible to take the First and the Fifth Traditions off the printed page and put them into action. A group contribution, no matter how small, represents more than money. It represents a group's understanding of and desire for the services it pays for. It represents a contribution toward A.A. unity.

Gary Glynn,

Class A trustee & treasurer, G.S.B.

SUBSTANTIAL UNANIMITY IN THE CONFERENCE PROCESS

This presentation/discussion session was moderated by Chuck Crist, Grapevine director.

To understand the importance of substantial unanimity, I first had to understand what we are here to accomplish.

Article 11 of both the current and original Conference Charters says: "The Conference will hear the financial and policy reports of the General Service Board and its related corporate services. The Conference will advise with trustees, directors, and staff members upon all matters presented as affecting A.A. as a whole, engage in debate, appoint necessary committees, and pass suitable resolutions for the advice or direction of the General Service Board and its related services." (*A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. S34)

That suggests that we are not administrators; we are policy-makers. So, as we focus on drafting policy, let's look at the big picture. We're here entrusted to chart A.A.'s future. Let's not waste our precious time together debating procedure or the past. As the Conference moves ahead and we proceed, the Warranties of Concept Twelve say: "...that all important decisions be reached by discussion, vote and whenever possible, by substantial unanimity..." (*ibid*, p. 61)

The two-thirds majority required for substantial unanimity is difficult to attain by design. Only the most worthy causes garner such overwhelming support. Substantial unanimity hampers frivolous or rash Conference action. It demands an informed group conscience. It forces painstaking deliberation for a unity of ideas.

In the introduction to our Twelve Concepts Bill W. wrote: "...change does not necessarily spell progress....each new group of workers in world service will be tempted to try all sorts of innovations that may often produce little more than painful repetition of earlier mistakes. Therefore it will be an important objective of these Concepts to forestall such repetitions..." (*ibid*, p. 3)

Therefore Conference Advisory Actions requiring substantial

unanimity should perhaps be reserved for only the most serious issues, lest Advisory Actions become the A.A. equivalent of government regulation. Let's use them sparingly, avoiding governance, focusing rather on spiritual guidance.

Some say Conference spirituality can be gauged by how few Advisory Actions pass. Perhaps that's a challenge to encourage creativity rather than to mandate rigidity. Let's resist management and concentrate on policy. Let's review our individual committee agendas for Advisory Actions that pursue policy, for that is where a two-thirds majority is warranted. When facing non-policy issues, let our committees use the alternative of strong recommendations. This way the gravity of a two-thirds majority and advisories are reserved for the most serious concerns.

Furthermore, by dispensing with non-policy issues at the committee level, we leave the spiritual Conference body more time to focus on the most pressing matters. Without dozens of advisories we can still live up to our responsibilities and prudently affect changes. In fact, we can avoid wholesale regulation and still rock A.A. to its core with strong recommendations.

Advisory Actions are not the only way to convey a message or get things done. In many cases common sense will dictate that full Conference consideration is necessary for some issues. Some committees may opt to issue a strong statement and let their message stand at that. There are, of course, several issues in every Conference about which we all have strong opinions, and for these Advisory Actions are certainly in order.

If each Conference has a unique controversy unto itself, this 45th may well center on the phrase that follows substantial unanimity in the long and short versions of the Twelfth Concept, which reads: "...that no Conference action ever be personally punitive or an incitement to public controversy...." (*ibid*, p. 61)

Under the stewardship of the General Service Conference our Fellowship has flourished. Substantial unanimity ensures that we will not hurt it, or ourselves, with the "new innovations" that Bill predicted in 1955. Substantial unanimity ensures agreement will prevail among more than most of us. It reinforces humility, in that we are each a small part of a greater group.

Substantial unanimity demands cooperation and fosters informed group conscience. And, after we have argued "spiritually" over policy, substantial unanimity prevails and restores that special unity in A.A. wherein we can disagree without being disagreeable.

Karl Lamberg, New Hampshire

My very first reaction when I received this loving invitation was "Poor me, why do I always have to get the tough ones?" My second thought (following very closely on the first) was to get our happy archivist to do the research for me, which I would then summarize and present. This would give you a history of the concept of substantial unanimity in the Fellowship, as well as a detailed, foolproof set of procedures and guidelines to apply directly to all circumstances. Those of you with an alcoholic mind will of course immediately recognize the big Ego and the attempt to go for the easier, softer way. And then the third thought (which came only long after) was that I am stuck with this and I'll have to stumble through this in my own clumsy way.

So, how do we define substantial unanimity? Well, we all know the basics. We know it takes three-quarters of all the registered groups to change the things that we have written in stone—like the Traditions and the Warranties of Article XII of the Conference Charter.

At all levels where decisions are made (I'm thinking particularly of actions taken here at the Conference), a vote of over

two-thirds is accepted as substantial unanimity and is considered binding on the management and staff at the General Service Office, as well as on the three boards. A vote of less than one-half means "Don't." A majority vote between one-half and two-thirds represents a suggestion to the staff/management/boards that, under normal circumstances, efforts should be made to follow this action—but it is not nearly as binding as a two-thirds vote.

This was summed up beautifully by my sponsor long before I was even aware of the existence of a Conference; namely, that there are always three options for any decision in A.A.: a "yes," a "no" and a "maybe, but not now."

But what about those "Additional Considerations That Did Not Result in Recommendations?" I place these in the category of "park bench musings." As far as the Conference is concerned, they may be items that are not at a policy level and decisions on them more properly belong elsewhere; or they may be items on which the Conference Committee is split; or the committee may agree that more input and discussion are required on an item before a recommendation is formulated; or there may be any one of another half dozen reasons for not recommending a specific action right now.

All of this mechanical stuff we know, and to varying degrees, accept. So why is substantial unanimity the topic of discussion here today? Why do we want to spend our precious time here this week on this topic? I think the basic answer is Trust—or more precisely, the lack of trust. We could spend the next four days hammering out the fine guidelines and regulations and rules for who decides what, and who is responsible to whom. But I'm positive that with our keen alcoholic intellects we would find objections and exceptions to each detail before the ink is dry on the paper. No. The more obvious answer has to lie in trust and faith: Faith that we have been guided at each step to select the right people to serve us (G.S.R., D.C.M., delegate, staff, management, director, trustee); trust that the servants selected are willing and responsible to carry out the services assigned.

I think that the greatest hurdle this Fellowship will face in the next ten years will not concern copyrights, nor whether litigation is public controversy, nor the proliferation of self-help psychobabble. I feel that the greatest hurdle we face today and in the foreseeable future is the spill-over into our Fellowship of the cynicism and distrust that are exhibited in our North American society at large in regard to its public servants. I have noticed with growing concern that letters from members of the Fellowship are more and more suspicious of the motives of the leaders we have chosen to serve us. There was a time within my short 18-year experience in this Fellowship when arguments abounded about principles and what the best course of action might be. But there was always the underlying premise that both sides thought they knew what was the greatest good for the longest time. And when the vote was taken, and upwards of two-thirds voted for fuchsia-colored name tags, the proponents of the brown tags might have their minority say, but would accept the decision of a Higher Power "as He may express Himself in our group conscience." I sometimes wonder if we can still do that. More often I hear the minority either questioning the motives of an "influential" leader in swaying the majority; or else, insisting that the body wasn't well informed, and then, when the group does have the information, saying that the body is not responsible (not listening) and that it has become a law unto itself. The thing that's missing is acceptance by the minority of the group conscience decision. I know that for myself, I have to keep two things in mind:

First, I, alone, do not always know what is best for A.A. in the long term. I often don't even know what is best for me.

You're looking at the person who was convinced beyond a doubt that being alcoholic and coming to A.A. was the absolute worst fate that could possibly fall to a human being. Turned out to be the very best thing that ever happened to me—bar none! So if I don't even know what's good for me, I may occasionally not know what is best for A.A.

Second, if a servant (or service body) somewhere in A.A. screws up, the trouble lies not with that servant, but with the members who selected that person. My home group some time ago chose to sit back and let a young, new member take on the job of group treasurer. After three months, we discovered that the money from the basket didn't make it to the bank, and the rent wasn't paid. Whose fault? The older members of the group did the young girl a terrible injustice. She should never have been placed in such an impossible situation. I often pray for her, and am grateful to her for teaching me a very valuable lesson.

So, after all this, what is substantial unanimity? It's the same as it has always been—to be of one mind (spirit) on the basic principles of fundamental issues. Translated into personal terms, it simply means that I don't always know what's best, and I need to have faith in group conscience decisions. Simple as that!

Not one of us is given a torch big enough to lead the drunks of the world out of the darkness and into the light. Instead, each of us has been given a candle that burns for a short while with a flickering flame. If we stand together, the light will outshine the greatest torch. If we argue and bicker and blow at each other's candle so that each of us starts shielding our own little flame, then the alcoholics of the world will continue to suffer in darkness—and so will we.

The answer does not lie in more rules or guidelines. The solution lies in trust and faith. I pray that this Conference will be a witness to the Fellowship of the trust and faith by each member here, in the guidance of a Higher Power.

Gerry Flegel, Western Canada regional trustee

REPORT: THIRTEENTH WORLD SERVICE MEETING

The experience of unity at the Thirteenth World Service Meeting, held from October 9-13 in Cartagena, Colombia, is one I shall never forget. The privilege of serving A.A. as a delegate of the U.S./Canada structure fills me with gratitude. Witnessing the love and respect others have for our G.S.O. was inspiring and gratifying.

My wife Gail and I arrived in Cartagena on Friday and were greeted with courtesy and warmth by members of the Colombian Host Committee. They made us feel at home in this historic city, attending to our needs throughout the week and providing enjoyable excursions for family and guests.

Our general manager, George Dorsey, chaired all the meetings. John Grant's planning and preparation helped make the meeting the success it was. John arranged the agenda, worked with the host committee to accomplish the logistics and preparations and continued on to create the World Service Meeting's attractive and informative final report. John Kirwin negotiated hotel arrangements, saw to our equipment and data processing needs. Staff members Susan Ulseth, Danny Mooney and Richard Bush coordinated workshops, took notes and assisted in many valuable ways. Angel Calvillo, from our translation staff, provided much assistance throughout the week. The work of all provided invaluable support and I extend my thanks and praise to each for their diligence, competence and loving spirit during these very busy days. Their work, along with the work of

Colombia's G.S.O. and General Service Board, plus the experience and strength of the 38 caring delegates provided this important experience of love and service for us all.

The World Service Meeting opened on Sunday afternoon with a reception followed by a "Red Ball" A.A. meeting, which I was given the privilege of chairing. As the Red Ball rolled around the room from delegate to delegate, experiences of gratitude, humor and love were shared. We all identified with each other in the A.A. way—a fine beginning. This meeting and all the others were simultaneously translated into Spanish or English. All delegates must have a working knowledge of English or Spanish in order to participate in the meetings.

After dinner that night George Dorsey brought the official proceedings to order and roll was called. Class A trustee Hermes Zuluago Restrepo, chairman of the General Service Board of Colombia, gave an inspiring opening address. Dr. Zuluago paraphrased Bill W.'s remarks in *A.A. Comes of Age*, when he said "our Twelfth Step—carrying the message—is the basic service that the A.A. Fellowship gives; this is our principle aim and the main reason for our existence. A.A. is more than a set of principles: it is a society of alcoholics in action. We must carry the message, else we ourselves can wither and those who have not yet been given the truth may die." This thought carried through the entire four-day meeting.

After the Statement of Purpose was read by Akiyo Mimatsu, delegate from Japan, the keynote speaker, N.C. Naiker of South Africa, gave a presentation on the theme of the meeting, "Back to Basics." In part, N.C. stated "As a World Service Meeting delegate, why do I have to go back repeatedly to basics? I must be fully aware of the dangers of complacency and egoism and never allow any dictatorial attitudes to creep in. Living the A.A. program according to its suggested principles, I will be joining forces with others to eradicate anything that may threaten the quality and very existence of our Fellowship. . . . I may be safe from the ravages of this dreaded disease today. But can I say it will be so tomorrow? Can I say it will be so for my kin? One day I asked my Higher Power why he had taken from me this dreaded disease, while my only son had fallen victim to it. The answer came through the power of prayer, the belief in the faith I have in the God of my understanding, and in the Fellowship. Ten years ago, my son walked through the doors of A.A. This was an instance of my wildest dreams coming true."

Monday morning we heard three presentations on Anonymity, followed by the first of three committee meetings. Committees include Agenda; Literature/Publishing; Policy/Admissions/Finance; and Working With Others. The Policy/Admissions/Finance committee recommended an increase in delegates' fees for the Fourteenth World Service Meeting to \$2,900, progressing toward the goal of fully self-supporting World Service Meetings. World Service Meeting recommendations are not binding on the service structure of any country. They are expressions of conscience of the World Service Meeting.

The Working With Others Committee discussed aspects of how to best carry the A.A. message to the handicapped, professionals and clergy. The committee also focused on assisting newly emerging A.A. structures in other countries. The Literature Committee had a long agenda. Some of the items discussed included, "How we handle requests for permission to reprint excerpts from Conference-approved literature" and "Does A.A. publish too much literature?" The committee reviewed the subject of copyrights and felt that "A.A. literature belongs to A.A. as a whole and that A.A.W.S., Inc., U.S./Canada, holds the copyrights in trust for all members." The committee recommended that A.A.W.S. continue to grant exclusive licenses to only one service structure in each country. Granting licens-

es to two entities in a single country could weaken A.A. unity in that country. This became an unanimous recommendation of the entire World Service Meeting. It was suggested that future World Service Meetings be kept aware of problems regarding A.A. copyrights.

Four workshops were held throughout the four days: Literature—A Basic Tool; Communication Between Countries; Understanding Anonymity; and Unstructured. It was during the workshop on Communication Between Countries that Akiyo Mimatsu and New Zealander Bob Preston announced the Asia/Oceania Meeting which was subsequently held so successfully this past March in Tokyo.

Much like at our General Service Conference, first term delegates gave brief highlights of A.A. activity in their countries. I presented U.S./Canada highlights of our structure, Conference and boards. Throughout the week there were frequent opportunities for delegates to share from open microphones following presentations and reports. Second term delegates all received loving invitations to make presentations. David O'Leary, trustee-at-large/Canada, gave a presentation on "Rotation in Service" and concluded his talk by saying, "I firmly believe that if we adhere to the spirit of rotation, 'the spirit which now binds us together in our common cause will always be stronger than those personal ambitions and desires which tend to drive us apart.'" (*Language of the Heart*, p.8) Swedish delegate Marie Louise sharing on the importance of our Traditions in a changing world, said: "We do live in a world that changes and, for this reason, it is even more important to remember our Twelve Traditions. The disease of alcoholism does not change!" Barney McCaul of Cork County, Ireland, spoke of "...our unique, anonymous, humble solidarity. We feel it so strongly when the basket passes among us at the end of the meeting. Anonymous contributions support all our joint needs as A.A. members, and prevent finance and fame from tearing us apart. Of itself, it releases the spiritual strength that reminds us that our own welfare is based on placing the ideal and the goal above our own interest."

Following closing remarks by Dr. Zuluaga we joined together in the Serenity Prayer. Delegates from every country, repeated the prayer in their own languages: Flemish, Spanish, Finnish, French, German, English, Icelandic, Gaelic, Italian, Japanese, Norwegian, South African and Swedish. No words can express the spirit of unity that filled the room. One could sense the spirit moving forward to China, to emerging Eastern Block nations, and to new members elsewhere around the world and here at home. Truly our gratitude must go forward. The Agenda Committee reflected the feeling of us all when it chose the theme for the Fourteenth World Service Meeting, "Love and Gratitude in Action." This World Service Meeting will be held here in New York just preceding the 1996 October Board Weekend.

Words of thanks could never suffice for the loving care of the Colombian Board and Host Committee. Thursday evening the Colombian General Service Board hosted a magnificent banquet, with entertainment by sensational native folk dancers who were joined at times by delegates, spouses and friends.

Gail and I returned home with memories of A.A. love that will never fade. To witness the first fruits of A.A. labors in far-away lands; to hear the Traditions lovingly upheld there as they are here at home; to hear of the effectiveness of service structures—all unique—but modeled somewhat after ours; but most of all, to feel absolute love and commitment of my fellow delegates concerning our message and its future—these labors and loves filled our hearts. This love and dedication was expressed by Francisco Carvalho de Rivera of Brazil when he said, "Our beloved Fellowship must remain alive and be forever growing. This will be our heritage to those who follow us. Our hope for

the future is that some day, everywhere in the world, there will be an A.A. member carrying the message and declaring, 'I am responsible. When anyone, anywhere reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. to be there and for that I am responsible.' Perhaps this appears to be a dream. But dreams do come true." If we work for it and God sustains us, Francisco's dream will come true. Thank you, God, and thank you and A.A. around the world for the gift of this once-in-a-lifetime experience.

Larry Nelson, trustee-at-large/U.S.

SPECIAL NEEDS

Thursday's afternoon session began with two presentations on carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics with special needs. Gay Garner, Southeast regional trustee, was the moderator.

In 1940, Bill responded to a non-A.A. woman in San Francisco who was interested in "doing the book in Braille." He commended her efforts saying, "And you surely have our happy consent to put the book into Braille." Our Fellowship has a long history of attempting to make the A.A. message accessible to all.

Hard of hearing alcoholics, too, were seeking help. In 1948, a deaf, lip-reading member, whose wife was also deaf, wrote, "Being deaf, we have to know a little more about things than the average A.A. member. We make up our own stories and do what we can to say the right thing. We will try to send in our story some time in the future, but only if you think it would help someone else." In 1953, the Glen Ridge, New Jersey Group proudly announced that James C., "The only Male Deaf Mute In Alcoholics Anonymous" would be celebrating his first A.A. anniversary. His "case history" was to be translated through sign language.

In keeping with our Twelfth Tradition, there are no special A.A. members, but many alcoholics have special needs—persons who are blind or visually impaired; deaf or hard of hearing; chronically ill or homebound; and those with limited reading skills. One might also include those who must overcome particular hurdles in order to get the A.A. message, such as alcoholics facing language barriers, older alcoholics with limited mobility, A.A.s with AIDS or who are HIV positive, those with learning disabilities or mental illness.

To help make A.A. accessible for such people, some areas have formed Special Needs or Accessibilities Committees. The members of these committees explore, develop and offer alternatives to make the A.A. message and participation in our program available to anyone who reaches out for it. At this time, fewer than 20 committees are listed in our records, but we hope there are more.

If your area has a Special Needs or Accessibilities Committee or is interested in forming one, please let us know. We will provide the chairperson with new A.A. Guidelines on Serving

Freudian slip: floor accidents (for floor actions, of course).

Dan Eberlein (North Florida) said he had been told that "the first time you go up to the microphone is like losing your virginity."

"Never have I heard so many wonderful people say the same thing in a different way." —Jim Redemske (Iowa).

"I saw Disney World years before it was built." —Charles Matthews (Tennessee).

Alcoholics With Special Needs, A.A. Guidelines on Carrying the A.A. Message to the Deaf Alcoholic, and information about relevant material available through G.S.O.

For example, the Big Book may be obtained in Braille, large print, on audiotape and also on video in American Sign Language. The Twelve and Twelve is in Braille, large print and on audiotape; three basic recovery pamphlets are available in Braille; several of our videos and all of our television public service announcements are closed-captioned or subtitled. We also have special Conference-approved, illustrated, easy-to-read literature for alcoholics with limited reading skills.

In addition, housebound A.A.s, known as Homers, may participate in the *Loners/Internationalists Meeting* by mail. G.S.O. is able to provide information about a variety of resources such as distributors of A.A. talks on tape, agencies that provide A.A. Conference-approved literature in Braille and on audiotape, and on-line A.A. meetings convening in cyberspace.

With our growing understanding of special needs, a future Conference might consider revising "The A.A. Group" pamphlet to increase group awareness about accommodating alcoholics with disabilities.

Groups might be encouraged to look for accessible locations, to offer tapes, large print and Braille as part of their literature displays. Some groups provide A.S.L. interpreters to accommodate deaf members. Speakers at A.A. conventions are often signed. In Eastern Missouri, the innovative Special Needs Committee provides convention programs in Braille. At the International Convention in San Diego, Braille programs will be available, and the Big Meetings and many other events will be signed for deaf attendees. There will also be a workshop entitled "Reaching Alcoholics With Special Needs," a meeting especially for deaf alcoholics, and special transportation will be provided for physically disabled members.

In fulfilling our primary purpose, let us always remember the alcoholic who may not be able to get the message in the same way we received it. Our Conference theme is a wonderful reminder to each of us to "Pass It On"—in Braille, in sign language, or by whatever means necessary to make the A.A. message available to ALL who want it.

Lois Fisher, G.S.O. staff

Our theme, "Pass It On—Our Three Legacies," has really had an impact on me relating to the topic, Special Needs. It seems to me that this gives us a great opportunity to look into our own hearts and reflect on how we have been addressing the special needs of members of our Fellowship. For carrying the First Legacy message of Recovery to suffering alcoholics is what our Fellowship is all about.

What a wonderful experience it was when we first came to A.A. We saw the peace and serenity of the people that had come to A.A. before us. We heard the spiritual words that were shared by grateful members. We spoke of our gratitude for receiving the message of recovery. We read about our future in The Promises. We eagerly walked into the meeting rooms of A.A. to greet the members.

In turn, we got to carry the message of recovery to some alcoholics we came in contact with. But what about the other alcoholics we don't commonly see? Like the alcoholics with special needs who may never ever in their entire life get the message of recovery.

What about the blind who don't get to see the peace and serenity of people who came to A.A. before them? What about the deaf who don't get to hear the spiritual words that are shared by grateful members? What about the mute who cannot

speak of their gratitude for receiving the message of recovery? What about the illiterate who cannot read about their future in The Promises? What about the crippled who cannot eagerly walk into the meeting rooms of A.A. to greet the members? And what about all the other alcoholics with special needs that have greater dimensions of difficulty in their recovery programs than we had in ours?

Let's think about the special needs people in our home areas who require Twelfth Step work. Do we have any idea: Who they are? How many there are? Where they are? Or what their special needs are?

The number of alcoholics with special needs who are waiting for the message of recovery is immense. Through our Second Legacy of Unity much has been done throughout A.A. to carry the message to them. However, this field of endeavor still has unlimited opportunities for Twelfth Step work. Consider these shocking facts about the reading ability of people. One out of every nine adult Americans cannot read at all. Sixty-five percent of U.S. prison inmates cannot read. Eighty-five percent of juvenile offenders are illiterate. One out of ten drivers cannot read road signs. Forty percent of Americans say they have never read a book.

How can we help alcoholics with special needs? From our Third Legacy of Service we can draw the simple solution. We can help by bringing the alcoholic to a meeting, or by bringing the meeting to an alcoholic. That is what we need to do more of.

If you are interested you can look for and ask about special needs activities in your area. Look for: Special Needs listings in meeting lists; wheelchair access signs and ramps; offers to provide rides to meetings; signs and flyers in Braille; meetings with signers for the deaf; translation equipment for members with language barriers; availability of T.D.D.s for the deaf to communicate with each other.

You can do any or all of these things. Anything that you do will be greatly appreciated by the special needs members who are struggling to help themselves.

I was asked to speak for five minutes on the subject of special needs. Not very much time for such an important topic. I thought that the time would be best used in making an impassioned plea to you to ask yourself, "What can I do to help deliver the message of recovery to alcoholics with special needs?" Please hold out your hand to those who need you so badly.

Manuel Ysaia, California, Mid-Southern

1995 INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

Throughout Conference week there was an air of excitement in anticipation of A.A.'s 60th Anniversary celebration, a few short months away. Therefore, it was fitting that the final reports of the Conference, Friday afternoon, were updates of last minute plans for this important event.

From June 29 to July 2, 1995—just a couple of months away—we will meet in celebration of A.A.'s 60th Birthday at our International A.A. Convention. San Diego is proud to be the host city for the Convention, and we hope to see all of you there.

This very special event will be packed full with meetings, meetings, meetings, panels, workshops, marathons, mini-marathons, and, of course, the Big Meetings and other events at the Jack Murphy Stadium. Thursday evening starts off with a Harbor Block party and dances along the San Diego Bay waterfront to the Seaport Village Mall.

At midnight on Thursday, two major marathon meetings get underway, one in English and one in Spanish. These will run

continuously until Sunday morning. All day Friday and Saturday, there will be A.A. meetings, in various languages, going on at the Convention Center as well as the Marriott and Hyatt hotels.

Friday night at the Jack Murphy Stadium will mark the Opening Ceremonies, with a Parade of Flags of those countries in attendance at the Convention—probably about eighty of them—followed by the Big A.A. Meeting. Saturday night there is an Oldtimers Stadium Meeting, and Sunday morning the Closing Meeting at the Stadium. Complimentary shuttle buses will be available to and from Jack Murphy Stadium events, the Convention Center and any other Convention sites.

Preparing for such an event is a lot of work. The trustees' Committee on International Conventions, Eileen Gatzka, the Convention coordinator, as well as Bobbie Coneen, Gary Ulrici and Gail Nelson, the A.A. Host Committee chairs, and their subcommittees have all worked hard to help make the many visitors to San Diego feel welcome and comfortable. The Host Committee is now well on its way to being 6,000 local A.A. members strong! We are grateful for their service. Preregistration closes on May 15, 1995. So if you have not yet registered, do it right away (there are still some forms available in the back of the room). Of course, anyone can register on-site, but long lines will be expected, and it will be \$5 more to register on-site to cover turnaround processing costs.

Registration covers the entire cost of putting on the International Convention, which, in keeping with our Seventh Tradition and previous Conference Advisory Action, must be self-supporting. No group funds are used for the International Convention.

For the family members and friends that belong to Al-Anon or Alateen and will be going to San Diego, the Concourse Center, right in town, as well as the adjacent Doubletree and U.S. Grant hotels will offer daytime meetings, workshops and other events.

San Diego is a beautiful and welcoming city just 27 miles from the Mexican border—we have reserved space in hotels in Tijuana and Rosarita Beach. The neighborhoods are all scenic, and conventioners will have a wonderful time-out visiting our historic sites, Balboa and Mission Bay parks, the Zoo and Sea World, and strolling along the San Diego Bay and the Pacific Ocean. And we have great restaurants, coffee bars and ice cream parlors!

We from San Diego look forward to welcoming you to this International Celebration of A.A.'s 60th Birthday, where everyone will, we know, be speaking the language of the heart!

Marco Antonio Roman, California, San Diego/Imperial

For the second time in this decade, the Pacific Region is privileged to host an International Convention of Alcoholics Anonymous. Following the 1990 International in Seattle, San Diego will host the event this year.

The 1995 San Diego Convention will be the tenth international gathering of our Fellowship—gatherings that are held once every five years. The following is a brief history of the International Conventions of Alcoholics Anonymous, from data compiled by previous Convention committees. Since 1950, when the first International Convention was held in Cleveland, there have been many changes in both our society and our Fellowship. You will see that some changes have occurred in our Conventions, but that the basic purpose remains the same—to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers.

Each Convention has made its own memorable contributions to our Fellowship. That first one in Cleveland celebrated

the 15th Anniversary of Alcoholics Anonymous. Since Dr. Bob died in November of that year, it was the only Convention in which both our co-founders appeared. The General Service Conference received its start, on a five-year probationary period, at this Convention.

Five successful years later, in St. Louis, surviving co-founder Bill W. turned over to the General Service Conference full responsibility for A.A.'s Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service. This week we renew our pledge to continue furthering these three Legacies—to Pass It On.

The 1960 International Convention in Long Beach marked the 25th Anniversary of our Fellowship. About 9,000 A.A.s and family members showed up for this gathering, which featured many of the nonalcoholic friends of A.A.—Sister Ignatia, the Rev. Sam Shoemaker and Milton Maxwell.

"I Am Responsible" was the theme of the 1965 International in Toronto, the first Convention held outside the borders of the United States. More than 10,000 people from 34 countries gathered at this fourth International. In his concluding talk, Bill W. reminded his listeners that the program had reached less than ten percent of those needing help.

Bill W. briefly addressed his last International at the 1970 Miami Convention. In Miami, similar to previous Internationals, powerful themes and dedications were matched by beautiful surroundings, but the overriding issue in the minds of most people was Bill's declining health. He died the following January.

The 1975 International in Denver witnessed nearly 20,000 attendees. Here the Native American A.A.s were very much a part of the first Convention to be solely under the leadership of the General Service Conference.

In 1980, the New Orleans International was marked by the introduction of *Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers*. Attendance soared to more than 22,000.

That figure almost doubled to 44,500 at the 1985 Montreal Convention, which also marked the 50th anniversary of Alcoholics Anonymous. Here Lois Wilson made a brief appearance at 94 years of age, and Ruth Hock, who typed the original manuscript of the Big Book, was presented with the five-millionth copy.

In 1990, for the first time in 30 years, the International returned to the West Coast when 45,000 drunks converged on Seattle. The flag ceremony, with many Eastern European banners appearing for the first time, was a particularly moving and memorable event.

What does San Diego hold in store for us? As usual, we will have some very special guests. Very likely we will see record attendance in a centrally located convention area situated in one of this country's most popular vacation cities. The 1995 opening ceremony will include the largest number of flags from other lands in the history of our Fellowship, truly reflecting the Convention theme, "A.A. Everywhere—Anywhere."

The meetings will be larger, and some of the agenda topics will cover new material—amateur radio in our Fellowship, computer communications, and a host of foreign language presentations. But liberally sprinkled throughout the entire program will be the basic topics with which we are so familiar—"Twelfth Stepping the Old-fashioned Way," "Gratitude, a Full and Thankful Heart" and "Unity: Our Common Welfare."

And the goal of the 1995 International Convention will be the same as the first 1950 Convention—"Pass It On."

Julian Rhinehart, Pacific regional trustee

Reports from the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees and G.S.O.

These annual reports are submitted to each Conference—via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary, acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: Following the practice of the last several years, chairpersons of the General Service Conference Committees were invited to the quarterly trustees' meeting held at the end of January. The chairpersons attended sessions of the corresponding trustees' committees and were also invited to attend other meetings of the trustees, including the board meeting. The presence of the chairpersons at the January meetings is part of the sharing process that brings us to this room today.

Members of the General Service Board travel all over the United States and Canada attending meetings of areas, election assemblies, Regional Forums, board meetings and committee meetings, as well as planning meetings and subcommittee meetings. The goal of these activities is to carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous. Meetings cannot be ends in themselves; they must continue to be vehicles to enable the message of recovery in A.A. to be carried to the drunk who still suffers.

The 13th World Service Meeting was held in Cartagena, Colombia, last October with 38 delegates from 25 countries in attendance. The week of general sessions was characterized by energy and spirituality, accompanied by many expressions of gratitude, humility and affection. In the course of the week, the delegates seldom strayed from their primary purpose—how best to deliver the A.A. message. Their focus was clear and the sharing strengthened everyone in their resolve to do the best they could with what they have.

The Agenda Committee for the World Service Meeting recommended that "Love and Gratitude in Action" be the theme for the 1996 World Service Meeting to be held in New York. Each of the presentation/discussion topics to be included on the agenda for the 14th World Service Meeting focuses on how best to carry the A.A. message to the still-suffering alcoholic. The Traditions, especially those on Anonymity, are implicit in the topics chosen.

As I review 1994, a passage from *The Language of the Heart* (p. 322) comes to mind:

As we now enter upon the next great phase of AA's life, let us therefore rededicate ourselves to an even greater responsibility for our general welfare. Let us continue to take our inventory as a Fellowship, searching out our flaws and confessing them freely. Let us devote ourselves to the repair of all faulty relations that may exist, whether within or without.

And above all, let us remember that great legion who still suffer from alcoholism and who are still without hope. Let us, at any cost or sacrifice, so improve our communication with all these that they may find what we have found—a new life of freedom under God.

Once again our co-founder, Bill W., had seen into the future and said a prayer that we now repeat with hope, and we trust that together we can do what I alone or you alone cannot do.

The love and commitment to our Steps, Traditions and Concepts have supported and energized us as difficult matters were discussed. The same spirit and attitude were manifested at the last three Regional Forums in Boise, Idaho, in Eastern

Canada at Thunder Bay and in Biloxi, Mississippi. We have seen increasing participation from the regions in both the planning and conduct of the Forums. This, in my opinion, is both healthy and productive in furthering the goals of Regional Forums.

The year 1994 also saw the General Service Board and its active arms, the A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine Boards, involved in efforts to improve communication and resolve differences with Intergroup World Services (IWS), Inc. Toward the end of the year it was agreed that the board supported A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine in their efforts to resolve matters of mutual concern, including the sale of our Spanish language copyrighted material. The board asked Gary Glynn, Class A trustee, along with Ann Warner, Grapevine executive editor, and George Dorsey, the general manager of G.S.O., to meet with three people associated with IWS. The meeting took place early in 1995 and resulted in a better understanding. The spiritual foundation of our Three Legacies provided a positive thrust toward resolution beneficial to the total Fellowship. We will continue to stay in close communication with those involved and we continue to be optimistic, since we have infinitely more common ground than differences.

At all board weekends throughout the year, trustees met in committee and spent many hours on various projects. All trustees' Committee Reports were presented and accepted by the board.

In August, chairperson Jim Estelle welcomed the four new trustees, C. Peter Brock, William Bungay, Julian Rhinehart and Peter Roach, and extended our gratitude for having them with us.

Throughout the August board weekend, extensive dialogue took place regarding continued effort, energy and emphasis being put forth to improve communication between the chairpersons of the three corporate boards. This resulted in an understanding that all trustees will be included in the full disclosure of issues and conditions that might lead to a decision regarding litigation. We will make every reasonable effort to avoid litigation, short of abandoning our responsibility to preserve and protect our Fellowship, both from a fiduciary standpoint and from spiritual erosion.

The board approved the plan to reduce literature income, which included reducing the price of special needs items and selected recovery/service pamphlets; increasing the discount on pamphlets, miscellaneous items, and foreign literature; and reducing the level at which books receive a quantity discount (from 40 books to 20 books) as well as an additional 5% discount on all orders.

All members of the board received a proposed "action of censure," which generated long and thorough discussion. This grievance was referred to the trustees' Committee on the Conference. (Note: In action from the trustees' Committee on the Conference, the board approved forwarding the item to the Conference Committee on Trustees.)

In the past year Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees accepted awards on behalf of Alcoholics Anonymous. Past Class A trustee Joan Jackson accepted on behalf of the Fellowship an award given by the Crisis Intervention Program of Yale New Haven Hospital in Connecticut. The University of Utah School on Alcoholism and Other Drug Dependency presented an award to the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous as "one of the miracles of all times." Gary Glynn represented our Fellowship at the New Jersey Reformatory for Women in Clinton, where A.A. first started serving women in prison in the U.S., 50 years ago. The long form of our Eleventh Tradition says: "Our relations with the general public should be characterized by personal anonymity. We think A.A. ought to avoid sensational advertising. Our names and pictures as A.A. members ought not be broadcast, filmed, or

publicly printed. Our public relations should be guided by the principle of attraction, rather than promotion. There is never need to praise ourselves. We feel it better to let our friends recommend us." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 192)

We are very grateful for the compliments of our friends in Utah, Connecticut and New Jersey.

W. J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr., chairman

Note: Later in the Conference, Jim stated that, with the approval of the General Service Board and prior to his rotation, he would like to create an Ad Hoc Committee reflective of the composition of the General Service Conference to study all aspects, historical, spiritual and financial, of moving G.S.O. out of New York at the expiration of the current lease in 2,002.

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: A.A. World Services, Inc., is a wholly-owned subsidiary of the General Service Board. It has the delegated responsibility to maintain oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.) which provides group services, including printing and distribution of Conference-approved and other service literature. The board met nine times in 1994 to hear G.S.O. management and staff reports; review group services activity and progress on compliance with Conference and board recommendations; review budgets, expenditures, and salary policy; establish prices for literature and other materials; discuss publishing operations and matters of G.S.O. administration; consider requests from A.A.s and non-A.A.s for permission to reprint A.A. copyrighted literature; and address other matters as they arise.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors: currently, four are trustees, including two regional trustees; three are nontrustee directors; one is the G.S.O. general manager; and one is the staff coordinator. Also attending board meetings but not voting are other G.S.O. staff members, the controller, assistant controller/business administrator, the services director, and the secretary. In addition, a Grapevine staff member is usually present.

The committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Publishing, which addresses reprints, foreign literature and publications concerns; Finance and Administration, which concerns salary and budget, audit review, and retirement; Services, which addresses the needs of all service assignments; and Nominating. Long-range planning is done within each committee and by the board as a whole. For 1994 the following significant items are noted:

Finance: The committee reaffirmed the 1990 objectives of the board regarding self-support. Through its Salary and Budget Committee the board prepared, reviewed and recommended the 1995 G.S.O. budget to the trustees' Finance Committee. 1994 A.A. sales income for the year was down 4% or \$279,000 from 1993. 1994 non-A.A. sales income increased by 3.5% or \$82,300 over 1993. Non-A.A. sales represented 26.6% of our total sales in 1994, compared with 25% in 1993. The board approved the Retirement Committee recommendation for a 1% increase to be made in retirees' pensions from January 1, 1989 to January 1, 1995, with a minimum of \$20.00 per month. Those who retired in 1993 and 1994 were excluded from this increase. The board approved retaining the firm of Owen J. Flanagan and Company as our outside auditor and endorsed the general manager's proposal to utilize the services of an outside compensation consultant in 1995.

Only one permanent employee left in 1994. Although the International Convention, records conversion, and credit card services have created additional work, G.S.O. year-end count is

the same as the beginning of the year. Hiring part-time students from Barnard and Columbia has proven cost-efficient and productive. Total personnel costs were below budget and about the same level as 1993.

Literature prices: The board recommended to the trustees' Finance Committee that they rescind their directive to the A.A.W.S. Board that no literature item be priced below cost, and also rescind the policy of achieving a minimum gross margin on each literature item.

The A.A.W.S. Board recommended adoption of a repricing structure and presented it to the trustees' Finance Committee. As a result, literature discounts were increased by \$140,000 in 1994. In 1995 the effect will be a reduction in literature income of approximately \$1,000,000.

The board also discussed letters requesting reduction of literature prices. There are many factors to be looked into before additional price reductions can be considered, i.e., year-end results, information obtained as a result of increased discount and reduced prices, status of the Reserve Fund and anticipated increases in paper and warehouse costs. The literature pricing policy is reviewed on a continuing basis.

A suggestion that a two-tier pricing structure be implemented was considered not to be appropriate. Apart from it being discriminatory among the A.A. membership, it could raise legal issues.

The following new publications were priced: Correctional Facilities booklet (separate from the workbook); Spanish "Bridging the Gap"; Literature Committee Guidelines; and Public Information Workbook (soft cover). *Braille pamphlets:* "This Is AA," "Is AA For You?" and "44 Questions." *Foreign Language:* Ukrainian Big Book and "44 Questions," Turkish "Living Sober," Romanian "A Newcomer Asks" and Twelve & Twelve, Bulgarian "Living Sober," Lithuanian "Daily Reflections," Spanish pocket-size Big Book, and Hungarian "Come to Believe." The prices of the large-print editions of the Big Book and the Twelve and Twelve were reduced. Foreign books printed by our office will be reduced to the equivalent English price, effective March 28, 1995.

We discussed the proposal to settle with the recipients of our royalty payments which would end our legal obligation to pay royalties. After discussion, it was the consensus of the board that this would not be beneficial at this point in time.

Literature—Other: The suggestion that we publish a pocket version of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* was forwarded to the trustees' Literature Committee, with accompanying information for their consideration.

As the board has a working policy regarding translations of A.A. literature into Native American languages, we are open to receiving requests for assistance.

The committee's recommendation to translate the Big Book into Tagalog and Nepali was approved.

The request from Australia to apply \$2,000 for the World Service Meeting Literature Fund toward publishing basic recovery pamphlets in Aboriginal dialects was approved. Australia then returned the \$2,000 as they wished to be self-supporting.

We approved an advance of \$6,000 to cover the cost of the first printing of the Big Book in Portuguese. These funds came from the Translations and Other Literature Assistance Fund, and include the usual proviso regarding such assistance — that the inventory remains the property of A.A.W.S. until the total sum is repaid.

We granted permission/did not object to 85 requests to reprint from A.A. literature; 8 such requests were denied.

Effective June 15, we started accepting credit card payment for literature orders. Announcements went out to delegates and intergroups/central offices and a notice was included in the

mailings of literature order forms and in Box 4-5-9. The board agreed that the 800 FAX number be made available for credit card purchases to all purchasers of A.A. literature.

Guidelines for Carrying the Message to People with Special Needs are now available. A comprehensive survey of material for "Those With Special Needs," for example Braille, video and audio, is underway. We are reviewing what we have now and what additional material would be helpful. We are also looking at new technology to produce such material more effectively and/or economically and ways to communicate to the Fellowship exactly what material is available for "Those With Special Needs."

The board considered a request to produce the Twelve and Twelve in American Sign Language (ASL). Management will review how much use there has been for the Big Book which was produced in ASL two years ago, and how we might increase awareness of its availability. The board will then look into the costs of an ASL Twelve and Twelve.

The trustees' International Committee had suggested that G.S.O. develop a "cohesive record on all copyrights and licensing agreements through the world." Our Publications Department has completed the following research: Searching archives and "active" foreign G.S.O. files for licensing agreements and permissions given on behalf of A.A.W.S.; Creating master files on computer of copyrights and licensing agreements cross-referenced by: a) country b) language c) title of publication d) copyright. They will review and follow up with individual countries for gaps or inconsistencies.

Early in 1994, Great Britain proposed to reprint the original Concepts—what we describe as the Twelve Concepts (Long Form but without Bill's essays). This was to be followed by "The Twelve Concepts for Service in Great Britain" in order to reflect the corporate and service structure of Great Britain. After discussion at the January 27, 1994 board meeting, the board had no objection to their proceeding. We suggested that they consider using a short introduction or preface on the history of the Concepts and the reasons for their adaption for A.A. in Great Britain. They agreed to send us a draft of their final proposal before it went to their Conference.

We have received the final draft and after reviewing it, the board approved the request to reprint the Concepts (Long Form), as well as Bill W.'s Essays on the Concepts as they appear in *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service U.S./Canada*, and to adapt the Concepts (Long Form) to reflect the corporate requirements and difference in A.A. structure in Great Britain. We asked that they include the usual credit line/disclaimer.

Services: For over a year, the committee has been considering a video with accompanying service piece which would show ways that G.S.O. serves the Fellowship as a whole. It was recommended to the trustees' Literature Committee that this project be developed for consideration by the 1995 Conference. Background information was prepared for the trustees' Literature Committee.

International: The World Service Meeting was held in Cartagena, Colombia, October 9-13, 1994. The meetings were essentially informal and characterized by great mutual support, particularly for newer A.A. countries and those having some problems. As requested by the 1992 W.S.M., a report was given on the status of Foreign Literature Assistance Fund, which is supported by contributions from other countries. There was also discussion regarding A.A.W.S.' copyrights and licensing policy. The W.S.M. delegates unanimously accepted the report of their Literature Committee as follows:

"Copyrights were brought up under new business. It was felt

the literature of Alcoholics Anonymous belongs to A.A. as a whole and A.A.W.S., Inc. (U.S./Canada) holds these copyrights in trust for all of us. The committee recommended that A.A.W.S., Inc. should continue to grant exclusive licenses to one service structure per country. It was suggested that future W.S.M.s be kept aware of problems regarding copyrights in A.A."

In April, George Dorsey was invited to participate in a National Conference in Espoo, Finland. In attendance were 3,000 out of a total membership estimated at 5,500.

At the request of the Russian General Service Board, John Grant and trustees at-large Larry Nelson and David O'Leary (World Service Meeting delegates) attended the Sixth Russian General Service Conference in Petrozavodsk in May, to participate as observers and resource people. We are in a period of increased A.A. activity in Eastern Europe and are presently reprinting 5,000 copies of the Ukrainian *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* because of the high demand.

In June, Danny Mooney was invited by the General Service Board in Colombia to participate in their Sixth National Convention. The event drew over 2,500 A.A.s from all over Colombia, as well as other South American nations.

At the request of the Mexican General Service Board, David O'Leary and Danny Mooney accompanied members of the General Service Board, Mexico, to Cuba, where they met with members of the newly formed Cuban Service Board, and had two meetings with Cuban doctors and A.A. groups.

Other Board Actions: The general manager discussed quotes obtained for Directors and Officers Insurance for the General Service, Grapevine and Corporate Boards. The board approved a recommendation to the General Service Board that we obtain this coverage.

Ann Warner, Gary Glynn and George Dorsey met with three representatives of Intergroup World Services, Inc. (IWS) in January 1995. It was a cordial meeting, and although we did not always see eye to eye, there was an understanding on some important issues. After further communications following the meeting, an understanding was reached and reported to delegates, alternate delegates, intergroups/central offices, overseas G.S.O.s and World Service Meeting delegates.

G.S.O./Staff Operations: The Financial Reports are now system generated; Canadian sales tax data are captured by the system/comparative sales analysis and reports are produced; royalties are computed by sales and a report is generated; both A.A. and the Grapevine modem their orders to Kansas City, providing faster turn around time; 1099s are system generated; and the Tri-Annual Survey is completely computerized.

Functional changes have taken place for 1994; staff assistants were provided with PCs and a new Records system has been implemented.

We have been working on a solution for insuring the safety of archival materials and providing for efficient storage and retrieval of G.S.O. documentary information. This will be done by means of an imaging system with implementation to begin in 1995.

The new AS400 authorized this year has arrived and has been brought on-line. This will enable the staff to have access to group records, response time will be improved and memory capacity increased. The data processing room and personnel will move from the space they presently occupy on the 10th floor to the 11th floor and return the 10th floor space to the building. The cost of rewiring on the 11th floor may cancel out any savings for the first year; however, the move should generate savings of \$60,000 or more over the balance of the lease.

A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff members coordinated and attended the following Regional Forums in 1994: Western

Canada in Saskatoon, Saskatchewan; Special Forum in Hawaii on four islands; Pacific in Boise, Idaho; Eastern Canada in Thunder Bay; Southeast in Biloxi, Mississippi.

This seminar was held in Vancouver, B.C., November 11-13, 1994. The seminar provided an opportunity to address specific shipping and delivery and publications questions. Having representatives attend from A.A.W.S. and G.S.O. was very useful.

After looking at more than 35 resumes, Judit Santon was selected to fill the position of assistant archivist. She comes with excellent qualifications and recommendations from former employers and professional colleagues, and joined us on July 11.

We welcomed 1,219 visitors to G.S.O. in 1994. We had estimated the number of visitors to the office would decline when we moved from Midtown to a part of New York unfamiliar to most out-of-towners (as well as to many New Yorkers). However, that has not been the case and, in fact, the number of visitors to our office is increasing.

As of March 31, advance registrations for the International Convention were 30,013. We have budgeted for 60,000 participants. (Attendance at Seattle was 48,000.) We are hoping for 40,000 registrations by the May 15 cut-off date, and we are anticipating many on-site registrations by Southern California A.A.s.

Michael McPherson, chairperson

ARCHIVES

Trustees' committee: Our committee met four times since last year's General Service Conference. Judit Santon, assistant archivist, was welcomed by the committee. Judit has a valuable background gained at the State Technical Library in Budapest, Hungary.

The committee developed a Timeline exhibit unit, which will be displayed for the first time at the International Convention. This multi-paneled presentation of the important dates in A.A. history will be placed in a highly visible location at the Convention. Additionally, a small reproduction of the exhibit has been suggested as a "give away" to Convention goers. Smaller adaptations of this item could be made available for use at Forums, conventions and other A.A. activities.

At the suggestion of an area delegate, a subcommittee examined our present policy on not photocopying for distribution the personal correspondence of our members. After considerable study and discussion, it was the unanimous opinion of the committee to retain this restriction in light of the expectancy of confidentiality by the writer of the correspondence, our Traditions of Anonymity, and other considerations such as the flourishing market for correspondence relating to A.A. matters and members.

The committee approved a plan to hold two Archival Workshops, entitled Archives: A Collective Vision, at the International Convention. One, planned for Friday, June 30, at 3:00 p.m., will be chaired by John King; the other, on Saturday, July 1, at 9:30 a.m., will be chaired by David O'Leary, vice-chairman of the trustees' Archives Committee. For both workshops, regional trustees have been asked to select participants. It is expected that Gordon Patrick and Michael Alexander, past General Service Board chairmen, will participate in these workshops.

The committee approved a Conference Archives Committee Scope and Procedure for submission to the 1995 General Service Conference Policy and Admissions Committee. It was suggested that this new committee be patterned after the Conference International Conventions Committee, which constitutes a "second assignment" for selected delegates.

A scanner has been ordered for the G.S.O. Archives, and plan-

ning has begun for its utilization in archival document protection and access.

John King, chairperson

Archivist's report: Happily, interest within our Fellowship in things archival and willingness to serve that interest abounds; witness the fact that over 40 applications were received for a possible position of appointed committee person for the trustees' Archives Committee. The quantity of the volunteers, together with the quality and variety of their experiences, caused our committee to rethink the parameters of that position. One possibility being considered is that, rather than having a single individual appointed for the entire term, a selection might be made based on specific needs during discussions that address topics in which special experience would be useful.

Our Group Birthdate undertaking is proceeding quietly. A relatively small fraction of our overall group list has responded by supplying corrected dates from their records or the memories of earlytimers. This could mean that the dates initially supplied from our files were largely accurate. Quite a few area archivists are actively examining their group birthdates and developing a scheme of how A.A. grew in their area.

At mid-year, Judit Santon joined Noela Jordan and myself in our three-person department as assistant archivist. Judit has been documenter/editor at the National Technical Information Center and Library in Budapest, the largest such center in Hungary; she is also a graduate of Pratt Institute, Library and Information Department. Along with other duties, Judit will lead us into the electronic age when we obtain our scanner.

In early fall, an impassioned earlytimer (from 1947), Joe H., gathered a small collection of archival firebrands and led them on a forced march, retracing Bill W.'s daily commute from his home on Clinton Street in Brooklyn to the first "headquarters" of Works Publishing on William Street, Newark, New Jersey. Two local historians, one from New Jersey, the other from Brooklyn, and a video camera expert were also members of this group. Small crowds would gather around us in downtown Newark, perhaps thinking we were part of an advanced crew for a sequel to Woody Allen's "Bullets Over Broadway." In all, it was great fun to relive Bill's daily sojourn under the guidance of a Newark native A.A.

We obtained a remarkable oral history from Lib S., past G.S.O. staff member (1951 to late 1962), which encompassed some of the more turbulent years historically for our Fellowship. Lib started work on May 1st right after the first General Service Conference. Bill had postponed her starting date, in his judgment, to avoid losing Lib amidst the din of that event. She retained a deep resentment for "the lost dramatic moment in A.A. history." Lib, sober since 1945, was to marry her sponsor, to the horror of her A.A. peers. That marriage has lasted all these years. One of the *raison d'être* for both the Conference and G.S.O. was to expedite the sharing of information from areas where things were going well to areas where things might be going poorly. She quoted Bill as saying, "A.A. is a kindergarten designed to knock off our rough edges to render us suitable for polite society."

I'm happy to be part of this kindergarten called Alcoholics Anonymous.

Frank Mauser

CONFERENCE

Trustees' committee: The committee met three times since the 1994 General Service Conference, reviewed the 1994 Advisory

Actions pertaining to the General Service Conference, and approved the theme for the 45th General Service Conference, "Pass It On—Our Three Legacies." We approved revisions to the service piece summary of "How the General Service Conference Operates," which can be used for reference during voting on Conference Committee reports. Also approved were revisions to the 1995 Conference Questionnaire, including a question as to whether the Conference theme and workshop/presentation topics were useful for sharing in pre-Conference assemblies, area conferences, etc.

We agreed to include the Wednesday morning sharing session on the 1995 Conference Agenda, and also agreed that the trustees' Conference Committee evaluate this sharing session next year and discuss whether or not to include it on the 1996 Agenda. A question as to its value is included in the 1995 Conference Questionnaire.

We also reviewed proposed agenda items submitted for the 1995 Conference and referred them, when appropriate, to the standing Conference Committee, G.S.O. or the General Service Board. All proposed agenda items were addressed and a letter of explanation sent to the originator of each agenda item. The committee reviewed and finalized the Conference Agenda, assigning participants for the various presentations.

Ann Bruning, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the contact for General Service Conference members. The General Service Conference is a year-long process and the Conference coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates in a cooperative effort to make the annual meeting of the Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator's desk also is the contact for area and district committee members and past delegates of the 91 areas throughout the U.S. and Canada.

The General Service Conference, created in 1951 by our co-founders Dr. Bob S. and Bill W., became, in July of 1955, the "guardian of the Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous, the perpetuator of the world services of our Society, the voice of the group conscience of our entire Fellowship, and the sole successor of its co-founders, Dr. Bob and Bill."

All A.A. members are asked, through the area committees, to submit items for the Conference to address. These are brought to the trustees' Committee on the Conference for consideration and referral to the appropriate committee. The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics, which are then reviewed for selection by the Conference Agenda Committee and recommended to the trustees' Committee on the Conference for approval.
- Serving as secretary for both the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Working with the general manager and G.S.O. staff in planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and all material for the Conference Manual, Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.
- Reviewing all area and district newsletters, as well as minutes and reports received from area and district committee meetings and assemblies.

Valerie O'Neill

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community met three times since the last General Service Conference. Our service is based on A.A.'s primary purpose, Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts for World Service. Our focus is on assisting local C.P.C. Committees in providing A.A. information to professionals in contact with the still-suffering alcoholic.

The following Advisory Actions of the 1994 General Service Conference were implemented: The rewritten pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate With Professionals" was published last fall; the policy on distribution of A.A. confidential directories was changed so that G.S.O. no longer provides these directories outside of the Fellowship; a final draft of the rewritten C.P.C. Workbook was completed, along with a revised list of contents for the complete Workbook Kit; and Guidelines for the traveling C.P.C. exhibits, written by the 1994 Conference C.P.C. Committee, were approved.

The committee accepted the recommendation of a subcommittee that the 1995 Conference C.P.C. Committee consider the need for rewriting and retitling the leaflet "Alcoholics Anonymous and Employee Assistance Programs."

New panel designs for the traveling C.P.C. exhibits were installed last year and have been well received. After evaluating the impact of the new panels, which are less expensive than earlier designs, the committee recommended to the General Service Board that the A.A. World Services' Board purchase sets of panels for sale to local committees.

The 1994 schedule of 40 exhibits at national meetings of professional groups was completed successfully. Members of the committee and/or local C.P.C. chairpersons made presentations to several professional gatherings as well as to several university schools on alcoholism. The 1995 schedule of exhibits is moving forward with the full cooperation of local C.P.C. committees.

A committee member, joined by another trustee and the Spanish services staff person, responded to an invitation to visit with professionals in Cuba, where A.A. presence is expanding.

Twenty-eight resumes were submitted by members qualified to serve as an appointed committee member. After interviews, one person was selected and approved by the trustees' Nominating Committee.

John Hartley Smith, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: The purpose of Cooperating With the Professional Community is to provide A.A. information to individuals and groups who may be in contact with the still-suffering alcoholic in their professional capacities. The C.P.C. staff person serves as a link to all C.P.C. committees in Canada and the U.S., and shares background and other information with A.A.s overseas on request. Currently, we communicate with more than 405 area, district and intergroup/central office C.P.C. committees through the chairperson. When we learn of a new C.P.C. committee, the chairperson is sent a letter of welcome and background information. C.P.C. Workbooks are sent to incoming area C.P.C. chairpersons, and are available to all others through the literature catalog. The staff member on the C.P.C. desk serves as secretary to the trustees' and Conference C.P.C. Committees.

Over the last year, we received hundreds of inquiries from nurses, physicians, attorneys, teachers, members of the clergy, social workers, alcoholism counselors, professionals working with mentally or physically disadvantaged people, employers, therapists, organizations involved in the treatment or preven-

tion of alcohol abuse, court officials and others. Each professional received a personal response, and most were put in touch with a local committee chairperson.

Periodically, C.P.C. news is carried in *Box 4-5-9*, and usually includes information from one or more local committees. *About A.A.* is mailed out two or three times a year to professionals who ask to be on this mailing list, now numbering over 17,000. The Fall/Winter issue featured "Singleness of Purpose Unites Over Two Million A.A. Members." The Spring issue focuses on talks about A.A. by two psychiatrists.

The staff person coordinates the traveling C.P.C. exhibits for national gatherings of professional associations, where local committees staff our exhibit booths. An increasing number of local C.P.C. committees are purchasing portable exhibits for use at these national meetings, as well as for A.A. exhibits at local or statewide events sponsored by professional organizations. Often the C.P.C., P.I., Treatment and Correctional Facilities committees will share use of a portable exhibit.

Joanie Moncrief

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities is to recommend actions that support carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics in correctional facilities. One of the tools for this purpose is distribution of literature. Our efforts in the past year have been to get area and local committees involved in responding to requests from inmates and corrections staff for information about A.A. literature, outside meeting assistance, and prerelease contacts.

The committee responded to the request of the 1994 Conference Committee to thoroughly review the Correctional Facilities Workbook and has submitted two reports for the consideration of the 1995 Conference Correctional Facilities Committee. Also forwarded is a report written as the result of suggestions from area C.F. committee chairpersons in connection with A.A. service in juvenile detention facilities.

During the past year we also began cooperating with the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee to help provide literature and local staffing for exhibits at the national conference of corrections organizations. Local C.F. and C.P.C. chairs were enthusiastic about the results and we plan to continue the effort this year.

We have forwarded to A.A.W.S. Publications a proposal to offer local C.F. committees an additional and larger prison discount package, which many committees buy to furnish literature supplies for groups on the inside. The new package, which will have 20 or more copies of several pamphlets, will sell for about \$30.00, or just about at cost.

A subcommittee considered ways we might offer local committees help in encouraging A.A. members to get involved in carrying the A.A. message inside the walls. We have forwarded, for the Conference Committee's consideration, a proposal to develop an audio cassette for this purpose.

Finally, the committee is developing a letter to be sent out this year to wardens in the U.S. and Canada to provide information about A.A. and its service work in correctional facilities.

John N. Chappel, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: The Correctional Facilities assignment is responsible for carrying the message of Alcoholics Anonymous to those alcoholics confined in correctional institutions.

This assignment receives an average of 400 letters a month from inmates, most asking for free literature, some asking for names of outside A.A. members with whom to correspond, or for help in making contact with A.A. upon release. We try to facilitate many of these requests, primarily through our network of area, district and local Correctional Facilities committees. Many of the requests have been for Big Books to use in substance abuse classes. We respond that we can give quantity discounts to the administration if they are buying material. We also ask area Correctional Facilities committees to help determine literature needs for "inside" A.A. groups. Even with these reservations, we did send out 8,255 units of complimentary literature in 1994 at a cost of \$5,664.88.

The Corrections Correspondence Service is coordinated by this desk, and we are concerned about the continuing need for outside A.A. members to correspond with inmates. We have offered this service for years but we currently have a waiting list of more than 100 inmates who have not been "hooked up" with outside members. On the other hand, area Correctional Facilities chairpersons have become more involved in helping us to find volunteers, for which we are grateful.

As the prison population expands and the number of alcohol-related crimes continues to increase, the General Service Board and Conference and local Correctional Facilities committees are truly on the front line of carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics who are still suffering.

Richard Bush

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' committee: Last year, I reported that "Contributions, Sales of Literature, and Circulation at the A.A. Grapevine were weak in 1993, continuing the trend of the past three years." This year, I am able to report that our financial health is somewhat better.

Contributions in 1994 were approximately \$3,855,500—an increase of 0.8%, approximately \$47,000 over those received during 1993. This increase reverses a trend of three years of declining contributions. Of the 55,200 registered groups, we received contributions from approximately 25,300, or 45.8% during 1994. This works out to about \$152.00 per contributing group.

Literature sales for the year amounted to approximately \$9,637,000 before discounts allowed. This was approximately \$86,000 less than the prior year and approximately \$800,000 ahead of budget. Based on the history of the past several years we had expected to again have declining unit values. This did not occur however and, in fact, total units of books and booklets sold in 1994 exceeded 1993's total by approximately 14,000. During 1994, G.S.O. sold 118,000 copies of the pocket edition of the Big Book compared with 99,000 in 1993, or approximately 19,000 more.

During 1994, A.A.W.S. was able to recommend, and the General Service Board approve, \$1 million worth of reductions in our prices of selected A.A. literature. This is described more fully in other reports you will hear during this Conference, primarily aimed at helping you carry the message as you requested last year at the Conference. Total G.S.O. Revenues, that is Gross Profit from Literature Sales plus Contributions, fell approximately \$83,000 or just under one percent.

In addition to reducing prices on selected recovery material, discounts allowed on all items were increased. Discounts for the

year were approximately \$547,000, \$170,000 higher than budgeted and \$140,000 higher than the previous year. Due to a strong Reserve Fund, and tight controls on expenditures, we were able to institute these price decreases.

Operating expenses are still under control. Total Operating Expenses for the year were approximately \$7,650,000, some \$20,000 higher than 1993.

Net income for the year is \$606,000, compared with \$71,000 last year. This reduction in income was due primarily to allowing price reductions and discounts on literature sales.

Turning to the service side of the equation, the cost of providing services to the Fellowship, excluding publishing activities, was \$5,365,000 in 1994, approximately \$106,000 (2%) higher than in 1993. This amount exceeded contributions by approximately \$1,506,000, a difference that was made up by literature profits. As was reported last year, we have instituted new reporting formats and procedures that present a better picture of how much services and publishing actually cost and allows the reader of the financial statements to see where the money is going. The \$5,365,000 incurred for services represent approximately \$98.00 for each registered group.

Last year's service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services, 47%; Public Information, 4%; C.P.C., 4%; Treatment Facilities, 1%; Correctional Facilities, 4%; Loners, Internationalists, and Overseas Services, 10%; the General Service Conference, 13%; Regional Forums, 4%; Archives, 6%; and trustees'/directors' expenses, 7%.

An interesting fact here is that after allocating every expense we could to specific activities, we found that approximately 32% of our total office expense goes to areas that support both publishing and services. These are internal support services like accounting, personnel, some data processing, office management, clerical pool, mailroom, and so forth, which publishing and services share. These expenses are allocated to specific activities in proportion to total direct expenses.

The G.S.O. Budget for 1995 was prepared on the assumption that book sales might decline by approximately 3%. The most significant decline in units is expected in the pocket Big Book as it goes through its life cycle from first introduction, to a settling out, to a normal level of sales. Gross Margin from literature has been budgeted to decline by approximately 17%. This is primarily due to the reduction of selected literature prices as well as the increase in discounts allowed.

Contributions for 1995 are budgeted to be approximately one percent higher than in 1994. Both projections of sales and contributions take recent trends into account. Total revenue will likely decline by approximately 12%, or almost \$1,000,000. Operating costs are budgeted to rise somewhat less than 5%, including approximately 3½% for salaries and increases in postage that affect everyone. The budget shows an operating deficit of approximately \$730,000. This deficit will be offset by drawing down interest and principle from the Reserve Fund. The 1995 Budget allows for maintaining the current level of services while at the same time reducing literature prices.

The Reserve Fund equalled \$10,484,000 at the end of 1994, \$1,228,700 of which was held for the account of the A.A. Grapevine for subscription liabilities, leaving \$9,255,300 as the principle amount. The Reserve Fund earned approximately \$545,000 in 1994, net of the A.A. Grapevine share, and received transfers of \$700,000 from A.A.W.S. and \$67,250 from the A.A. Grapevine. After allowing for transfers to the Reserve Fund of G.S.O.'s 1994 net income of approximately \$605,000, and a portion of the A.A. Grapevine's income not needed to bring their liability account up to standard, the Reserve Fund would equal approximately 13.3 months of com-

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 1995

	Groups	Members
United States	49,443	1,127,471
Canada	5,133	95,546
Correctional facilities	2,085	50,983 ¹
Internationalists		154
Lone members		359
Total	56,661	1,274,513
Outside U.S. & Canada	32,578	516,015 ²
Total	89,239	1,790,528

1. U.S. and Canada only.

2. G.S.O. has records for 40 foreign G.S.O.s, as well as individual groups in 111 countries that do not have a general service office. We attempt to contact all general service offices outside the U.S. and Canada annually. Groups are contacted in countries where there is no G.S.O. Last year, of the 40 foreign G.S.O.s, 18 responded with updated figures. Of the 22 remaining foreign G.S.O.s, figures used for 18 of them are from their last previous response, while 4 have not forwarded any membership figures. Since we cannot substantiate the international figures, no attempt is made to estimate membership figures for the countries not responding.

The estimated group counts in the U.S. and Canada include only those that ask to be listed at G.S.O.; thousands do not.

Among listed groups in the U.S. and Canada, many do not report membership figures. For each nonreporting group, an estimate of membership is arrived at by taking an average among reporting groups within the Conference area concerned. Even among reporting groups, membership figures include only those now active and attending meetings; there is no way to count sober members who no longer have a home group.

In 1994, it was determined that A.A. meetings (which do not consider themselves groups) will no longer be included in the General Service Office database. In the past, meetings were included in the total number of groups shown in the directories. Although current figures indicate a decrease in the number of groups, 3,056 new groups were registered at G.S.O. during the year.

bined operating expenses. Moving forward and reviewing the expected results of the 1995 Budget, the Reserve Fund at the end of 1995 is expected to be approximately 12 months of operating expenses. The Reserve Fund currently amounts to \$169 per registered group.

Please remember that during 1993 the method of calculating the number of months of combined operating expenses that had been used since 1977 was revised. The difference between the two methods is that the new method excludes direct shipping and warehousing costs from operating expenses, while the old method included them. This change makes our Reserve Fund look about one month higher than it would be under the old method. With the old accounting system, it was impractical to exclude direct shipping and warehousing from other expenses. Under either method the Reserve Fund is very healthy.

In 1994 the A.A. Grapevine realized lower revenue in both magazine subscription income and other publishing item income. Circulation at the end of 1994 was approximately 120,300 copies, compared with 121,400 at the end of 1993 and the 1994 budgeted circulation of 123,000 copies. Total Gross Profit for the year was \$1,163,000, approximately \$108,000 below 1993—approximately 8%.

Total cost and expenses were \$1,320,700, approximately

\$35,000 or 3% higher than the prior year. Net Loss for the year after interest income was \$81,630, compared with an excess of income in 1993 of approximately \$67,990. For 1995 the A.A. Grapevine Budget assumes average circulation of approximately 123,000. The Gross Profit Percentage of the magazine is expected to drop by approximately one percentage point due to higher production costs, largely paper and postage increases. Total dollars of magazine gross profit is approximately the same as 1994. Other Publishing Income is also budgeted to be approximately the same in 1995. Total gross profit for the year is expected at \$1,139,900, compared with \$1,163,000 in 1994.

Total costs and expenses are projected at \$1,329,800, compared with \$1,292,000 in 1994, or \$38,000 or 3% higher than 1994. Loss from operations is estimated at \$189,900 and a loss after interest income earned is projected at \$109,700, compared with an \$82,000 loss after interest earned in 1994.

The A.A. Grapevine Board recommended a price increase for the magazine during 1995. The trustees' Finance Committee requested this increase be deferred pending the results of circulation efforts that are being currently undertaken based on suggestions received from the circulation consultant during 1994. Forgoing the price increase will increase the Grapevine's loss from operations by \$66,500 in 1995. Both the Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee recognize that eventually the price of the Grapevine will have to increase because of higher paper, postage, and other costs.

Gary Glenn, chairperson

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: The three General Sharing Sessions since the last General Service Conference discussed issues of specific interest to the board and the Fellowship.

"Anonymity and the Public Perception of Alcoholics Anonymous" was the topic during the July Sharing Session. Richard Bush, G.S.O. staff, opened by saying that he hoped the focus on anonymity would continue, as anonymity is still of the greatest importance to the future of Alcoholics Anonymous. He hoped that we do not become overly concerned or worry about the public perception of A.A., but rather try to help the public understand that there is a difference between anonymity and secrecy. We might even want to talk about anonymity from the historical standpoint as well as its spiritual significance. It causes a tremendous pull within us to see our Fellowship being discussed in the context of controversy—much like opening the door to a family argument.

Richard Roughton, A.A.W.S. director, wondered if many of us might be unaware of how A.A. is received from outside, because we in the Fellowship place a high value on Traditions that encourage A.A. to remain separate, distinct and apart so that we might remain focused on our primary purpose. We do, in keeping with our principles, tend to hold ourselves apart in a world in which organizations pay professionals to create a "correct" image. Yes, we have our public information work, but we are not out there aggressively seeking to shape and form a public perception. We are more inclined to focus upon our internal workings and our shared understanding of how we help one another.

October's board weekend's sharing session was on "Corporate Poverty and the Seventh Tradition (Spiritual and Practical Principles that Assure A.A.'s Future)."

Gary Glynn, Class A trustee, shared that in A.A., "spiritual" and "practical" are the same thing. Anything that is going to be

of any practical use to us has to be spiritual as well. At the same time, beginning with Bill W., A.A. quickly dropped any spiritual sounding ideas that didn't pass the practical tests of keeping alcoholics sober and keeping A.A. together. Is corporate poverty a spiritual and practical principle that would assure A.A.'s future? Of course it is. A strong Reserve Fund is one of the prices we have to pay to assure that no one but the Fellowship sets our financial policies. Continuous debate over whether or not the Reserve Fund is perilously large is part of that price.

Gerry Flegel, Class B trustee, spoke about A.A. being a not-for-profit service entity, with our sole reason for existence being to serve the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous. "I don't think we have a secondary mission of any kind," Gerry said, "and the Fellowship we serve has as its goal 'to solve their common problem, and help others to recover from alcoholism.' I believe," Gerry continued, "that as long as we rely on our own resources and strengths (and dollars), we will experience more and more difficulties. And I believe that it is only to the extent that we place trust and faith in the source of our being, that we will experience unity and harmony and peace. That source of power for us is the A.A. groups. They are, at the very least, the vehicle of communication for any Higher Power that we envisage for ourselves."

Sharing from the gathered trustees, directors, staff and guests included many comments, a few of which include: Spirituality will allow A.A. to continue into the future. The principles which are the basis of our society will bring us through in the long run. We are like the duck in a windstorm with feathers ruffled, but paddling (invisibly) below the water. Not enough money can also be a distraction. We are committed to poverty within the framework of where we find ourselves.

At the January sharing session John Grant, Vinnie McCarthy and David O'Leary addressed the subject "Carrying the Message—Our International Commitment." John Grant explained that the Overseas assignment at G.S.O. deals with 140 countries outside the U.S.A./Canada. This assignment also facilitates requests for translations and literature assistance. Until 1990, the U.S./Canada structure underwrote the entire cost of foreign literature assistance; however, at the 1990 World Service Meeting an International Literature Fund was established to help defray these expenses. The Big Book is now available in twenty-nine languages and numerous other books and pamphlets are available in a variety of languages.

Vinnie McCarthy, director, G.S.O. Publications Department, pointed out that our Archives files reveal that the first Europeans to translate the Big Book were in Norway and, as is the case in so many other instances, Bill's thinking on the subject continues to guide the Fellowship today. As A.A. General Service Offices in foreign lands developed and a service structure was put in place, these offices were able to handle their own translation needs, but U.S. and Canada still provided (as we do today) some financial assistance in helping them print the initial copies of their books.

In the mid-80s, the trustees' International Committee initiated translations of our basic recovery pamphlets for foreign language groups that were arriving en masse into the United States: Arabic, Cambodian, Chinese, Korean and Vietnamese, as well as pamphlets in Russian for small communities on the East and West coasts of the U.S.

Since July 1989, when 5,000 copies of *Alcoholics Anonymous* in Russian came off press, our office has produced: The Big Book in twelve languages, The Twelve & Twelve in seven, *Living Sober* in four, and an assortment of the basic recovery pamphlets in fourteen languages, with more planned for the future. Today, A.A. literature can reach more than one and

one half billion people, speaking 29 languages.

Trustee David O'Leary said that a trustees' committee has been formed to explore ways in which the General Service Board and/or the General Service Office might assist in the growth of A.A. worldwide. The committee has the responsibility of suggesting to the trustees policies and actions which will result in carrying the message to alcoholics overseas, particularly in countries where there is no established service structure. It is also a focal point for information about A.A. around the world, and a link between the World Service Meeting and the General Service Board.

The International Literature Monetary Fund demonstrates the recognition of A.A.s everywhere, and that the responsibility to meet the need for A.A. literature is one that all A.A.s share. It gives us an opportunity to participate in this work as our means allow. We sometimes believe we are a big Fellowship. If two percent of the world population suffers from alcoholism, estimates are that 160,000,000 need this program.

Larry Nelson led the sharing session that followed. Some of the comments: Drunks continue to find other drunks. A.A. members share and new A.A. groups begin. Early in our own history the message was carried by traveling salesmen. Now the message continues to be carried around the world by clergy, military and business travelers. Around the world A.A.s communicate their gratitude for the wonders God as we understand Him has wrought in us.

Larry Nelson, chairperson

GROUP SERVICES

Staff report: The Group Services coordinator is responsible for service material distributed throughout the Fellowship. Developed because of an indicated need, the purpose of this material is to provide information and share experience not found in Conference-approved literature. A descriptive four-page list describes the items in detail. Examples of service material include: A.A. Guidelines; Regional Forum Reports; Referral List of Fellowships Similar to A.A.; Special Needs items, such as information about A.A. literature in Braille and on audiocassettes and special literature for deaf alcoholics.

Current ongoing projects involving Group Services:

- Coordination and production of three A.A. Directories: Eastern U.S., Western U.S. and Canadian. The staff member on Group Services works closely with the Special Projects manager regarding group printouts to areas and central/intergroup offices' records.
- Supervision of G.S.O. Service files. There is a variety of service material available, upon request, to A.A. members, groups, and for service workshops.
- Supervision/production of service material such as A.A. Guidelines, Group Handbooks, and G.S.R. kits.
- Liaison with intergroup/central offices, including serving on the Policy and Site Committees of the Intergroup Seminar, which will next take place in Atlanta, Georgia, October 5-8, 1995.
- Participant on Office Procedures Committee, which is concerned with the processing and dissemination of information to the Fellowship.

The staff member on Group Services also serves as secretary for the trustees' Nominating Committee and the Conference Committee on Trustees, in addition to handling correspondence and inquiries from the Northeast Region.

Lois Fisher

INTERNATIONAL/WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' committee: The International Committee serves as a link between the General Service Board and the World Service Meeting. It has the responsibility of developing policies enabling the A.A. message to be carried to alcoholics overseas, especially in countries where there is no service structure.

World Service Meeting—The Thirteenth World Service Meeting was held in Cartagena, Colombia, October 9-13, 1994, with 38 delegates from 25 countries in attendance. The theme was "Back to Basics." Many items were discussed at the committee meetings, including the issues of copyrights and licensing procedures. The Literature/Publications Committee recommended that A.A.W.S. continue to grant exclusive licenses to only one service structure in each country. Granting licenses to two entities in a single country could weaken A.A. unity in that country. It was suggested that future World Service Meetings be kept aware of problems regarding A.A. copyrights.

Foreign Literature Assistance—The committee reviewed the 1995 foreign literature budget of \$160,560. Some translations included in the budget are: Armenian, Czech, Hungarian, Nepali, Tagalog, Bulgarian, Portuguese, Hindi, Turkish and Lithuanian. Some of the expenses for these translations are being underwritten by the International Literature Fund, which was established in 1990 at the World Service Meeting in Munich, Germany.

Overseas Information—John Grant, Overseas staff person, Larry Nelson, trustee-at-large/U.S., and I attended the Sixth General Service Conference in Petrozavodsk, Russia, May 20-22, 1994. We also attended the General Service Board Meeting at the conclusion of the conference, and had some very constructive sharing with their board members regarding literature and the Traditions, Concepts, etc.

At the request of the Mexican General Service Board, Danny Mooney (Spanish Services staff person) and I visited Cuba, July 10-17, 1994, with members of the Mexican General Service Board to help carry the A.A. message to A.A.s and professionals throughout the country. Our trip was quite fruitful and a subsequent trip is planned for 1995. Needless to say, A.A. is needed desperately in Cuba and is growing at a very fast pace. Trustees from the General Service Board in Mexico have been visiting Cuba for the last couple of years, bringing A.A. literature and sharing the A.A. program with all interested.

A.A. continues to grow in Eastern Europe and in the former Republics of the Soviet Union. We are constantly receiving translations of A.A. literature from these countries, and do our best to publish as many of them as possible. This is a very exciting time for A.A. around the world, and there is much work to be accomplished in carrying our message to the alcoholic who still suffers in the far corners of the globe.

David O'Leary, chairperson

Staff report: Correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries without a service center or office is answered by the staff member on this assignment. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 39 general service offices and literature distribution centers outside the U.S. and Canada.

Coordinating the biennial World Service Meeting is an absorbing aspect of this assignment. The primary purpose of the World Service Meeting is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers, anywhere in the world. The W.S.M. seeks ways of accomplishing these goals by sharing the experience, strength and hope of delegates who come together every two

years from all parts of the world. "Love and Gratitude in Action" will be the theme for the next World Service Meeting, to be held October 27-31, 1996, in New York City.

The European and Ibero-American Service Meetings are also held biennially, alternating with World Service Meetings. These meetings provide an opportunity to share experience for countries not yet able to participate in World Service Meetings. The staff member on this assignment is often invited to participate in these meetings. The first Pan-Pacific Service Meeting will be held in March 1995 in Japan, coinciding with the 20th anniversary of A.A. in Japan. This new meeting will explore ways to best carry the A.A. message in that region.

To ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message, careful consideration is given prior to granting permission to print A.A. literature in various languages. Translations are reviewed and, if found to be satisfactory, the means of financing are explored. The request for permission to print or reprint is then presented to the A.A. World Services Board. The staff member on this assignment serves as the intermediary for translations of A.A. literature.

Since the last General Service Conference, *The Big Book*, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, has been published in Ukrainian, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* in Romanian, *Came to Believe* in Hungarian, *Daily Reflections* in Lithuanian and *Living Sober* in Bulgarian and Turkish. There were also numerous pamphlets translated into a variety of languages.

The staff member oversees the updating of the International A.A. Directory, which can be used by traveling A.A. members to find meetings and also can be used as a useful tool for Twelve Stepping.

John Grant

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION/ A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' committee:

International Convention—Since the last Conference, the committee approved the 1995 Convention Program, with the understanding that some last-minute additions or adjustments might be needed. We accepted the list of non-A.A. speakers for the Convention panels and reviewed formats for the Big Meetings, recommending that they be as follows:

Friday Night

- Following the Flag Ceremony, the Pacific Regional trustee will introduce any special guests as a group (seated on the dais), and then introduce the chairman of the board.
- The chairman of the board will say a few words and introduce, as a group, the General Service Board (seated on the dais). He will then acknowledge corporate board directors, past and present trustees, past and present delegates, G.S.O. people, members of the Host Committee, Al-Anon members who are present, and "all trusted servants gathered here tonight."
- The Pacific Regional trustee will chair the A.A. meeting, which will begin with a sobriety countdown in five-year counts up to 40 years, and in one-year counts thereafter. There will be three speakers: one from the U.S., one from Canada, and one from another country.

Saturday Night

- The general manager of G.S.O., with the help of an assistant, will chair the Saturday night Oldtimers Meeting of members with forty or more years of sobriety. (These members will either

be seated on the dais or seated together in the front rows of the stadium, depending on the number.)

- Names of speakers will be pulled "out of the hat." There will be a time limit imposed, with a bell to keep things moving along.

Sunday Morning

- The chair of the trustees' International Convention Committee will open the meeting, and then introduce the Host Committee chair.

- The Host Committee chair will say a few words, then turn the meeting back to the chair of the trustees' International Convention Committee, who will chair the closing A.A. meeting.

The committee recommended inviting to the Convention the following special guests, who are surviving links to our co-founders: Sue Windows, Bob Smith, John Seiberling, Nell Wing, Dorothy (Williams) Culver, Ellie Norris and Dennis Manders, together with a spouse/guest each.

We also discussed several times whether the Convention badge cover should include the letters "A.A." and accepted the suggestion that "A.A." not appear anywhere on the badge covers. The committee reviewed and accepted the list of speakers for the Friday and Sunday Big Meetings.

Regional Forums—Since the last Conference there have been three Regional Forums in the Pacific, Eastern Canada and Southeast. All were reported to be productive and lively.

To gain a better perspective of who attends the Forums, the committee has examined the breakdown of attendance figures by area. It was not surprising to note that the farther away an area was from the Forum site, the fewer the participants from that area. In view of this, it was suggested that consideration be given to inviting neighboring areas outside the Forum host area. As in the past, at least 75% of attendees were attending a Regional Forum for the first time.

This past year we scheduled fewer presentations, to allow for a less structured agenda; this provided a more relaxed atmosphere that seems to have worked well. Also, to keep the program moving and to avoid getting bogged down on one or two items, a bell was tried at the Southeast Regional Forum. This gesture failed, however—most often with board members and delegates!—but it did contribute to a light moment from time to time. Maybe we'll try again in the future.

A Special Forum is scheduled for Western New York, but at the time of this writing has not taken place. The agenda, developed by the area delegate and Forum coordinator and tailored specifically to the needs of the area, focuses on how the groups relate to the service structure and to A.A. as a whole. Other topics include unity, leadership and the Seventh Tradition.

1995		
March 31—April 1	Special Forum	Buffalo, NY
May 12, 13	Special Forum	Alma, Quebec
August 11, 12, 13	Northeast	W. Springfield, MA
August 25, 26, 27	West Central	Sioux City, IA
Sept. 29—Oct. 1	East Central	Milwaukee, WI
December 1, 2, 3	Southwest	San Antonio, TX

Les Leuthaeuser, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Convention—The International Convention assignment entails coordinating the myriad details involved in producing the A.A. International Conventions, held every five years. Working with four committees — Trustees, Conference,

G.S.O. Planning and Host — the International Convention coordinator is responsible for bringing the Convention to life and ensuring that thousands of A.A.s can share and celebrate A.A.'s anniversary.

The 1995 Convention, in San Diego, June 29-July 2, will be a wonderful event, with meetings, meetings, meetings, panels, workshops, marathons, mini-marathons and stadium events. Events begin on Thursday evening, right outside the San Diego Convention Center, with a Block Party and dances along the Waterfront Bay to Seaport Village. Beginning at midnight on Thursday, two major marathon meetings get underway—one in English and one in Spanish—and run continuously until Sunday morning.

Opening Ceremonies will be held Friday night at the Jack Murphy Stadium, complete with the Parade of Flags of those countries represented at the Convention, and followed by the Big A.A. Meeting. On Saturday night, there will be an Oldtimers Stadium Meeting, and on Sunday morning, the customary Closing Meeting at the stadium.

Local San Diego A.A. Host Committee volunteers expect to number 6,000 plus, and these people will welcome the many visitors to San Diego. For the family members and loved ones that belong to Al-Anon or Alateen and will accompany us to San Diego, the Concourse Center, as well as the Doubletree and U.S. Grant hotels downtown, will offer daytime meetings, workshops, marathons and other events. We trust that all the attendees will experience a milestone event and gratitude and the language of the heart in beautiful San Diego.

Eileen Gatz

Regional Forums—The responsibilities of the Regional Forum assignment involve coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. service workers, the General Service Board, the A.A. World Services and Grapevine Boards and the General Service Office. Regional Forums are held at the invitation of a particular region every two years; there are four Forums annually.

Working in conjunction with the regional trustee, area delegates and host committee liaison person, the Regional Forums coordinator prepares the agenda and topics and suggestions for workshops and presentations, and produces and mails invitations to G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area committee officers, central offices and intergroups, past delegates and past trustees. The staff member also takes care of hotel requirements at each stage of planning, to insure that countless details are handled. He or she is also responsible for providing literature displays at each Forum. Following a Forum, a report of the weekend sharing is produced by the coordinator, and sent to all registrants.

General Service Board personnel attendees usually include the chairman of the board, other Class A and Class B trustees, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors and staff members. Work for a Regional Forum begins at least one year in advance, and great care is taken to insure that each Forum creates an environment and program conducive to lively sharing in a comfortable setting.

In addition to the Regional Forums, Special Forums are also held upon request. They are designed to strengthen service and knowledge of the Fellowship, tailored specifically to a particular area. In this instance, the Regional Forums coordinator works closely with the host contact, keeping the delegate and regional trustee informed. Two Special Forums are planned for 1995, one in Buffalo, New York, in March and the other in Alma, Quebec, in May.

Sarah Price

LITERATURE

Trustees' committee: This report offers a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 1994 General Service Conference.

Projects Completed—Developed and published "A.A. Guidelines—Literature Committees"; added "district meetings" to the inverted triangle in "The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated" pamphlet; updated the "G.S.R." pamphlet; deleted sentence, "Mood-changing medications—including uppers, sedatives, and antidepressants—are usually a threat to sobriety and you may want to learn more about this," from the pamphlet "Is There an Alcoholic In Your Life?" page 18. The request that the parenthetical statement: "(The pamphlet 'The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs' discusses the problem in detail)" be moved to the end of the paragraph, page 19, was approved; added material on "Service Sponsorship" to the "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" pamphlet (pages 28-29).

Projects in Progress—Reviewing a Concepts Checklist for use as service material available to the Fellowship; continuing to oversee the removal of the circle and triangle from all Conference-approved literature as reprinted and, whenever possible, add the phrase "This is A.A. General Service Conference-approved Literature" on the front cover.

Projects forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee—(1) Review proposed additions to "Landmarks in A.A. History" section in *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*; (2) consider proposed revision to "Twelve Traditions Illustrated" pamphlet (the text in Tradition III); (3) consider proposed revision to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet and review a request to reinstate a paragraph referring to Concept One that has been deleted; (4) review the responses in "Should There Be a Fourth Edition of the Big Book?, A Report on Area Response"; (5) consider the strong recommendation from the trustees' Literature Committee that the first 164 pages of the Big Book not be changed; (6) consider whether or not the first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, should have the same rewrite status as the Steps, Traditions and Warranties of Article XII of the Conference Charter; (7) consider a request to prepare a pamphlet on a portion of the "Doctor's Opinion" from the Big Book; (8) consider a request to publish a new book (suggested title "Our Stories"), comprised of Bill's and Dr. Bob's stories and stories from the first and second editions of the Big Book that were not included in the third edition; (9) consider recommendation from the trustees' Literature Committee that a pocket edition of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* be published; (10) consider recommendation from the A.A.W.S. Board and from the trustees' Literature Committee that a video be developed on ways that G.S.O. serves the Fellowship, with an accompanying service pamphlet; (11) discuss a request for a pamphlet, an information piece, a video or inclusion of a section in *The A.A. Service Manual* on the "Circle and Triangle."

Additional trustees' Literature Committee considerations:

- To add a daily inventory question to each page of *Daily Reflections*. The trustees' Literature Committee recommended that *Daily Reflections* be left as is, that daily inventory questions not be implemented, and that this recommendation be forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee.
- To publish a pamphlet on "Accessibilities." The A.A.W.S. Services Committee has developed a new guideline, "A.A. Guidelines—Serving Alcoholics with Special Needs" (published December 1994), so the trustees' Literature Committee decided not to continue work on an additional pamphlet on

"Accessibilities." The committee would like to wait and see whether the new A.A. Guideline fits the needs of the Fellowship before considering a new pamphlet.

- To publish a pamphlet of the first half of the book *Les Douze Etapes et Les Douze Traditions*. The trustees' Literature Committee recommended to the General Service Board that the request to publish such a pamphlet be denied at this time.
- To decide how to handle inconsistencies in Bill's writings. The first one is in *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, page 100, and the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, page 136, where there is reference to the money Towns Hospital made (1920 and 1930). The second discrepancy is in *A.A. Comes of Age*, page 125, and the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, page 178, in reference to the membership of the Washingtonians (500,000 or 100,000).

After research and discussion, the trustees' Literature Committee felt Bill W.'s writings should be left alone and not footnoted in spite of inconsistencies. The committee unanimously recommended that no changes be made in Bill W.'s writings in regard to the inconsistencies in "the money Towns Hospital used to make," or the reported membership of the Washingtonians.

- To consider the return of the circle and triangle symbol to Conference-approved literature. The committee felt it would not be appropriate to take any action on returning the circle and triangle symbol to Conference-approved literature.
- To produce a pamphlet explaining the purpose of our Three Legacies: Recovery, Unity and Service, as embodied in our circle and triangle trademark. Request was tabled until the July 1995 quarterly meeting.
- To discuss whether "A.A. needs more books, more pamphlets and how we can get the A.A. literature we have to everybody, equally." The committee noted that A.A. literature continues to be reviewed quarterly by many trustees' committees and annually by many Conference committees. In addition, there is a literature review subcommittee that meets when necessary.
- To review the "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" pamphlet in reference to sponsors and sponsorship. The committee tabled this request until the July 1995 meeting.

Fran Polek, chairperson

Staff report: The literature coordinator serves as secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees and works closely with the editor, writers and illustrators on preparing all new recovery pamphlets, books, displays and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. The coordinator, along with the editor, follows the progress of writers and illustrators on updating and revising all recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department.

The Literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about literature. We maintain contact with all current area, district, intergroup and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and material to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility. Additionally, the literature coordinator is the liaison with the French Literature Service in Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

Under the present structure of G.S.O., the staff member on the literature desk serves as editor of *Box 4-5-9*, published bimonthly in English, French and Spanish. Work is ongoing all year for ideas for *Box 4-5-9* articles, and the calendar of events is kept up to date daily. The staff member works closely with the editor of the

Publications Department and a small editorial committee to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. through *Box 4-5-9*. Your ideas and suggestions are always welcome.

Susan Ulseth

LONERS, INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS

Staff report: The following is from an Internationalist who participates in the *Loners-Internationalists Meeting by Mail, (LIM)*. It is typical of many letters we receive:

"I am sober today through the grace of a loving God, the Fellowship and the Twelve Steps of A.A. I am one of 19 men and two women aboard the M.V. Greenbay. Yesterday, through the love of my Higher Power, I found three other drunks in the program; we will be together Monday and Thursday nights, 6:00-8:00 p.m., for the duration of the voyage (maybe 100 days) and any other times we need to. I pray this thing we have remains as it is when it started, one drunk talking to another drunk to stay safe, sane and sober. We are people who normally would not associate, but we do, to stay alive and so others may live, to carry the message. God bless you all."

As the name implies, Loners are A.A.s who are unable to attend meetings because there are no groups nearby. There are about 375 Loners in 141 countries, including the U.S. and Canada. Seagoing A.A.s are known as Internationalists. There are now about 161 Internationalists and 40 Port Contacts. Thirty-four Internationalist Groups meet aboard ships or in ports. Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to long-term illness or physical disability. We now have 128 Homers in the Loners/Internationalists Group. Loners, Homers, and Internationalists stay sober by reading A.A. literature and sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters and tapes.

A literature package is sent to each new Loner, Homer or Internationalist. Each also receives directories of Loners, Homers, and Internationalists, complimentary subscriptions to *Box 4-5-9* and *Loners-Internationalists Meeting*, a bimonthly meeting in print which shares excerpts of letters received at the General Service Office from LIM members.

To share group activities and personal experience with the Loners, Homers and Internationalists are Loner Sponsors—A.A.s who do attend meetings regularly.

A.A.'s message of hope continues to be carried around the world through traveling A.A. members and through our literature, as demonstrated by a letter from a Loner in Cotonou, Benin: "I have another drunk who wants to stop drinking here in Cotonou, and we are meeting regularly. It helps a lot, as I'm sure you know. I suspect that my friend and I will be able to keep a much more solid sobriety if we put into action service to others still suffering. We'll see if our two-men English-language meeting might spawn a larger French one."

Sarah Price

NOMINATING

Trustees' committee: With attention to the suggestion of the 1993 Conference Committee on Trustees to consider applicants with spiritual and corporate backgrounds for the Class A trustees vacancies in 1994 and 1995, the committee reviewed the list of

"friends of A.A." available to serve on the General Service Board and invited four to be interviewed during the October 1994 board weekend. The committee recommended that Arthur L. Knight, Jr. and Robert O. Miller serve as Class A trustees.

Since the 1994 Conference Committee on Trustees agreed, after reviewing a preliminary procedure, that more specific procedures are needed for the formation of new regions and/or making alterations in the regional map, a more detailed report was prepared with the recommendation that it be forwarded to the Conference Committee on Trustees as a *work in progress* for review and input.

The report from the Procedures subcommittee was presented and the Nominating Procedures were accepted as revised, for distribution to the General Service Board for reflection prior to adopting the revisions at the July board meeting.

An essay describing the qualifications the Nominating Committee should consider in selecting Class A trustees was reviewed and favorably accepted with the suggestion that it be distributed to all members of the General Service Board and reviewed by the Nominating Committee whenever a search for Class A trustees is underway.

The committee approved the following to serve as appointed committee members: Patti Walters on trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community; James Puckett on trustees' Public Information Committee; Russ Higgins and Martha A. Lewis on trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee; Jim Clough and Frank Berls on trustees' Literature Committee.

The committee recommended the following nominations: *A.A. World Services Board*: Julian Rhinehart, Pacific regional trustee, replacing Gerry Flegel. *A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board*: Larry Nelson, trustee-at-large/U.S., replacing Les Leuthaeuser; Elaine M. Johnson, Class A trustee, replacing John King.

The proposed slates of General Service Board members, officers of the board, A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine directors were forwarded to the 1995 Conference Committee on Trustees for disapproval, if any.

The committee reviewed and will recommend the following slate of trustees at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in May, following presentation at the 1995 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

John N. Chappel, M.D.	Arthur L. Knight, Jr.
W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.	Robert O. Miller
Gary A. Glynn	Peter Roach
Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.	

Class B

Peter Brock	Larry Nelson
William Bungay	Fran Polek
Gerry Flegel	Julian Rhinehart
Gay Garner	Jane Murphy Schulberg
Les Leuthaeuser	Donald Weaver
Michael McPherson	

(Two Class B regional trustees and one Class B trustee-at-large to be elected at the General Service Conference in May 1995.)

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board:

<i>Chairperson</i>	W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.
<i>First Vice-Chairperson</i>	John N. Chappel, M.D.
<i>Second Vice-Chairperson</i>	Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.
<i>Treasurer</i>	Gary Glynn
<i>Secretary</i>	Gerry Flegel

Assistant Treasurer
Assistant Secretary

Donald Meurer
Pat Rosenstiel*

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., to be presented to the 1995 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Peter Brock	Gerard L. Ouellette
George Dorsey	Julian Rhinehart
Jacques Filteau	Pat Rosenstiel*
Gay Garner	Richard Roughton
Michael McPherson	

* To be replaced at staff rotation, September 1995.

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of directors of A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to be presented to the 1995 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Charles Crist	Jane Murphy Schulberg
Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.	Ames Sweet
Tom Maguire	Francine Ward
Larry Nelson	Ann Warner
Fran Polek	Donald Weaver

Jacob Ham, chairperson

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' committee: The responsibilities of the trustees' Public Information Committee include: Creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements; producing films about A.A.; preparing press releases and reports to the public; preparing health fair and other community exhibits; conducting the triennial A.A. Membership Survey.

The committee met three times since the last Conference. Much of the work of this committee was done through subcommittees and the P.I. staff coordinator in the office. Following is a list of work over the past year:

- Completed close-captioning for all TV public service announcements.
 - Completed revised and reformatted P.I. Workbook.
 - Suggested a new *Box 4-5-9* article on anonymity be written incorporating the ideas covered in the anonymity discussion/topic questions with encouragement for discussion at group/district/area levels.
 - Met with the Public Relations consultant for the International Convention.
- The following items have been referred for consideration to the 1995 Conference P.I. Committee:
- Draft of mission statement for the Membership Survey,
 - Draft of a questionnaire for the 1996 Membership Survey which includes four new questions.
 - Revised Anonymity Statement card to include information on neither videotaping nor identifying A.A. speakers by full names on audiotapes.

Gerry Flegel, chairperson

Staff report: The goal of the Public Information assignment is to help to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic, potential alcoholic and the general public through the media, health fairs, and schools. It is a crucial part of Public Information work here at the General Service Office to be a resource and a central collec-

tor of sharing for Public Information committees throughout the United States and Canada. The staff member and staff assistant respond to hundreds of written and telephone inquiries that come into the office from the general public and the Fellowship. The staff person is responsible for handling interviews with the media describing what A.A. is and what we can and cannot do, and providing accurate information to the media, researchers, and the public about Alcoholics Anonymous. In the year of the International Convention the P.I. staff member prepares and mails press releases and a P.I. Press Kit, and provides information to journalists covering A.A.'s 60th Anniversary.

During the past year, literature has been provided for a large number of health and community fairs. In many cases, local Public Information committees provide this literature for their participation in the fairs. When possible, we try to connect the community resource with local A.A. Public Information committees so that they can become involved with the decision about how A.A. can best participate in the event.

New area Public Information chairpersons are automatically sent the Public Information Workbook and all P.I. committee members receive *Box 4-5-9*, as well as any new public service material. Discount packages and one-way displays about the Membership Survey are also made to P.I. committees.

Radio and television public service announcements have been widely aired on major networks and local stations and requests for help in planning programs that include references to Alcoholics Anonymous have also abounded. We have ongoing contact with major networks, as well as the PBS and cable channels. Many film companies have contacted us for permission to use our literature as props in scenes depicting an A.A. meeting.

The success of any Public Information work at G.S.O. is measured in the same way as any other service: are we doing what we can to see that the A.A. message is available to all, and to strive to see that the information conveyed about A.A. is accurate and easy to understand.

Helen Turnquest

SPANISH SERVICES

Staff report: Throughout the years, G.S.O. has provided services in several languages, including Spanish. But it was not until 1984 that the assignment of Spanish Services was formally initiated.

In our general service structure there are more than 30,000 Spanish-speaking A.A. members. They meet in 1,200 groups in the U.S., Puerto Rico and Canada. The Spanish Services staff person, who does not rotate, coordinates and revises Spanish translations of material from the other staff assignments and assists other staff members in providing services to the Spanish-speaking community which are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups. All Spanish-speaking groups receive *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish.

For the first time this year, the General Service Board's *Quarterly Report* is being distributed in Spanish. Also for the first time this year, a list of preliminary and final Conference Agenda Items was distributed in Spanish to all delegates and alternate delegates. A revised Spanish translation of the Twelve and Twelve was available in March 1995.

As more bilingual people come into A.A., communication between the Spanish- and English-speaking groups is improving; the groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings, where they elect bilingual D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. Many Spanish-speaking districts have been

added recently to the areas in our service structure. Service material is translated into Spanish and kept up-to-date. More and more Conference-approved literature is published in Spanish by our Publications Department. The Spanish Services staff member helps answer the correspondence received in Spanish by most other assignments and especially by the International assignment.

The staff member on this assignment represents G.S.O. at the Ibero-American Commission for Translation and Adaptation of A.A. Literature and attends conventions, Hispanic intergroup meetings, Regional Forums, the World Service Meeting and the International Convention, as well as greeting Spanish-speaking visitors to G.S.O.

Danny Mooney

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups and members are provided through 12 staff assignments. In addition to assuming the responsibility for Treatment Facilities or Public Information, for example, staff members correspond with groups and members in a specific region of the U.S. and Canada, as well as with A.A.s in overseas countries. Staff members rotate assignments every two years. These staff assignments are monitored by the staff coordinator.

The staff is divided into three units so that G.S.O. mail is processed and responded to as soon as possible. Unit A consists of P.I., C.P.C., C.F., and T.F. Unit B includes coordinators of staff, Conference, Regional Forums, Loners/Internationalists and Group Services. Unit C includes Overseas, World Service Meeting, Literature and Spanish Services. The International Convention assignment works parallel to all of the other units.

During a typical year, G.S.O. staff receive approximately 14,500 pieces of mail, and the staff coordinator ensures that mail continues to be handled when staff members are involved with large projects, and in times of sickness and vacation. Weekly staff meetings are chaired by the staff coordinator; at these, discussion centers on problems that require direction from the group conscience, and more and better ways of providing service to A.A. groups and members are sought.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of required staff trips to area assemblies/conventions, making sure that the office is adequately covered at all times. She also serves as a liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments and supervises the Support Services (secretarial/clerical) department, ensuring that the paper work is done accurately and in a timely manner.

Whenever there is a staff opening, a letter is sent out to the trustees and directors announcing the opening and briefly describing the requirements for the job. The information is also posted in *Box 4-5-9*. Six years of sobriety is a requirement for a G.S.O. staff member. Business experience, excellent communication skills, A.A. service experience and geographic considerations are among the criteria used in the selection process. The staff coordinator trains new staff members.

During 1994, staff attended a total of 71 conventions, assemblies, roundups and Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These provide staff with an opportunity to communicate about G.S.O. services, to meet A.A.s throughout the U.S. and Canada and to receive information that can be shared with other groups.

In the past year, approximately 1,219 visitors from around the world came to G.S.O. Each visitor has the opportunity to tour G.S.O. and Grapevine offices, learning about the services to the

Fellowship. Often visiting members and guests attend the weekly A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on most Fridays.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance materials, and preparing the minutes of the General Service Board meetings; she also serves as editor of the *Quarterly Report*, the summary of the boards' activities.

The staff coordinator is a voting member of the General Service Conference, and serves as secretary of the trustees' Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions. In accordance with Concept IV, the staff coordinator is also a director of A.A. World Services, Inc.

Pat Rosenstiel

TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities is "... to further the acceptance of A.A. in hospitals, rehabilitation centers, and similar facilities, and to bring additional help to alcoholics under treatment there." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S123.) Consequently, the way in which the A.A. message is finally heard by alcoholics in treatment facilities is a matter for concern, attention and development by the committee.

Since the 1994 General Service Conference, our committee has met three times. At the July meeting it was reported that our pamphlets "Bridging the Gap" and "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" had been revised and were ready for distribution. This year, in addition to the annual letter which was sent to treatment facilities personnel and also to area, district and other treatment facilities chairpersons, the committee decided to institute an annual letter to the above chairs requesting information about local treatment facilities committee activity, so that such material may be shared via the Treatment Facilities Newsletter and Box 4-5-9. The letter brought forth the requested material so that, at least for the time being, it is feasible to publish the newsletter biannually.

There has been some discussion about the possibility of changing the format of the Treatment Facilities Workbook to conform to the design recently adopted by the Public Information and Correctional Facilities Committees for their workbooks. This matter will be considered by the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee.

There has been serious discussion about the necessity for more effective sharing of information among the

trustees' Committee on Public Information, Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities and Treatment Facilities. Appointed members of each of these committees will meet together during Board Weekends and then give a report at their regular committee meetings.

There has also been discussion about the fact that there are currently more alcoholism treatment programs in prison settings. This appears to be because more people are being jailed for alcohol-related crimes, and also because sentiment about effective alcoholism treatment is shifting from punishment to the fostering of recovery programs. Also, under managed care programs people with alcohol problems are being released from treatment after a very brief stay instead of weeks or months. This presents new challenges and opportunities for local A.A. members to introduce newly sober alcoholics to A.A. in their communities.

Elaine M. Johnson, Ph. D., chairperson

Staff report: The primary purpose of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to help A.A. members carry the message to alcoholics in treatment. We have now over 400 (451 to be exact) Treatment Facilities committees functioning in the U.S. and Canada, 91 of which are area committees. We try to keep an up-to-date list of the chairs of these committees and to provide them with considerable information and literature.

In order to carry the message "inside," the A.A. member must meet with the administrators and personnel in many different kinds of treatment settings. He or she must become familiar with the rules and regulations of the facility and be willing to comply with them. As an oldtimer once said, "If we can't get in, we can't carry the message!" The local A.A. member also offers to provide information about A.A. groups in the patient's hometown and encourages active participation upon leaving the facility. This is called "bridging the gap."

We send a Treatment Facilities Workbook to all area chairpeople. This workbook is a comprehensive how-to guide to carrying the message "inside." It contains shared experience, suggestions, general information, guidelines and literature. District and other treatment facilities chairs also receive the workbook. Treatment facilities people also receive Box 4-5-9, *About A.A.*, the Treatment Facilities Newsletter, and a current list of the 91 chairs in the U.S. and Canada. All chairs have copies of our U.S. and Canadian directory of intergroups and central offices for referral purposes.

Mail comes from three sources: (1) newly sober alcoholics in treatment facilities, (2) local A.A.s who have become or are interested in becoming active on treatment facilities committees, (3) treatment facilities administrators or personnel requesting information about A.A. and assistance in setting up meetings.

The other major staff activity entails serving as secretary to both trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities. Responsibilities in this area include responding to mail from committee members, helping to prepare agendas for committee meetings, preparing background material and, of course, preparing minutes at the conclusion of meetings. The staff member also gathers material for an occasional treatment facilities article in Box 4-5-9 and prepares biannual editions of the Treatment Facilities Newsletter.

Phyllis Masback



Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is a wholly-owned subsidiary of the General Service Board. The corporation's primary purpose is to produce a magazine, and in June 1994 the Fellowship's monthly international journal celebrated 50 years of continuous publication. The Grapevine also produces a number of other materials associated with the magazine. The Grapevine accepts no contributions toward operating expenses. When A.A. members do send contributions, they are placed in a special fund, which is used to provide subscriptions for A.A. members who are unable to afford them (often those in correctional facilities).

Each year, the board holds four quarterly meetings as well as four meetings in which it convenes as a planning committee of the whole, to engage in ongoing strategic planning for the future health of the corporation and the magazine. Since April 1994, the board's primary emphasis has been on ways to improve circulation, and to make communication with all segments of the Fellowship more effective. We have spent time making decisions about various related materials, from the ubiquitous Wall Calendar and Pocket Planner to new materials for the Spanish A.A. community. After several years of declining circulation, finances have been a serious concern, and the budgeting process for 1995 was a difficult and at times frustrating one.

Directors have used conference calls this year to keep in touch with each other on urgent matters, and to enhance communication with delegate members of the Conference Grapevine Committee.

50th Anniversary Celebration: We celebrated the magazine's 50th Anniversary of publication with a triple whammy: a new design, a 96-page double issue in June, and the transition to desktop publishing. Response to the new look has been overwhelmingly positive, and single-copy sales of the June issue exceeded 20,000 copies. Throughout the anniversary year, all new subscribers received a bonus issue, November 1993, which emphasized A.A. history.

Circulation: Beginning in about April of last year, the steady downward progression started to level off, and though the hoped-for upward movement has not yet happened, circulation has been fluctuating up and down from month to month in the neighborhood of 120,000. Average circulation for 1994 was 120,900, or 2,100 below the budgeted 123,000. Beginning in January of this year, there are signs of modest improvement,

and for the first three months the average circulation was 121,572, with a high for the March issue of 123,555.

In addition to a lot of help from the service structure, three special mailings toward the end of the year were helpful: 1) A trial mailing to groups in nine areas, with a covering letter and a pad of subscription forms (about 200 subscriptions by January 31); 2) a mailing to readers whose subscriptions had expired (1,900 subscriptions); and 3) a mailing to subscription donors (181 subscriptions).

An easel-back poster, "Carry the Grapevine—Carry the Message," introduced last April, has been widely used, and at this time the supply is running very low. Because it is an extremely expensive item, and its effectiveness (as compared to its popularity) is as yet unclear, the 1995 budget does not provide for a reprint.

In July, the board requested a budget adjustment for several purposes: to make an adjustment to the unfulfilled subscription liability account; to send an all-groups mailing (which was subsequently scaled down to the trial mailing to nine areas), and to bring in a firm of outside consultants to make recommendations in the area of circulation and renewal practices. The consultants' final report reinforced a growing feeling among board and management that the Grapevine can, and should, follow more standard publishing industry practices. While many conventional marketing techniques are clearly in conflict with the Traditions, many are not, and management and board need to stretch their thinking and come up with creative ways to use more industry techniques to help with magazine circulation. Two of the report's major recommendations—hiring a circulation manager and building more flexibility and information gathering capacity into the AS400 circulation module—are already in process. In addition, the report recommends writing and disseminating a position statement for the magazine, to clarify its use and value for readers. The report will be followed up by a focused business plan for the next several years.

In the immediate future, management is moving forward with redesigning the renewal sequence to make notices more appealing (a fourth notice has already been added), taking steps to contact new groups directly with information about the Grapevine, and reevaluating and consolidating material for GvRs to make it more effective in providing information as well as more cost effective.

Finances: The corporation ended the year with a net loss of \$81,600, compared to a budgeted net loss of \$61,000. Average circulation came in at 2,100 (or \$25,200) below budget, and single-copy sales were \$8,500 below budget. Even with consistent monitoring and control of costs (which resulted in savings of



\$14,500 compared to budget on magazine production), magazine gross profit was \$3,100 below budget. Gross profit on related materials was also below budget by about \$40,000.

A seeming paradox is the fact that in a year showing such a net loss, the board can forward \$26,000 as a contribution to the General Service Board Reserve Fund. According to past practice, interest income from the Grapevine unfulfilled subscription liability account (\$75,000) stays in the Reserve Fund. If needed, a portion of it (\$48,740) is moved into the liability account to bring it to the required level. The remainder (\$26,260) is a contribution to the Reserve Fund proper.

1995 Budget: The board had a real struggle over the budget this year. Faced with an average circulation that was about 2,000 below the 1994 budget, along with dramatically rising costs (almost 40 percent on the price of paper, and a 19.1 percent increase in second class nonprofit postage rates), directors were forced to seriously consider a price increase on the magazine. After several preliminary discussions, the board asked management to bring alternate budgets to the January meeting: one with a price increase, and one without. We had a *long* discussion. None of the directors was happy about raising the price, even less so about accepting the resulting drop in circulation (meaning that the Grapevine could carry the message to fewer alcoholics). But in the end, in keeping with our fiduciary responsibilities, the board approved, with substantial unanimity, a budget that included a price increase on the magazine effective May 1 (the July issue), and showed a net loss of \$44,680.

The budget story ended differently in the Finance Committee, where members of that committee considered the Grapevine's situation in relation to the General Service Board Reserve Fund as a whole. Finance Committee members discussed the inevitable decline in circulation, and voted to accept the alternate budget, without a price increase, showing a deficit of \$109,000. Recognizing that this action represents deferring a price increase, not avoiding it indefinitely—costs will continue to rise, not decrease—the Finance Committee believed that in a year when the Reserve Fund is exceeding the maximum this was an appropriate use of Reserve Fund monies.

Related Materials: Two new cassette tapes on A.A. history, "History Lights the Way" and "What We Were Like," were produced in April, and proved to be extremely popular, selling a total of 8,200 by the end of the year.

In October, the board voted to go ahead with production of the 1996 Wall Calendar and Pocket Planner. The topic had been raised at the June planning committee meeting, immediately after the Conference's second "strong suggestion" in a row, and the board's vote, like that of Conference members, was split. By October, it was clear that circulation had not risen over the course of the year, and directors voted unanimously to continue production of these two items.

The board voted in June (subject to the approval of the Conference Grapevine Committee) to cancel production of a humor book slated for production in 1995. This decision was based on the lack of quality material for such a book, and on continuing requests from members to cut back on production of materials other than the magazine.

A board committee has been working on guidelines for discontinuing related materials, and has established six criteria to help make these decisions when appropriate.

Grapevine Resources in Spanish: In response to the 1993 Conference Action asking the board to "continue to explore different ways of carrying the message to the Spanish community through Grapevine materials," a Spanish translation of *The Language of the Heart* was undertaken. It has now been completed, and the book will come off press early in May for introduc-

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION — GEOGRAPHIC BREAKDOWN

	CIRCULATION		INCREASE/ DECREASE
	APRIL 1995	APRIL 1994	
UNITED STATES			
Alabama	1,329	1,273	56
Alaska	487	522	— 35
Arizona	1,722	1,549	173
Arkansas	695	707	— 12
California	12,147	11,363	784
Colorado	1,551	1,568	— 17
Connecticut	2,006	1,947	59
Delaware	415	423	— 8
District of Columbia	278	279	— 1
Florida	6,001	5,787	214
Georgia	2,884	2,678	206
Hawaii	420	395	25
Idaho	584	545	39
Illinois	5,210	5,220	— 10
Indiana	1,893	1,731	162
Iowa	1,572	1,486	86
Kansas	1,528	1,511	17
Kentucky	1,112	1,073	39
Louisiana	1,136	1,146	— 10
Maine	852	862	— 10
Maryland	1,814	1,915	— 101
Massachusetts	3,831	3,848	— 17
Michigan	3,519	3,440	79
Minnesota	3,112	3,115	— 3
Mississippi	797	718	79
Missouri	2,164	2,131	33
Montana	681	659	22
Nebraska	1,407	1,393	14
Nevada	656	620	36
New Hampshire	707	674	33
New Jersey	3,531	3,473	58
New Mexico	689	614	75
New York	7,829	7,809	20
North Carolina	2,848	2,726	122
North Dakota	508	489	19
Ohio	3,388	3,541	— 153
Oklahoma	1,432	1,410	22
Oregon	1,254	1,303	— 49
Pennsylvania	4,959	4,780	179
Rhode Island	493	536	— 43
South Carolina	1,239	1,191	48
South Dakota	524	466	58
Tennessee	1,561	1,520	41
Texas	5,363	5,109	254
Utah	598	560	38
Vermont	421	406	15
Virginia	2,664	2,507	157
Washington	3,432	3,388	44
West Virginia	532	514	18
Wisconsin	2,870	2,699	171
Wyoming	334	344	— 10
Puerto Rico	85	72	13
U.S. Possessions	81	79	2
Total	109,145	106,114	3,031
CANADA			
Alberta	1,328	1,221	107
British Columbia/Yukon	1,747	1,668	79
Manitoba	534	556	— 22
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	559	532	27
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	870	830	40
Ontario	4,175	4,027	148
Quebec	420	446	— 26
Saskatchewan	782	842	— 60
Total	10,415	10,122	293
FOREIGN	1,650	1,507	143
Grand Total	121,210	117,743	3,467

tion at the International Convention in July. Spanish translations of the slogans, Serenity Prayer, and Preamble were made available in March, and a proposal for a Spanish edition of the magazine will be considered by the 1995 Conference Grapevine Committee.

Customer Service: The shipping operation for related materials has been moved to the Kansas City warehouse, resulting in prompt and accurate fulfillment of orders.

After communicating with Canadian delegates and trustees, management has been working on a plan to improve delivery of both the magazine and related materials to Canada. The Grapevine now has a GST number, and plans are underway to open a warehouse in Canada, thus speeding delivery of both the magazine and related materials.

Other Board Business:

- **Technological Challenges**—The board is beginning to explore the possibilities of electronic distribution and storage of the Grapevine.
- **IWS**—As a result of the meeting with Intergroup World Services (IWS) in January, considerable progress has been made on an understanding, and we are very optimistic about the final outcome.
- **Term of Directors**—The board discussed a referral from the trustees' Nominating Committee regarding reduction of directors' terms to two years. Consensus that no change is needed at this time was forwarded to the Nominating Committee.
- **Meeting Location**—In order to hold costs down, the board is now holding its meetings at the office rather than the hotel.
- **Retirement Committee**—The board approved a recommendation to approve for retirees a one percent increase per year of retirement from 1/1/89 to 1/1/95, excluding those retired in 1993 and 1994, with a minimum increase of \$20 per month.

Jane Murphy Schulberg, chairperson

Staff report: The A.A. Grapevine currently has 16 full-time and four part-time employees.

Editorial: The executive editor, Ann Warner, has oversight responsibility for the Grapevine operation, and reports directly to the Grapevine Board. Ames Sweet, the managing editor, is responsible for format, content, and design of the magazine, oversees the Grapevine representative program, and works directly with the magazine's freelance designer and copyeditor. Together, the managing editor, the executive editor, and the copyeditor evaluate all material for publication and stay in touch with everyone who writes for the magazine. To bolster these efforts, the Grapevine Editorial Advisory Board (made up of volunteer A.A. members who are professionals in the fields of publishing and communications), meets nine times a year to discuss all aspects of the magazine.

Unlike A.A. staff positions at the General Service Office, Grapevine staff positions do not rotate, and the executive editor and the managing editor both serve on the Grapevine Corporate Board and are voting members of the General Service Conference. In addition, both share the responsibility of repre-

senting the Grapevine at Regional Forums and, when invited, other A.A. events.

The Editorial Department is also responsible for publishing the quarterly "GvR News," and with the help of the part-time GvR coordinator tries to keep GvRs (Grapevine reps) at all levels informed about what's going on in the office and what's happening with other GvRs around the world.

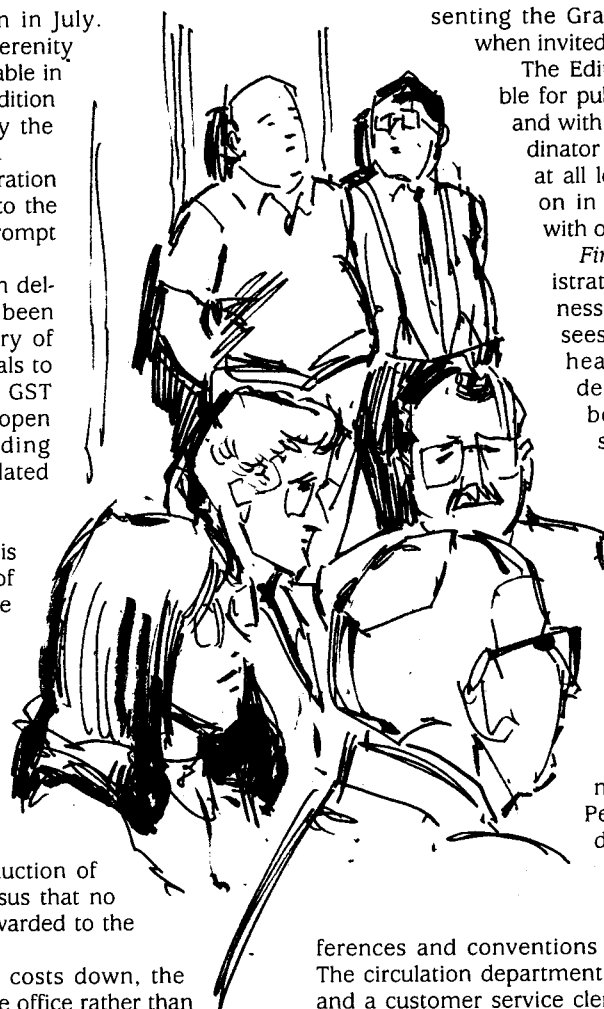
Financial: Controller/business administrator Bob Scherer manages all business aspects of the corporation, oversees the circulation department, and heads the bookkeeping-accounting department. He is ably assisted by bookkeeper Bob Slotterback, who supervises four accounting clerks and the shipping operation. The bookkeeping department keeps track of all incoming and outflowing funds, and prepares the financial analyses and reports required by the Corporate Board, the General Service Board, and the Grapevine's outside auditor. While the magazine and the bulk of the Grapevine's special item orders are packaged and mailed by outside mailers in Pennsylvania, the in-house shipping department is kept busy mailing a variety of small orders, back issues, letters, books, tapes, and complimentary materials for con-

ferences and conventions throughout the U.S. and Canada. The circulation department consists of three data entry clerks and a customer service clerk and is responsible for maintaining the Grapevine's subscriber list as well as handling any special requests or problems which may occur.

Office Management: Office manager and corporate secretary Naomi Strassberg's job includes ensuring the general efficiency of the office as a whole, administering the health insurance program, supervising the day-to-day work of the GvR coordinator, and handling all copyrights and permissions requests.

Like any other professional operation, we have our ups and downs—our good days and our bad days. Some days are filled with nothing but complaints and gripes—aimed at or coming from each one of the different departments. Yet, overall, if the early "ink-stained wretches" who founded the Grapevine with Bill W.'s blessings were to return to our modern-day office, through all that is familiar and unfamiliar, they would certainly recognize the spirit of Alcoholics Anonymous which flows throughout the entire operation.

Ames Sweet, managing editor



"Boy meets girl on A.A. campus. . . ."

Dorothy Newrohr (North Dakota) and Jim Redemske (Iowa), both Panel 44 delegates, met for the first time at last year's Conference. They showed up at the 1995 Conference engaged. With an October wedding planned the only "high-class problem" seems to be what state to reside in.

Literature Distributed - 1994

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	496,161
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover)	422,405
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)	12,114
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	118,663
Daily Reflections	135,863
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	238,566
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	40,994
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	188,309
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	5,559
A.A. Comes of Age	14,633
As Bill Sees It	67,033
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	13,293
"Pass It On"	15,021
Total	1,768,614

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service	32,725
Living Sober	186,796
Came to Believe	86,446
A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate	16,636
Total	322,603

Pamphlets

A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs	12,781
A.A. and the Armed Services	6,318
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	25,880
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	18,368
A.A. for the Native North American	20,718
A.A. for the Woman	108,118
The A.A. Group	57,751
A.A. in Your Community	23,422
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	17,843
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	24,710
The A.A. Membership Survey	32,024
The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs	89,799
A.A. Tradition - How It Developed	33,230
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	10,293
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	119,085
Circles of Love and Service	18,636
Bridging the Gap	23,580
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	13,306
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	18,716
Do You Think You're Different?	135,119
44 Questions	202,066
G.S.R.	24,331
How A.A. Members Cooperate	17,580
How It Works	58,272
If You Are a Professional	23,428
Inside A.A.	43,290
Is A.A. for You?	274,648
Is A.A. for Me?	114,983
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	85,455
It Happened to Alice	47,891
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	50,497
The Jack Alexander Article	29,871
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	8,237
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	89,056

A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	57,035
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	46,878
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	6,101
A Newcomer Asks	256,566
Problems Other Than Alcohol	99,589
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	269,589
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	19,428
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	14,644
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	79,113
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	41,363
This Is A.A.	256,062
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	17,784
Time to Start Living	66,681
Time to Start Living (large print)	11,112
Too Young?	88,992
Understanding Anonymity	67,052
What Happened to Joe	50,137
Young People and A.A.	104,196
Total	3,431,624

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	596,922
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	71,294
Wallet cards-Anonymity	38,054
Anonymity Display Card	7,740
Parchment-scrolls	2,850
Placards	370
C.P.C. Workbook	460
Correctional Facilities Workbook	1,005
P.I. Workbook	695
Treatment Facilities Workbook	328
A.A. Guidelines	50,778
Group Handbook	3,345
Wire Racks	2,128
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	3,209
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	3,260
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	147
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	1,423
TV Spots (video cassette)	206
Public Service Announcements (cassettes, tapes, records)	348
Twelve Steps Shade displays	2,189
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	1,959
Fact Files	1,777
Total	790,487
Grand Total	6,313,328

SPANISH

Books

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)	26,053
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	3,754
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	3,634
Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	6,006
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	3,332
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	2,355
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	6,385
Total	51,519

Booklets

Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	12,352
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	1,811
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	23,533
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	6,001
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	3,772
Total	47,469

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	5,205
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	19,381
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	25,497
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	50,198
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	5,336
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	7,672
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	5,455
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	1,841
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	2,032
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	4,350
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	12,711
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	8,485
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	7,957
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	2,402
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	4,694
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	8,631
El Miembro de A.A. - Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs)	4,368
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	5,003
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	2,259
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	6,994
La Tradición de A.A. - ¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition - How It Developed)	1,861
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	7,915
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	1,677
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	8,415
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	5,340
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	1,367
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	2,021
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	2,630
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	1,644
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	2,978
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	9,119

A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	4,072
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	1,162
A.A. y los Programas de Alcoholismo Empresariales (A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs)	1,882
Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	6,205
Tiempo Para Empezar a Vivir (Time to Start Living)	3,572
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	8,650
Total	260,981

Miscellaneous

Guías (Guidelines)	8,394
Parchments, Spanish	595
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	17,978
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on cassette)	338
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on cassette)	822
Total	28,127
Grand Total	416,223

FRENCH

Books

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format relie)	4,247
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format poche)	3,314
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format relie)	1,539
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format poche)	3,527
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	597
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	3,085
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	4,935
Total	21,244

Plaquettes (Booklets)

Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe)	2,219
Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	3,084
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	1,408
Total	6,711

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	21,031
Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)	3,805
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	27,196

Larry Cagnina's (Alaska) package of Conference background material was delivered when he was at work, so the postman left it on the doorstep. By the time Larry got home it was frozen solid and took a week to thaw. It's hard to build defrosting time into the pre-Conference schedule, but it might be something to think about.

Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	1,307
Cooperation des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	420
Les A.A. et les programmes d'aide aux employes (A.A. & Employee Assistance Programs)	425
Le membre des A.A. face aux médicaments et à la drogue (The A.A. Member - Medications & Other Drugs)	1,139
Les A.A. - Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	366
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	180
Questions et réponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	2,228
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les médecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	577
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	531
La Tradition des A.A. et son développement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	1,101
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	907
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	585
Jean face à son problème d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	649
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	2,582
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	2,418
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	571
Les Douze Traditions illustrées (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,743
Les A.A. dans les établissements correctionnels (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	427
Ça vaut mieux que de languir en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	590
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	6,078
Les membres du clergé se renseignent (Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	434
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	617
Message à l'intention d'un détenu (Memo to an Inmate)	1,051
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels	

(Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	249
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	2,124
Les Douze Concepts illustrés (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	887
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	703
Trois causeries à des sociétés médicales (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	483
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	1,059
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	2,280
Causeries à l'extérieur des A.A. (Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	318
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	1,533
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	1,372
L'Héritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	427
Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	1,391
Vous croyez-vous différent? (Do You Think You're Different?)	1,478
Lettre à une femme alcoolique (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	713
Sondage de 1992 sur les membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	2,216
Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	1,760
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	2,117
Il est encore temps de vivre (Time to Start Living)	958
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	6,372
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	1,144
Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	242
Les Douze Étapes illustrées (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	2,006
Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	420
Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amérique du Nord (A.A. and the Native North American)	369
Total	111,579
Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	2,332
Total	

Divers (Miscellaneous)

Le Gros Livre (cassettes)	270
Carte 12 Étapes/12 Traditions (Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	1,703
Carte anonymat (Français/anglais) (Anonymity Wallet card)	101
Cassettes	48
Notre Méthode (How It Works)	22,150
Manuel de Groupe	83
Manuel de l'Information Publique	11
Manuel des Centres de Detention	4
Manuel de la CMP	17
Messages d'Interet Publique (Radio P.S.A.)	3
Prière Serenite (Carte) (Serenity Prayer wallet card)	25,520
Slogans (serie de 5) (Five A.A. Slogans)	305
Suggestions Reunions Debutants (Guide for Leading Beginners Meetings)	76
Manuel des Centres de Traitement	10
Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (fact file)	2,657
Total	52,958
Grand Total	194,824



Quite by accident, Helen Turnquest (G.S.O. staff) and John Goldberg (Illinois, Chicago) discovered they were both graduates of Hyde Park High-the best school in Chicago, noted for its high achievers. Helen and John might have become alcoholics but they were high-achieving ones!

Reports on Area Service Highlights

Alabama/NW Florida: Our area includes all of Alabama and N.W. Florida, with 22 districts and 371 groups. Quarterly area assemblies have an average registration of 368. Our area was well represented at the 1994 Regional Forum in Biloxi, and a stipend was provided for all area officers to attend. We have very active committees for Archives, Conventions, Corrections, C.P.C., Finance, Grapevine, Intergroup/Central Office, P.I. Treatment and Literature. We have nine intergroups and five central offices. Several workshops each year are conducted by committee members and Conference themes are among the topics of other assembly workshops. Past delegates participate in workshops and a panel of past delegates chair an "Ask-It-Basket" session Saturday afternoon at each assembly. Clear and open communication at the group, district and area levels stimulates enthusiastic participation. — *Clark Fisher*

Arkansas: Area 4 has a number of past delegates and trustees who continue to participate on an area level. Each of our 12 districts and many of our 250 groups regularly participate at assemblies. Our seven area committees cooperate to carry the message to the districts and groups through workshops and displays. C.P.C. continues to interact with the professionals through workshops and personal contact. Carrying the message through workshops and "bridging the gap" is the focus of our T.F.C. The Corrections committee works with local, county and state institutions by conducting meetings on the "inside," and working with court classes. The Convention committee coordinates "Old Grandad," the oldest state convention west of the Mississippi, held each August. Our Archives committee is currently working on a workbook, and our traveling GV display has helped increase subscriptions. Last October Arkansas hosted the 4th SW Regional Service Assembly in Fort Smith, with participation by our eleven areas. Two of our rotating trustees are from Area 4: Ann B. and John King. For your hard work and dedication, and for your love, thank you, Ann and John. — *Mary Bridges*

British Columbia/Yukon: Our area is the second largest geographical area, close to 1,300 miles long and 650 wide, with 750 groups and 47 districts. Our General Service Committee consists of the delegate plus six elected officers and as many as eight appointed chairs of committees. There are nine committees, with each D.C.M. being assigned to one of them for a one-year period. One assembly and three quarterlies are held annually in various locations, with one of the quarterlies being combined with a pre-Conference service assembly. Most districts have monthly meetings, and many also hold mini-assemblies on a quarterly or monthly basis. An area newsletter is produced six times a year. We have an annual convention that rotates around the area, and also take part in PRAASA as well as the Pacific Northwest Conference. Our Archives, Newsletter, and Grapevine displays are presented at numerous events throughout the year in various locations. — *Alex Palmer*

California (Northern Coastal): The 18 geographic and three Spanish districts that make up our area stretch from the San Luis Obispo county line in the south to the Oregon border. Each district is made up of the number of subdistricts; currently there are 172 subdistricts serving approximately 2,250 groups. Monthly district meetings are attended by the delegate or one of the other seven area officers. We hold 12 centrally located area committee meetings and four district-hosted assemblies each year. Our area P.I./C.P.C., Archives, and Bridging-the-Gap committees meet on area committee days. There are 21 central offices and intergroups within our boundaries; four are Spanish. Communication and cooperation with these and the autonomous Hospitals/Institutions com-

mittee of Northern California continue to improve. Our area consists of groups that are very well informed and active. We also have groups that are not yet aware of the joy of service. There is still much to do. The area is continuing to grow in participation, energy and the determination to help assure A.A.'s future with special emphasis placed on an effective subdistrict structure. — *Jim Madger*

California (Southern): Our area has 60 districts with 1,983 registered groups. Seven districts are Spanish-speaking. Area assemblies are held every other month and rotate from district to district. We have 11 standing committees which are all very active. Our C.P.C. committee has been working on a video presentation for judges and our Literature committee has put together an information packet for district and group literature chairpersons. Last year our Grapevine committee held a workshop celebrating GV's 50th anniversary. In addition to our committee meetings at assemblies, we have a D.C.M. sharing session and a G.S.R. orientation meeting. An adhoc committee continues to study and discuss ways of improving communication and increasing participation. This is a challenging time for our area as we look at endless possibilities for change, not only at the area level, but within our districts. We have a resurgence of energy in our area to effectively serve its ever growing population with renewed interest and commitment to "Pass It On"! — *Eva Sanchez*

Colorado: Area 10 has 624 groups, 30 districts and one Spanish-speaking district. We conduct three area assemblies a year, rotated throughout the area. In the Fall, we hold our annual State Convention. We have seven central/intergroup offices; the Records coordinator maintains all group and district records. The *Hi Country News*, our area newsletter, is published three times a year. The Archives committee is recommending that the position of a permanent non-voting archivist be created. In 1994, Corrections placed over \$23,000 worth of Conference-approved literature behind the walls as a result of the Pink Can Program. Over 130 meetings a week are held behind the walls. The Grapevine committee is using displays and workshops to increase circulation, and recycles old issues to detoxes, treatment and correctional facilities. Treatment Facilities supports the Worldwide Bridging the Gap effort. Treatment, C.P.C. and P.I. are cooperating with the medical field in a series of presentations to the H.I.V. positive community. P.I. is conducting radio outreach into the Native North American and Hispanic communities, and participates in public health fairs. C.P.C. is working with minorities, special needs and the judicial system. The Fellowship is alive and well in Area 10 and we continue to work hard to carry the message to the alcoholic that still suffers. — *Linda Fredricks*

Connecticut: We have three service assemblies each year, and on non-assembly months, our delegate and alternate delegate visit each district. We do not have a central office. All services committees are supported by our area treasury. Because of an increase in correctional facility meetings, a burden has been placed on our C & T committees.



More "person" support is being requested. We have an Annual Convention, a service Round-Up and a Soberfest (an outside recreational weekend for A.A.s and their families). Area 11 has over 1,050 groups, two local intergroups and 10 districts, one being nongeographical, representing our Hispanic community. We have had growth problems and it's been difficult to have "Service Enthusiasm" present at all levels of service. One of our main objectives in 1995 will be to educate new D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s on service matters. Our P.I. committee participates on a monthly Open Air A.A. meeting, on a public service radio station, where A.A. Traditions are respected. We have a set of Area Guidelines, defining what our service structure is in Connecticut; when we stray from our primary purpose, these guidelines are there for all of us. — *Tony Taschner*

District of Columbia: Metropolitan Washington has over 2,000 A.A. meetings a week, day and night, from the halls of Congress to homeless shelters. Our area consists of a large inner-city and two suburban Maryland counties. Each month over 300 meetings are taken to treatment and corrections facilities. Our C.P.C. committee's focus is to represent A.A. at the many national conferences. Our intergroup and general service assembly are the linked hands of service, working closely, with a joint monthly newsletter and many shared service committees. Our Spanish-speaking districts have grown from one to three in two years. Our "Young People in A.A." is now a standing committee of the assembly. This year we enjoyed special fellowship with our neighbor Area 29, Maryland with joint attendance at special events, and Area 29 invited many of our "longtimers" to participate in their "A.A. History" Celebration. I expect to take home—together with experience, strength, and hope—many wonderful new ideas from this Conference, which can help Area 13 to learn from the past, to live in the present, and to plan for the future—one day at a time. — *Sandy Clunies*

Florida (North): Area 14 serves 31 districts and 764 groups. Our Growth, Finance and Central Site committees continue to provide extensive information processing and an informed conscience. Each D.C.M. increases area involvement by serving on one of these administrative committees. The Accessibilities Committee created a literature piece which is being considered for committee approval. Treatment, Corrections, Intergroup, P.I., C.P.C. and Archives committees remain energetic and focused. Area "Structure and Guidelines" were initiated to facilitate the flow of business and a book of Resolutions was created to review past floor actions and reduce duplication. Rapid membership growth has forced consideration on whether to split existing districts or adopt a multiple D.C.M./L.C.M. concept. The district and area solution to this healthy problem will impact how we do business for years to come. As detox beds disappear, area enthusiasm for presenting "12th Stepping the Wet Drunk" workshops gains momentum, thus reinforcing our primary purpose, carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. — *Dan Eberlein*

Florida (South)/Bahamas/Virgin Islands: We have 15 districts, with over 1,450 registered groups. We meet four times a year and have 450 to 500 in attendance. There are seven standing committees, the latest being Current Practices. Corrections has a quarterly newsletter and takes meetings to county, state & federal correctional facilities. Treatment has a temporary contact program, under the umbrella of the area structure or intergroup. In Archives, the districts set up their displays at various A.A. functions, along with sponsoring Old Timers meetings. District C.P.C. committees continue mailings to the various professionals, along with the "adopt a doctor" program, which places Grapevines in

the waiting rooms. P.I. speaks to a variety of organizations, schools, colleges and libraries. Grapevine: the districts have displays that are presented at groups, and special A.A. functions. All committees hold Saturday workshops at each of our quarterlies. The area started a "What's On Your Mind?" sharing session which is chaired by the current delegate, with past delegates participating. — *Diana Habbe*

Hawaii: Our area has approximately 220 groups in 17 districts covering 4 major islands. Area committee meetings and area assemblies rotate throughout the islands with 4-5 area committee meetings each year, and two-day assemblies. The Convention committee hosts the Annual Hawaii State Convention, a very popular convention for out-of-state A.A. and Al Anon members. The Convention's success has allowed lower registration fees and nearly free coffee the past couple years. Being an island state, one of our problems of communication and cooperation is air travel costs. Over the past six years our area has grown to include officers and committee chairpersons from all of the four islands. It can get quite costly for G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s to attend assemblies, and some members on Oahu, 85% of the state's population, feel that neighbor island committee members should not be funded with Oahu's group contributions to the Hawaii Area treasury. But the new neighbor island participation has brought dramatic neighbor island growth and a better sense of carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers throughout Hawaii. — *Charles Nalepa*

Illinois (Chicago): Our area has an active A.A. community with over 3,800 meetings per week in 23 districts. Volunteers at our central office handle over 5,000 phone calls per month, with approximately 10% being Twelfth Step calls. The Special Needs Committee has daily meetings signed for the hearing impaired. We are currently working with the homeless, homebound and the visually impaired. Our Hospital and Treatment Facilities committee is involved in the Bridge the Gap Program. Committees on Grapevine, P.I. C.P.C. and Corrections are active and our bimonthly newsletter, "Here's How," is read by over 40,000. Our Archives committee has sponsored four well-attended "In The Beginning" sessions where early Chicago members are taped. Annual All-Chicago Open Meeting draws over 12,000 people and has become self-supporting. We have held our Third Annual Forum in order to more fully inform the delegate. Many of our districts are holding annual Big Book and Traditions conferences which help to keep A.A.'s basic message intact. — *John Goldberg*

Illinois (Southern): Area 21 covers 70% of Illinois, mostly small towns and rural communities. The area closely follows the service structure of G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s and area service committees. We hold area assemblies four times a year, hosted by various districts. We have 16 districts with 456 registered groups. We have redistricted and now have five new districts over the past two years. We cooperate with the other delegate areas in the state in a yearly statewide conference. Area 21 holds an annual Spring Conference that is service orientated. A budget committee was established, and we are trying the budget system for the first time. In all, Southern Illinois A.A.s are aware of their responsibility to carry the message to the suffering alcoholic and willing-ly do so. — *Ann Santen*

Indiana (Northern): Area 22 has 48 districts with approximately 654 registered groups. We hold four assemblies a year, plus two D.C.M. conferences. The first D.C.M. conference is held before Conference. The second is held in late October with D.C.M.s sharing "What has worked and what has not worked" in carrying the service message to the groups. Our area has just completed updat-

ing the Area 22 Service Structure to bring it in line with our needs as we continue to grow. Our archivist is writing the history of the area; standing committees are becoming more active and involved throughout the area working with the districts. We are self-supporting and are now working on improving our prudent reserve. We continue to involve our past delegates as a good source of information to the area. — *Butch Riggins*

Iowa: Area 24 serves Iowa with 20 districts and approximately 650 groups. We have three area committee meetings and two area assemblies each year. Our January committee meeting is our Area Service Weekend. We have a very active committee system that holds several Cluster Meetings each year across the state. In the last few years we have added an area newsletter, computers, and a permanent archivist to our area committee. At present we are looking at better ways to utilize our literature in an effort to better inform our groups. We have been blessed with many fine members who have been willing to give whatever effort is required to continue to make Area 24 the excellent service area it is today. — *Jim Redemske*

Louisiana: In addition to our quarterly area assembly, we have at least nine major annual conventions, including our upcoming 37th State Convention. There are 23 districts with over 525 groups. The standing Archive, Grapevine, P.I., C.P.C., Treatment and Corrections committee chairs serve as voting officers of the assembly. The Archive and Grapevine committees have traveling exhibits for workshops and conventions. We elected a permanent nonvoting archivist to provide continuity and aid the archive chair in acquiring oral and group histories and preserving documents. All committees aid districts in workshop presentation. The Corrections and Treatment committees have made a concentrated effort to set up contacts areawide and cooperate with other areas in "bridging the gap." The area assembly continues to provide a clearinghouse for the free exchange of ideas and information, thus improving our ability to serve the Fellowship with unity—ever mindful of our primary purpose. — *Charles Bartell*

Massachusetts (Eastern): Area 30 has 26 geographical districts and two Spanish districts. There are approximately 2,500 groups/meetings; 1,600 are registered groups, served by five intergroups. Our state convention is a joint venture with Western Mass. Group and district participation is accomplished by five assemblies a year and monthly area committee meetings. To increase group participation, more cluster meetings among districts are being formed to dialogue Conference agenda items. We have very active committees, with P.I. and Corrections being joint committees with Boston Central Service, and Treatment a joint committee with intergroup/central service. Our standing committees include: Service Seminars, Registrar, and *The Messenger*, a service paper five times a year. Our Literature committee was made our seventh permanent committee this year. An Area Handbook is being drafted. We hope this will further inform the Fellowship in Eastern MA about the Three Legacies, especially of service, our structure, and our efforts to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. — *JoAnne Frey*

Michigan (Central): Area 32 covers the eastern half of lower Michigan, 300 miles in length and 200 miles wide. We have floating assembly meetings which are held each month throughout our 14 districts. Many of our districts conduct workshops annually and one has a one-day mini-conference each April. We will host the 1996 Michigan State Conference in Flint. In order to build productive committees and keep the new G.S.R.s "coming back" Area 32 initiated a New G.S.R. Orientation class that is

conducted each month. The orientation class has been a huge success in retaining new G.S.R.s by eliminating the mystery and confusion of area service. We have an active Forum Committee, and are sending approximately 20 new G.S.R.s to the East Central Regional Forum, in Milwaukee, Wisconsin, September 1995. The focus in Area 32 is to get new G.S.R.s into service, and keep them in service, enabling us to maximize our ability to carry the message. — *Sandra Kelly*

Michigan (Southeast): Area 33 consists of 24 districts with over 700 groups and approximately 16,000 members. We have one Spanish-speaking group with three meetings a week, and three separate hearing-impaired groups. We have a combined committee and assembly meeting every month which is held in a permanent, centralized location within our five-county area. Our Literature committee distributes introductory service packets to all new G.S.R.s. We have a new computer that helps our district/group coordinator keep track of new groups and disbanded groups. We were privileged to host the Michigan State Convention in March and will be the host area for the Michigan Young People in A.A. (MCYPAA) Convention in November. In the years that we don't host the state convention, we have a week-end Roundup; there is also an open-participation meeting to discuss Conference Agenda items. Our dedicated and hard-working committee chairs need more people to serve on their committees so we can more effectively carry the message to the still suffering alcoholic and inform the professional community. — *Pam Reising*

Minnesota (Southern): Our area has over 1,000 groups in 25 districts in the last two years. The overall effect of this redistricting has been to bring some new faces into the area and to contact some previously unvisited pockets of groups. D.C.M.s now submit written reports to our area newsletter. This year we will be trying a two-day assembly, allowing time for G.S.R.s to sit in on and participate in one of our area standing committees and more time for fellowship with others from around the area. Our Literature committee has been very active putting on workshops, disseminating information and producing a quarterly newsletter, and an area archivist has been appointed. C.P.C. is exploring ways of carrying the message to professionals. Area 36 is active and is showing a greater willingness to shoulder the responsibility to make sure A.A.'s message is carried and preserved. — *Doug Mead*

Missouri (Eastern): Area 38 has 599 registered groups and 20 districts. We have four assemblies and four committee meetings per year, meeting in a central location. Several past delegates are staying active in area service, where we can draw on their past experience, and many districts sponsor service workshops. Our annual state convention is usually held in July, in a joint effort with Area 39, Western Missouri. This year we conducted an area inventory focusing on service commitment and our Seventh Tradition, two ongoing trouble spots. Our intention is to keep the results of that inventory visible so that we can follow through with suggested remedies. We have an area office with an employee that is supervised by the area through the current delegate and chairperson. Our Archives preserves our history in a collection we are proud of. — *Jeanne Ertmann*

Missouri (Western): We hold four two-day assemblies per year, serving 212 groups and an average of 164 persons. We utilize a rotating "host district" to help with registration, clean up etc. We utilize the birthday plan, group contributions, district donations and convention donations to support area services. Three of our eight standing committees are self-supporting. We moved our Archives into a permanent location in 1994. Our area is excited

about hosting the 1996 Southwest Regional A.A. Service Assembly in Kansas City. Changes in our agenda have resulted in improved D.C.M. and G.S.R. meetings held at each assembly. D.C.M. and G.S.R. reports are given during these meetings with an oral synopsis given to the whole assembly and written reports printed in our area minutes. This gives us more time to discuss problems/solutions, and gives us more time for conducting other area business. — *Karen Williams*

Nevada: Our area includes the entire state of Nevada and two districts in California, east of the Sierras, between Death Valley and the Oregon border. Over the last two years we have grown about 25%, to about 450 groups. In the last two years a committee of the assembly produced a G.S.R. service guide, so that new G.S.R.s would be better and earlier informed. The H&I conference is now an annual event. We have grown from two to six intergroups, with two new central offices; two additional offices are planned. Although growing, Area 42 is still a sparsely populated area with limited human resources. In order to improve our ability to serve the A.A. community, all the committees are joint intergroup/general service functions. The chairs are voting members of both bodies. The area continues to work on self-support at all levels. Due to the high travel costs associated with being a spread-out rural area, roundups are still a substantial source of funds. — *Kevin Doyle*

New Jersey (Northern): Our area has approximately 1,300 groups with 35 districts; one is Spanish-speaking. We are consistently growing, and have a committee actively assisting districts which feel the need to redistrict. This committee is also investigating the possibility of dividing the area into "sections," to enhance communications between the G.S.R.s, the area and A.A. as a whole. Our P.I., C.P.C., T.F., and GV committees are active in carrying the message. Each committee hosts three workshops a year to inform A.A. members of their respective service and how they might get involved. In addition to our already established intergroup office, a new intergroup has been formed in the northern part of our area. We host four assemblies a year. Our June assembly will be a special service assembly commemorating A.A.'s 60th anniversary. Our area committee is solid and is strongly supported by our D.C.M.s. We will continue to extend the hand of A.A. in 1995. — *Bob Simmons*

New York (Central): Area 47 encompasses approximately 14,800 square miles and 19 counties, plus a few hamlets in northern Pennsylvania. There are about 769 groups in 73 districts with 25 registered D.C.M.s. Most districts meet individually or with neighboring districts monthly. The area has 11 assemblies and a convention each year. All eight committees, including our new "special needs" committees, meet at this time. Both the assemblies and the convention are rotated through the area by clusters of districts. The area redistricted in 1992 and, while it was immediately advantageous to the D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s, the area is just now seeing growth by way of new districts in the more populated areas. In 1994 the area reformatted its assemblies, which made it possible for more G.S.R. participation. Area minutes are sent monthly to about 105 trusted servants and 540 groups. It's always our hope to spark an interest and to carry the message to those groups that we don't hear from, and to initiate more fellow A.A.s into the joys of general service. — *Ed Wolf*

New York (Southeast): Although our area has about 2,400 groups, only 1,400 choose to participate through G.S.R.s, and only about one-sixth of these are present at area assemblies. This may be because assemblies are held at different locations throughout the year. There is thus an incentive for G.S.R.s to

attend those assemblies held nearby and skip the rest. Last year representatives of groups from all of our counties were present at an area assembly. Our committee is more regular in attendance with around 60% of the total 130 members (including six Hispanic districts). Efforts to improve service participation continue, including the purchase of translation equipment for use by our Hispanic members. The area hosts general service workshops six times per year and sponsors workshops on P.I., C.P.C., Treatment and Corrections. Last year we hosted the New York State Informational Workshop and our own area convention, and this year we hosted the North East Regional Delegates meeting. Our standing committees remain active. — *Paul Sherman*

North Carolina: Our area has 35 districts, 830 registered groups, 11,770 members in 100 counties. Area committees include Grapevine, C.P.C./P.I., Correctional Facilities, Literature, Site, Archives and Convention. C.P.C./P.I. and Archives have portable traveling displays. There are four committee meetings, two area assemblies, and a State Convention annually. This year all D.C.M.s, alternate D.C.M.s and area officers received an Area Communication Kit, similar to the Conference Kit. Although the area came in under budget in 1994 we face a challenge in increasing participation by the groups for financial support from the 41% of groups that presently contribute, and are also challenged to increase participation by the groups at area assemblies and the State convention. Area 51 is eagerly looking forward to hosting the SE Regional Forum in Asheville in December 1996. — *Bob Reynolds*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: Our area is composed of 16 districts: ten in Nova Scotia, five in Newfoundland and one in Labrador. Winter conditions and long distances necessitate travel by boat or aircraft. We meet as an assembly in the fall, with a service weekend in each province after the Conference. These meetings are composed of workshops, reports and sharing sessions by D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s; items common to all three provinces are left for the annual assembly. Communication by telephone and sharing of minutes from district meetings keep service people well informed. C.P.C., P.I., Treatment Facilities and Institutions work is done at the district level. Alternate G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s often chair these committees. The attendance of G.S.R.s and alternates—in spite of distances and expense—is very good. The history of A.A. is preserved by archivists and displays are shown at service weekends roundups and assemblies. — *Bert Gillis*

Ohio (Central & Southeast): Area 53's trusted servants are very enthusiastic about Panel 45. All eight area standing committees are active: Archives, Convention, Corrections, C.P.C., Grapevine, Intergroup Liaison, P.I., and Treatment. We have 44 districts and 623 registered groups. We hold quarterly area assemblies as well as rotating quarterly D.C.M./area committee meetings. Area 53 is proud to host the ninth annual General Service Convention in Columbus, Ohio on September 8-10, 1995. The theme is "Let It Begin With Me." — *Bill Schmertz*

Ohio (Northeast): Area 54 has over 1,200 groups in 54 districts. We have nine standing committees and a new Special Needs Committee to serve the hearing and sight impaired. A Spanish-speaking committee is being formed. Group contributions have been good, allowing the area to progress with its committee work. Our newsletter, the "NE Ohio Recorder," is published quarterly; we have six intergroup and one central office. We will host the 40th Ohio State Conference, the 18th East Central Regional Conference and the area's 21st Annual Mini-conference in 1996. Most districts meet monthly and our area assem-

bly meets six times a year. The area sponsors two workshops for D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s. Area 54 sees a great need to inform the Fellowship of the importance of service, our Third Legacy, which may dispel some of the apathy in our area. Changing times and styles pose a problem for some oldtimers at meetings. In spite of this we are trying to keep focused on our primary purpose and carry an undiluted message of hope to alcoholics who come through our doors. — *George O'Neil*

Oklahoma: We have 374 registered groups, divided into eight districts, which are served by six D.C.M.s each and several alternate D.C.M.s. Sixty-six percent of the groups are contributing. The Oklahoma Gratitude Plan accounted for \$4,945.37 in contributions. Our state conference in May was attended by 1,650. One of the problems in Area 57 seems to be the lack of participation and apathy, at both the district and area levels, in service work. One district is going to try a new concept for a District Workshop. Each D.C.M. and alternate will approach the groups they serve and recruit two or three from each group to serve on various committees for the workshop. The committees will plan the location, topics, set-up, pot luck, clean-up, etc. It is hoped that this will involve each group in the district and bring more new people into service work. Our area service committees are active in carrying the message to both the suffering alcoholic and to those who may cooperate with us to reach out to those who still suffer. — *Phyllis McCoy*

Ontario (Eastern): It has been an interesting year in Area 83 with lots of accomplishments. Our books were audited for the first time and the Ad Hoc Committee on Expenses made recommendations. We had a few interesting assemblies with a great deal of participation and have learned to listen—when all along we thought that we were. The election of our area committee was one of the best, starting at 2:30 and finishing at 7:00. The G.S.R.s were not leaving until they had done their job. The love and spirituality evident throughout the process gave the elections an emotional high I had never experienced before. Our first area committee meeting started and finished on a very positive note. — *Ray Mitchell*

Ontario (Northeast): Area 84 has 164 groups in eight districts with approximately 2,293 members. We have one intergroup office that is very active and is in the process of building a display case to hold the area Archives. Since the area is so large in distance, with many remote areas, we only have one two-day assembly a year. There are three more committee meetings during the year in which the eight D.C.M.s are very active. G.S.R.s and guests are welcome and asked for their input. The D.C.M.s attempt to visit all groups in their districts at least once a year. Our area newsletter is published four times a year. We also have a committee working on a Directory for the area. We have a conference every year that moves between three of the larger districts. Only 93 groups have contributed at the area level last year. We have started workshops at the area assemblies that have been well received and many of the districts hold workshops before their district meetings. — *Jack Sanderson*

Ontario (Northwest): Area 85 has 1,500 members in eight districts. We are large in size but small in numbers; some G.S.R.s travel 300-450 miles to district meetings and assemblies. We have two assemblies and two committee meetings. The delegate also gives reports on Conference agenda at most district and area roundups. Our area hosted the Eastern Canada Regional Forum last fall. We are achieving some progress carrying the message to the native alcoholics; several native groups have started and we are seeing more at our meetings and hope to have a few meetings on some remote reserves as soon as

winter roads are opened. One district has made a literature kit to be sent to new groups starting in the North. Our Corrections committee has 25 members working with inmates one-on-one five times per week at the correctional farm, and we have a registered group there. We are trying to form better relations with the treatment center, but this has been slow. We are growing in service; we have grown from 30% active groups to 41% in the last year. Our area is doing a very good job carrying the message. — *Norman Ames*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): Area 59 has 1,366 groups, 303 meetings, and nine intergroups in 45 districts. Unity best describes our present condition. Our area committee holds quarterly meetings and we currently have nine area subcommittees. We hold four mini-assemblies at different area locations to enable the delegate to give his/her report of the Conference directly to our groups. Our convention/assembly is attended yearly by more than 1,000. We have begun what we call "Area Day," a symposium to inform our membership of what our area structure is, how we function, and why we exist. The area annually hosts an Area/Intergroup/Central Office Workshop. We also participate with five of our nine intergroups in "Days of Sharing." Our area's topics for this panel are: How better to reach the alcoholic who wants sobriety; how to have greater participation in our Seventh Tradition; how to increase our Grapevine subscriptions; to get back to basics; and how to maintain our unity. — *Joseph Quinlan*

Quebec (Northeast): Our area comprises 21 districts, 370 groups and about 7,000 members, spread over a large territory. We also have ten area committees to serve local districts. We hold two general assemblies a year for G.S.R.s and four area committee assemblies for D.C.M.s. An area's office in Quebec City is open 20 hours a week to give the service needed by districts and groups. In May we will host a special Regional Forum. In September we will hold an area inventory to keep ourselves in the right line and improve the way we serve. The only challenge we face is to give, day after day, a better service. We try, in our daily action, to keep in mind the only goal of our existence: Save a life by passing on our message. — *Jeannot Bouchard*

Quebec (Southeast): The distance from one end of our area to the other is about 1,000 miles (one district is on an island 90 miles out at sea). Each of our 20 districts has its own P.I. coordinator and GvR. We have four area meetings annually plus one general assembly. We have 230 groups that hold 259 meetings per week; 171 open and 88 closed. On our "day of delegate" in March, we hold workshops to discuss Conference topics. Each year there are two dinners of gratitude where members express their gratitude toward A.A. and the delegate reports on the Conference. — *Aimé Imbeault*

Texas (Northeast): Area 65, covering approximately 70,000 square miles, has 29 districts, two of which are Spanish-speaking. The area is equally rural and urban. At the center is Dallas/Ft. Worth with about 3.7 million, surrounded by several smaller metropolitan centers. The rest consists of 30 or 40 miles of prairie and/or rugged terrain punctuated by towns of a few thousand. These towns usually house an A.A. group which meets 3 or 4 times a week. Most districts have the delegate give both pre-Conference and post-Conference reports. Sometimes several districts will combine in one meeting for these events. Many districts are involved in P.I., C.P.C., C.F. & T.F. at the local level, but still keep their focus on worldwide issues to assist the delegate in being informed of the area conscience on these matters. We hold four assemblies each year and rotate hosting districts. The area committee meets four times a year. From the

piney woods of E. Texas to the rugged prairie lands, A.A. is considered serious business. Its members will go to any length to preserve it for future generations.—*Jim Tims*

Texas (Southeast): Our area is alive and growing, with 16 districts covering over 500 square miles. Three times a year our assembly meets for committee meetings, D.C.M.-delegate sharing sessions, several workshops, and to handle the business of the assembly. In January we hold our annual convention and assembly weekend. Our P.I., C.P.C., Treatment, Correctional, Grapevine, and Archives committees are all very active. Two years ago we formed a Finance committee to look at any item we might need to purchase, or other expenses that might arise that are not in our projected budget. The Spanish-speaking community has two very active districts which are well represented at the area level. In the past two years translation equipment has been purchased so that we can better communicate.—*Rodney Rabren*

Utah: Area 69 serves the entire state, three central offices attempting self-support through group contributions, and Conference-approved literature. We have 10 districts that hold monthly meetings, and approximately 285 groups. We hold three annual assemblies, pre-Conference, post-Conference, and fall election; the area committee meets five times yearly. Our standing committees are lacking in participation, but with newly impaneled committee chairs, we anticipate activity to increase. Our C.P.C. committee cooperates with many outside organizations, including the annual school on alcoholism. Our Corrections committee is receiving numerous requests for help from new satellite facilities. Treatment is challenged with continually responding to the fluxuating situations experienced by the facilities within our area. We celebrated Utah's 50th A.A. birthday in 1994, and our Archives committee is completing a history book of our area. Focus on the Traditions and the Concepts with better communication is the foundation for our future activities and growth in the coming year.—*Tom Finn*

Virginia: Area 71 has 38 districts with over 1,100 groups. There are ten area committees and five special assignments: Archives, Conventions, Intergroup, Corrections, C.P.C., Budget and Finance, Grapevine and Literature, Growth, P.I., Treatment; and Archivist, Arrangements, Newsletter Editor, Mailing List Coordinator and Sound Engineer. The D.C.M.s, committee chairs, special assignment and area officers come together twice a year to set the agenda for our spring and fall assemblies, where the whole area takes part. For the last few years we have had over 400 people at the assemblies. There are usually six workshops at each assembly; most districts hold regular workshops on a single topic and some districts hold one-day service functions like mini-assemblies. —

Bob Hickey



Washington: Our area includes Washington state, the SE corner of British Columbia, small portions of Oregon, Montana and the panhandle of Idaho. We have six elected officers and 14 appointed officers. Our active standing committees include P.I., C.P.C., Grapevine/Literature, Treatment, and Correctional Facilities. D.C.M.s and officers meet three times a year. Due to redistricting in the last four years our area has grown from 29 districts to 56, serving close to 1,400 groups. One district in the eastern region, with a large Hispanic community, serves to carry the message and provide service opportunity to Spanish-speaking A.A.s. We encourage service workshops and little assemblies throughout the year and the support from the membership has been excellent with about 60% or more participation. This year is our first year to have an area registrar. It is exciting to see clusters of groups for hearing-impaired A.A.s forming. Our area archives is close to the geographical center, in Yakima, Washington. Pass It On. —*Ernie Mills*

West Virginia: We started our year with newly-elected trusted servants and our Spring Assembly Agenda meeting, held in January. For the most part our main objective was the distribution of names and addresses for mailings and communication. Our area stresses the importance of Unity and remembering our primary purpose. Our 800 number within the state has always been a controversial issue and a costly one too. A committee is researching prices and reviewing the types of calls we are receiving. 1994 brought a few much needed changes, due to the growth of A.A. within our state. We have many rural areas that do not have the advantages of the larger cities, such as hosting assemblies/conventions. Our area is not only divisional by districts, but now we have regions (7). This will help in connecting the smaller districts to join with the larger districts, not only with assemblies/conventions, but Unity also. We also have committees for Finance/Budget; Assemblies/Conventions; and Archives. The overall message—Unity, Service and Recovery. —*Marty Wright*

Wisconsin (Southern): Area 75 has 908 registered groups and 17,500 members, with 37 districts, most with active service committees. Our area has eight service committees. The Literature, Archives, and Grapevine committees have traveling displays for area workshops and conferences. The Grapevine committees have active "Count On Us" programs for Corrections. Most districts have active Corrections committees, and offer meetings at state, county, city, and half-way centers—about 70 meetings a week inside correctional facilities. The Bridging the Gap committee has a monthly meeting to coordinate a program for Treatment as well as Corrections. P.I. and C.P.C. committees are working in some districts with the universities and high schools as well as holding conferences and workshops for teachers, judges, and parole staff members. We have a service newsletter, published four times a year. The area has started a Third Legacy workshop each month in Milwaukee, which will travel to any district upon request. We will host the East Central Regional Forum September 29, 30, October 1, 1995 in Milwaukee.—*Bill Anderson*

How do you lose a 6'5", ??? pound, sober Australian trustee? Well, it happened at Yankee Stadium Friday night when Trevor H., was separated from a group of delegates and trustees. Ironically, Trevor made it back to the hotel before the rest of the gang did!

Additional Committee Considerations That Did Not Result in Recommendations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Conference Report." Those committee recommendations which are not adopted (less than 2/3 of the total Conference votes in favor), but which received at least a simple majority of the votes, are considered "strong suggestions" of the Conference. All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- A letter to the committee chairperson regarding Seccion Mexico was discussed and found to be outside the scope of this committee.
- The committee discussed whether there is a need for a specific place in the Conference Agenda to discuss the needs and current challenges of the A.A. groups in the U.S. and Canada and unanimously agreed that this is an issue for areas, districts and groups.
- The committee discussed the submission of floor actions at the General Service Conference and unanimously agreed to ask the 1996 Policy/Admissions Committee to consider that the submission of all floor actions be withheld until after the voting on committee reports.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee discussed the suggestion for a thorough review of all C.P.C. literature and service material to insure that duplication is avoided and that A.A.'s primary purpose is clearly stated.

The committee requests that the trustees' C.P.C. Committee begin a thorough review of all C.P.C. literature and service material, and send a progress report as background to the 1996 Conference C.P.C. Committee. The goals of the literature review would be to:

- a) Encourage that A.A.'s single purpose is foremost.
 - b) Make suggestions for eliminating unnecessary duplication and redundancy.
 - c) Look for opportunities to simplify and clarify C.P.C. information.
 - d) Explore the possibility of combining two or more existing pieces.
 - e) Review titles of existing C.P.C. information and suggest changes as appropriate.
- The committee recognized with appreciation the preliminary work and suggestions on the "Alcoholics Anonymous and Employee Assistance Programs" leaflet by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee, and urged that the ideas presented be considered in the thorough review of all C.P.C. literature to be undertaken by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee.
 - After thorough discussion on the suggestion that a video be developed for internal A.A. use to encourage participation in C.P.C. service work and to provide suggestions for making presentations to professional groups, the Committee decided to take no action because of the availability of less expensive

methods to encourage A.A. members to participate in C.P.C. service work.

- The committee felt that the literature review underway and the publication of the new C.P.C. Workbook respond to the need for specifics on presentations to professional groups.
- The committee discussed these two questions: 1) Are we doing enough to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic who still suffers inside and outside of the Fellowship?; and, 2) Are we meeting the needs of those we serve, or have we become self-serving?

- The committee concluded that these were wonderful inventory questions that inspired a thoughtful exchange of ideas. The concerns raised by these questions guided us in our deliberations of other Agenda items.

Strong suggestion of the Conference (recommendation where the vote was less than 2/3, but more than 1/2 in favor):

- After reviewing the history of the guidelines for traveling C.P.C. exhibits, that the trustees' C.P.C. Committee continue to follow these principles:

- a) The C.P.C. exhibit continue to be sent, upon invitation and within budgetary constraints, to such national conventions of professional organizations that may be reasonably presumed to have a significant concern with alcoholics.
- b) The list of exhibits at professional conventions be reviewed by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee at least twice a year.
- c) Local committees be encouraged to exhibit at local or regional professional conventions, and that such exhibits be supported at the most appropriate local level, i.e., district, intergroup, area.
- d) The C.P.C. staff person continue to facilitate such requests, bearing in mind the principles of attraction, cooperation and self-support.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee voted not to proceed with studying the feasibility of an audio cassette to encourage A.A. members to get involved in carrying the message to members inside the walls. It was felt that such a cassette was not needed at this time.
- The committee decided that it was not desirable or feasible to have a firm policy that G.S.O. send a Big Book to every inmate who requested one. It was felt that this should be left more to the autonomy of area and local Correctional Facilities committees.
- The committee accepted a report of the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee on proposed minor editorial changes in the Correctional Facilities Workbook. The staff was asked to work with Publications to make the requested changes in the next printing of the C.F. Workbook.
- The committee discussed a suggestion to add to the workbook more guidelines for taking meetings into juvenile detention centers. The committee reviewed a report from area correctional facilities chairs and agreed with a majority of area chairs responding that separate guidelines were not desirable at this time.
- The committee asked the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee to study ways to get more A.A. members involved in the Correctional Correspondence Service, noting that G.S.O. usually has a list of male inmates waiting for correspondence, and that most area committees are not at this time set up to provide Correspondence Services.

- The committee voted to ask the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee to discontinue development of a letter to wardens of correctional facilities in the U.S. and Canada providing information about Alcoholics Anonymous, citing the need for local autonomy.
- The committee voted to change the first paragraph on page six of the Correctional Facilities Workbook, at its next printing, to include various types of long-term and short-term correctional facilities where the message may be carried by C.F. committees.

FINANCE

- The committee discussed the proposal that the General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous be separately incorporated as a wholly owned corporation of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous and concluded with substantial unanimity it was not necessary to separately incorporate G.S.O.
- The committee considered the proposal that:

Prices of the Big Book and other literature sold by A.A.W.S. be gradually reduced over a seven-year period to their cost of production and distribution and;

Prices of the individual items sold by A.A.W.S. may be above or below their individual cost and different levels of discounts can be established by A.A.W.S. for different categories of customers as long as the overall revenue from the sales of the Big Book and other literature is equal to the overall cost of their production and distribution and;

A.A.W.S. present each Conference with a report that shows: (1) the cost of producing and distributing the Big Book and other literature sold by A.A.W.S.; (2) the current prices; and (3) the expected prices over the remaining years of the seven-year period; and unanimously concluded that the proposal did not need to be implemented. The committee unanimously supported the current efforts of A.A.W.S. to reduce literature prices.
- The committee reviewed history of Conference delegates fees, area contributions, and past advisory actions and were unanimous in taking no action.
- The committee reviewed history of the maximum contribution G.S.O. may accept from an individual in one year and was unanimous in its decision to take no action.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee discussed editorial content of the Grapevine and urged that the editorial policy of the Grapevine continue to follow our Statement of Purpose.
- The committee discussed a letter regarding the proposed generic Grapevine and unanimously suggested that the Grapevine Corporate Board not produce a generic Grapevine at this time, but rather, continue to focus on our Statement of Purpose and increasing subscriptions of the Grapevine.
- The committee discussed a list from the Grapevine Corporate Board of proposed related items for production in 1997 and suggested that no action be taken and that an additional proposal be presented to the 1996 Conference Grapevine Committee for possible production in 1998.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed the proposed additions to the "Landmarks in A.A. History" section in *A.A. Comes of Age* and

referred it back to the trustees' Literature Committee for further review regarding the true historical significance of various events in A.A. (i.e. publication dates of various books, International Conventions, and deaths of Milton Maxwell, Dr. Jack Norris, Sister Ignatia and Dr. Silkworth.) The committee suggested that either all major events in A.A. history be inserted or the "Landmarks in A.A. History" section remain as it is written.

- The committee reviewed the report "Should There Be a Fourth Edition of the Big Book, A Report on Area Response" and concluded there was no need to publish a Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, at this time.

There is evidence in the Area Report of some interest in the Fourth Edition, but the committee felt that it was not conclusive. The committee believed that, if more information in the proposed content of a Fourth Edition were made available to the Fellowship, there could be a more definitive response.

The committee referred the idea of a Fourth Edition back to the trustees' Literature Committee suggesting they prepare an outline of the proposed content of a Fourth Edition for consideration at the next Conference. This outline could indicate the proposed changes including which stories would be dropped and what kinds of stories would be added—keeping in mind A.A.'s singleness of purpose.

If the next Conference Literature Committee agrees, a new questionnaire could then be sent out to the Fellowship through area delegates in order to gauge the level of interest in a Fourth Edition.

- The committee considered whether or not the first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, should have the same rewrite status as the Steps, Traditions and Warranties of Article XII of the Conference Charter. The committee tabled any action in light of the previous recommendation at this Conference regarding no changes in the first 164 pages of the Big Book, the Preface, the Forewords, "The Doctor's Opinion," "Doctor Bob's Nightmare" and the Appendices, and referred the agenda item to the Conference Report and Charter Committee for discussion at the 1996 Conference.
- The committee considered a request to prepare a pamphlet on a portion of the "Doctor's Opinion" from the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, and felt there was no need at this time.
- The committee considered a request to publish a new A.A. book (suggested title "Our Stories"), comprised of Bill's and Dr. Bob's stories, and stories from the First and Second Editions of the Big Book which were not included in the Third Edition. In view of the request asking the trustees' Literature Committee to prepare a questionnaire and an outline on a Fourth Edition, the committee felt this question could be added to the questionnaire in order to get feedback from all areas so that an informed decision could be made at a future Conference.
- The committee discussed a request for a pamphlet, an information piece, a video or inclusion of a section in *The A.A. Service Manual* on the "Circle and Triangle." The committee felt that the 1994 Conference recommendation on the discontinuance of the circle and triangle logo on all Conference-approved literature was sufficient, and that there was no need for additional material. (Use of A.A.'s trademarks and logos is also explained in *The A.A. Service Manual*, 1994-1995 edition, page S103.)

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee discussed the following questions:

Does the Conference accurately reflect the needs and concerns of A.A. groups?

Has the Conference become too important to some and unimportant to many? If so, how can we bring our focus and involvement into balance?

Do we have a sufficient number of A.A. groups desiring to participate in the Conference to afford a reliable cross section of A.A. opinion to ensure that the Conference continues to be the actual and effective conscience for our whole society, or has the Conference become a minority voice?

The committee recognizes these questions as legitimate and feels that a short report of our discussion would be inadequate. We further recognize the need for continuing discussion at all levels and request that this sharing proceed and that reports of that sharing be sent to the Policy/Admissions Committee.

- The committee requests that the trustees' Committee on the Conference include the 1995 recommendation regarding floor actions in the Conference Kit which goes to all Conference members each January.
- The committee requests that the trustees' Committee on the Conference provide space on the agenda for an Archives presentation on alternating years.

Strong suggestions of the Conference (recommendation where the vote was less than 2/3, but more than 1/2 in favor):

- The Conference reaffirm the 1986 recommendations regarding floor actions:

"With regard to proposing Floor Actions in the final hours of the Conference the 1968 recommendation, which was as follows, be reaffirmed:

'That when questions of importance for the Conference could not be sent to the areas in advance, consideration be given to an oral presentation early in the Conference sessions, with discussions and voting to be taken at a later date during the Conference.'

And that the 1986 recommendation, as follows, be reaffirmed:

"That when matters of great significance having a long term effect on the Fellowship or of substantial expense are presented to the floor in the waning hour of the Conference, such matters be referred to the appropriate committee at the next Conference in order for the group conscience to be as informed as possible."

- The 1987 Conference Action be reaffirmed as follows:

"While the committee recognizes the need for and encourages the development of area Archives and Archives committees, with the resulting benefit to General Service and the Fellowship as a whole, a Conference Archives Committee should not be formed at this time because the needs of local Archives committees are being well served by the trustees' Archives Committee and the General Service Office Archivist."

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee discussed as it relates to Public Information whether we are doing enough to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic who still suffers inside and outside A.A., and felt that though we are doing well, we can always do better by informing the membership of the tools and the methods available for public information. One delegate described the skit presented in their area to show members how to do public information talks/presentations to schools and others. This skit will be sent

to the General Service Office to aid in preparing an article in the P.I. section of *Box 4-5-9*.

- The committee discussed whether we are meeting the needs of those we serve, or if we have become self-serving and definitely agreed that we are not self-serving as long as we keep our egos in check, keep an open mind and that decisions can be reached to meet the needs of those we serve.
- The committee reviewed the Public Information Workbook and were enthusiastic about the new and concise format and made no changes. One suggestion was to include the guide letters separately in the folder for those committees who might not have access to a typewriter/word processor, but the committee felt that these letters are guides/examples and should have some local personalization before they are sent out.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed the suggestion to review the entire manuscript of the *Twelve Concepts for World Service in The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition), reaffirm the Twelve Concepts, and amend current practices to reflect these principles. After reviewing the manuscript of the Twelve Concepts, the committee felt it is not necessary to reaffirm them. As far as amending current practices, it was felt this was outside the defined scope of this committee.
- After reviewing the section in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition) entitled "Past Delegates Can Be Helpful" to determine if there is a need to update, expand, or relocate the position of this text to reflect current activities and practices, the committee felt that no changes are necessary at this time.
- The committee reviewed the wording for the method of Conference approval of the trustees' slate, officers of the General Service Board and directors of corporate boards used throughout the "Current Conference Charter" (page S31), Bylaws of the General Service Board (page S106) and *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition) for consistency with Article 10 of the "Original Conference Charter—1955" (page S26), and found no inconsistencies.
- After reviewing Article Two, paragraph four of the "Current Conference Charter" (page S31) in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition), the committee did not find it contrary to the spirit of Warranty Six, Concept XII, or in conflict with Tradition Four (Long Form) and Warranties Three, Four and Five.
- The committee considered the suggestion that the term "ex-alcoholic" as it appears in the Bylaws of the General Service Board be replaced with another term. The committee felt that since the term "ex-alcoholic" is adequately defined in the Bylaws of the General Service Board on pages S109-110 of *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition), no change is necessary.
- The committee considered whether the section "Conference Language" in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition) should be placed before the Conference Charter, and felt no change was necessary.
- The committee considered whether the definition of an A.A. group in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition) should be placed before that of the G.S.R., and felt no change was necessary.
- The committee considered whether the definition of a district in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition) should be placed before that of the D.C.M., and felt no change was necessary.
- The committee considered whether the section in Personal

Views entitled "How I Got Interested in General Service" should be placed as early as possible in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition), and felt no change was necessary.

- The committee considered whether the following statement on page S55 in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition) be deleted: "We are actually asking them to take time out from the nuts and bolts of recovery to think about another phase of their new lives—this one seemingly very long-range," and felt no change was necessary.

- The committee considered including information in Chapters II and III in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition) on rotation similar to the language used about delegate rotation, and felt no change was necessary.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- Are we doing enough to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic who still suffers inside and outside of the Fellowship?

We will probably never do enough to carry our message to the alcoholic who still suffers inside and outside the Fellowship, but we can become involved in the treatment facilities service, i.e. informing non-A.A. people about what A.A. can and cannot do, carrying meetings into treatment facilities, helping long term patients start their own meetings, providing "bridging the gap" service, providing A.A. literature, and most importantly taking time to share one on one; and in all areas of service realize the importance of keeping commitments. The inventory process is invaluable in helping us discover what we need to do and of course, sponsorship is where it all begins.

- Are we meeting the needs of those we serve, or have we become self-serving?

A.A. is a "selfish program"—the more we serve others the better our quality of sobriety seems to be. We become self-serving when we try to take the "easier softer way" by taking the alcoholic to a treatment facility with no A.A. followup. Once again, it's important to remember to sponsor "one on one." Let's not become complacent by letting our literature do our Twelve Step work for us.

- Give examples of how treatment facilities committees can keep members aware of the usefulness of A.A. tools, i.e., films, literature and the A.A. Grapevine, in their service work.

Many treatment facilities committees meet regularly to share experience and seek help. Roundtable discussions and workshops are wonderful ways for new workers to benefit from the experience of A.A. members who have been longer in service. Some A.A. tools are: Treatment Facilities Workbook; A.A. Pamphlets (particularly "A.A. and Treatment Facilities" and "Bridging the Gap"); the A.A. Grapevine; and Videos: "Hope," "A.A. An Inside View," "A.A. Come Rap With Us," and "It Sure Beats Sitting In A Cell."

- How have changes and cutbacks in treatment facilities services affected the work of A.A.?

Changes and cutbacks in treatment facilities services have provided more opportunity in many areas for A.A. members to give "hands-on service" to alcoholics coming to A.A. after brief inpatient treatment, and also to those who are receiving some type of outpatient treatment or simple detox. Many of our newer members have never had the chance to work with a "wet drunk." Treatment Facilities Committee members need to recognize the importance of meeting newcomers "where they are." They may be a day or an hour away from a drink—or may be sober several weeks and familiar with the A.A. program.

- Review Treatment Facilities Workbook. Discuss possibility of revising format to conform with Public Information and Correctional Facilities Workbooks:

After much discussion on the pros and cons of changing the format of the Treatment Facilities Workbook, the committee unanimously agreed that the workbook is more useful in its current loose-leaf binder form.

CONFERENCE COMMITTEE ON TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed a draft of the Procedures for Formation of New Regions and/or Alterations in the Regional Map and expressed appreciation to the trustees' Nominating Committee for the work accomplished to date. It was the sense of the committee that more specific information is needed regarding changes in regional boundaries and how the need for additional regional trustees would be met. Therefore, the proposed procedure is being returned to the trustees' Nominating Committee for further work with assurance that suggestions and input from members of the Conference Committee on Trustees will be forthcoming.

- The committee considered the suggestion to approve new trustees individually and unanimously agreed that current procedures are satisfactory.

- The committee reviewed and approved as eligible for election all candidates for regional trustee for Northeast and Southwest U.S. and for Trustee-at-Large/Canada.

The 45th General Service Conference Voted Not to Consider the Following Proposed Floor Actions:

Floor Action #1 (proposal not considered):

That the A.A.W.S. Board's permission to Great Britain to adapt the *Twelve Concepts for World Service* for their own requirements be withdrawn pending review and recommendation by the Conference Report and Charter Committee at the 1996 General Service Conference.

Floor Action #2 (proposal not considered):

Area 44 requests that the 21 trustees of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous meet with representatives of the two service structures in Mexico (Central and Seccion). The purpose of this meeting, if needed, is to mediate the conflict and to bring to the 1996 Conference recommendations which would preclude reoccurrence of this type of conflict in any other situation/country.

Floor Action #3 (proposal not considered):

Seccion Mexico has sent three letters to our General Service Conference asking the Conference to review their petitions of grievance, which is their right under Concept V of World Service. To fulfill our spiritual responsibility I propose the following motion:

"That this Conference review and discuss these petitions and forward a response to Seccion Mexico"

Floor Action #4 (proposal not considered):

The Conference recommends that the General Service Board and its subsidiary boards, A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc., initiate no litigation in defense of copyrights and trademarks, in accordance with Tradition 10 and Warranty 5.

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**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.**
COMBINED STATEMENTS OF INCOME, EXPENSES AND CHANGES IN NET ASSETS
Years Ended December 31, 1994 and 1993

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Combined 1994	Combined 1993
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund				
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE							
Gross Sales				\$ 9,635,074	\$1,987,948	\$11,623,022	\$11,764,662
Less: Discounts				547,011	39,375	586,386	449,087
Net Sales				9,088,063	1,948,573	11,036,636	11,315,575
Cost of Literature Distributed							
Printing				(2,974,247)	(371,192)	(3,345,439)	(3,344,585)
Royalties on books				(885,108)	-	(885,108)	(956,499)
Gross Margin				5,228,708	1,577,381	6,806,089	7,014,491
Direct shipping and warehousing				(833,402)	(414,378)	(1,247,780)	(1,218,320)
Gross Profit from Literature				4,395,306	1,163,003	5,558,309	5,796,171
CONTRIBUTIONS - A.A. Groups and Members	\$ 3,855,445					3,855,445	3,808,665
INVESTMENT INCOME	2,685	\$ 545,080		5,905	76,092	629,762	593,930
Total Income	3,858,130	545,080		4,401,211	1,239,095	10,043,516	10,198,766
OPERATING EXPENSES (Schedule A-1)							
Salaries	2,410,275			1,253,163	704,953	4,368,391	4,295,794
Payroll taxes	188,515			97,720	55,921	342,156	344,589
Health and group insurance	400,961			201,119	101,989	704,069	706,333
Retirement expense	166,515			86,593	39,971	293,079	324,649
	3,166,266			1,638,595	902,834	5,707,695	5,671,365
Other operating expenses	2,198,392			649,186	417,890	3,265,468	3,245,342
Total Operating Expenses	5,364,658			2,287,781	1,320,724	8,973,163	8,916,707
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(1,506,528)	545,080		2,113,430	(81,629)	1,070,353	1,282,059
NET ASSETS							
Balance, January 1	57,013	7,942,972	\$ 1,858,503	2,423,124	502,568	12,784,180	11,850,175
Decrease - depreciation on capital projects			(287,011)			(287,011)	(348,054)
			1,571,492			13,567,522	12,784,180
Intercompany donations	1,506,528	767,250	-	(2,206,528)	(67,250)	-	-
Balance, December 31	57,013	9,255,302	1,571,492	2,330,026	353,689	13,567,522	12,784,180

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.**

SCHEDULE OF OPERATING EXPENSES BY ACTIVITY

Years Ended December 31, 1994 and 1993

	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	Regional Forums	International Convention	Publishing	Grapevine	Supporting Services	1994 Total	1993 Total
Operating Expenses											
Salaries	\$ 604,398	\$ 636,012	\$ 94,302		\$ 54,330	\$ 109,858	\$ 712,196	\$ 416,854	\$1,740,441	\$4,368,391	\$4,295,794
Payroll taxes	46,284	49,949	6,698		4,751	8,501	54,957	30,709	140,307	342,156	344,589
Health and group insurance	119,316	77,325	10,847		5,477	10,847	100,261	51,707	328,289	704,069	706,333
Retirement expense	40,872	44,108	5,915		4,196	7,507	48,530	23,210	118,741	293,079	324,649
Other program printing	223,186	22,364	68,665	\$ 5,692	5,079		1,252		2,229	328,467	418,551
Mailing labor	99,188	1,305	385	450	2,747		6,000		321	110,396	85,448
Postage and express	169,770	19,758	15,774	1,899	9,701	692	13,050	16,647	22,324	269,615	262,095
Writers fees	15,296	1,010	11,599	580	720		12,491			41,696	26,968
Foreign literature assistance		134,593								134,593	99,507
Selling expenses	1,945						51,824	119,580	1,961	175,310	176,111
Professional fees									182,333	182,333	208,419
Contracted services	3,643	36,150	366	11,180	167	606	8,770	22,218	33,456	116,556	113,240
Occupancy	76,669	76,774	6,079		3,039	6,079	102,301	65,726	291,870	628,537	600,821
Telephone	22,338	15,531	2,126		1,063	2,126	17,915	10,284	51,273	122,656	112,319
Equipment maintenance	1,649	400					1,626		49,092	52,767	77,310
Furniture and equipment	800	157					1,745		90,927	93,629	103,215
Stationery and office supplies	64,534	1,195	3,564	1,658	5,554	12	1,988	19,420	67,371	165,296	162,578
Office service and expense	5,809	3,227	4,705	4,122	1,639	336	13,325	19,421	160,681	213,265	186,913
Travel, meals and accommodations	791	18,624	295,362	122,213	48,772	50	8,137		302,728	796,677	658,868
Bad Debts									22,306	22,306	18,476
Delegate fees			(76,000)	(112,631)						(188,631)	(65,497)
	1,496,488	1,138,482	450,387	35,163	147,235	146,614	1,156,368	795,776	3,606,650	8,973,163	8,916,707
Allocation of supporting services to activities	854,795	650,301	257,261	20,085	84,101	83,746	1,131,413	524,948	(3,606,650)	-	-
Total Operating Expenses	<u>2,351,283</u>	<u>1,788,783</u>	<u>707,648</u>	<u>55,248</u>	<u>231,336</u>	<u>230,360</u>	<u>2,287,781</u>	<u>1,320,724</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>8,973,163</u>	<u>8,916,707</u>
Services	\$2,351,283	\$1,788,783	\$707,648	\$ 55,248	\$231,336	\$230,360				\$5,364,658	\$5,258,865
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$2,287,781			2,287,781	2,371,872
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$1,320,724		1,320,724	1,285,970
COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 1993	<u>\$2,267,411</u>	<u>\$1,889,876</u>	<u>\$731,451</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>\$312,549</u>	<u>\$ 57,578</u>	<u>\$2,371,872</u>	<u>\$1,285,970</u>		<u>8,973,163</u>	<u>8,916,707</u>
										<u>\$8,916,707</u>	

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
COMBINED BALANCE SHEETS**

Years Ended December 31, 1994 and 1993

	General Service Board of A.A.				A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Combined 1994	Combined 1993
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Convention Fund				
ASSETS								
Cash	\$ 921,248	\$ 954,819		\$1,179,647	\$ 897,710	\$ 100,865	\$ 4,054,289	\$ 1,920,370
Accounts and interest receivable		157,773		49,355	153,089	40,114	400,331	402,438
Intercompany balances	(914,224)	(828,709)		(527,465)	1,040,508	1,229,890	-	-
Inventories								
Books, pamphlets, etc.					1,014,812	151,321	1,166,133	1,300,173
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.					60,958	59,767	120,725	104,706
Investments								
U.S. Treasury Notes, due 1995/2004, at cost (market value: 1994 - \$8,756,440; 1993 - \$9,213,425)		8,971,419					8,971,419	8,729,852
Fixed Assets								
Leasehold improvements, computer hardware and software (net of accumulated depreciation - 1994 - \$1,654,199; 1993 - \$1,367,188)			\$1,571,492				1,571,492	1,858,503
Deferred charges	49,989			544,296	66,908	54,946	716,139	391,944
Other assets					20,251		20,251	20,751
Total Assets	57,013	9,255,302	1,571,492	1,245,833	3,254,236	1,636,903	17,020,779	14,728,737
LIABILITIES								
Accounts payable					\$ 647,868	\$ 80,765	\$ 728,633	\$ 479,371
Accrued royalties					207,247		207,247	245,862
Deferred income								
Orders and subscriptions					69,095	1,202,449	1,271,544	1,219,324
Advance registration fees				\$1,245,833			1,245,833	-
Total Liabilities	-	-	-	1,245,833	924,210	1,283,214	3,453,257	1,944,557
Net Assets (Exhibit A)	\$ 57,013	\$ 9,255,302	\$1,571,492	-	2,330,026	353,689	13,567,522	12,784,180
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	57,013	9,255,302	1,571,492	1,245,833	3,254,236	1,636,903	17,020,779	14,728,737

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITOR'S OPINION

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10115

February 22, 1995

Ladies and Gentlemen:

We have audited the accompanying combined balance sheets of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. and its wholly owned subsidiaries, ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC., as of December 31, 1994 and 1993, and the related combined statements of income, expenses and changes in fund balances for the years then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the organization's management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audits.

We conducted our audits in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audits provide a reasonable basis for our opinion.

In our opinion, the financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the combined financial position of the three corporations named above as of December 31, 1994 and 1993, and the combined results of their operations for the years then ended in conformity with generally accepted accounting principles.

Respectfully submitted,
Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants

**THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.
NOTES TO COMBINED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
DECEMBER 31, 1994 AND 1993**

Note 1 Organization

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. is a not-for-profit corporation organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world. In furtherance of that objective, the organization also publishes books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to the A.A. program through two wholly owned not-for-profit corporations, A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in four separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND—This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was redefined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. That committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That Advisory Action was approved by the board of trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers, and, therefore, they are reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND—This fund was established in 1990, with retroactive effect to 1989, to account for the costs of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects; and also to record annual depreciation on such assets.

The CONVENTION FUND—This is a separate fund established to record the income and expenses of the International A.A. Convention to be held in San

Diego, California in July 1995. This event, which is held every five years, is separate from the regular operations and structure of the General Service Office, but the General Fund receives any excess of income, or pays any excess of expense, resulting from the activity.

At December 31, 1994, cumulative outside costs incurred of \$544,296 and advance registration fees recorded of \$1,245,833 have been deferred and are reflected on the balance sheet of the Convention Fund on Exhibit B. Salaries, benefits and other internal costs related to General Service Office staff assigned to the Convention have been expensed as a program activity of the General Fund.

The GENERAL FUND—This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies

The corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. Contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Intercompany balances and donations have been eliminated in the combined totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services under a consistent method of allocation. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities



are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on its proportionate square footage; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

Inventories

Inventories held by A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. are recorded at cost under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Fixed Assets

The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund. In accordance with consistent practice, the costs of these expenditures continue to be recorded as an expense of the General Fund, but are then capitalized and depreciated through changes in net assets in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are considered to be immaterial and are charged to expense in the year of purchase.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 1994 and the accumulated reserves for depreciation at that date:

	<u>Life</u>	<u>Cost</u>	<u>Current Year</u>	<u>Reserve</u>
Leasehold improvements	Terms of Leases			
475 Riverside Drive		\$1,625,457	\$ 171,101	\$ 470,527
Furniture	8 Years	689,598	86,200	273,036
Computer—hardware	5 Years	638,965	252	638,965
—software	5 Years	271,671	29,458	271,671
		<u>3,225,691</u>	<u>287,011</u>	<u>1,654,199</u>

All depreciation is provided on the straight line basis.

Investments

Investments held by the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board of A.A. are carried at cost. No recognition is made in the accounts for any changes in aggregate market value above or below cost because all of the investments are U.S. Treasury Notes with short or medium terms that are normally held to maturity.

Note 3 Retirement Plan

The trustees of the General Service Board adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible employees of A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. The plan has been amended from time to time to improve benefits and to comply with current statutory requirements.

The report of the plan's actuaries stated that as of January 1, 1994, the most recent valuation date to these financial statements for which information is available, the present value of accrued benefits under the plan was \$4,289,193, of which \$4,042,535 was vested. The market value of the assets of the

trust fund at the same date was \$7,747,051. The assumed rate of return used in determining the actuarial value of vested plan benefits was 7.5%.

Pension expense has been consistently reported as the contribution made to actuarially fund plan benefits. That method of accounting was in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles that had been in effect since the issuance of Accounting Principles Board Statement No. 8 in 1966.

Effective as of 1987, however, Financial Accounting Standards Board (FASB) Statement No. 87 introduced a new concept of "net periodic pension cost," in which pension cost would be accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon actuarial factors which would not necessarily be the same as those presently used in calculating the annual funding requirement. In addition, FASB No. 87 would require, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the organization's balance sheet depending upon whether the plan was considered to be over- or under-funded. It is clear from the above actuarial data that there is no unfounded liability in the A.A. Retirement Plan. Management still believes the annual funding requirement is a more relevant measure of pension expense, and that the cost of additional actuarial calculations is not warranted. The actuaries have stated that the difference would not be a material amount.

Pension expense for 1994 and 1993 was \$293,079 and \$324,649, respectively.

In addition to providing pension benefits, the corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they reach normal retirement age while working for the corporations. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the corporations, 25% of the cost of which is reimbursed by the retirees.

The cost of providing health care benefits to retirees is recorded as the insurance premiums are expensed, and were \$66,600 and \$60,200 for 1994 and 1993, respectively.

Note 4 Lease Commitments

At December 31, 1994, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$347,275 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective July 1, 1991 through September 30, 2001.

\$132,994 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective September 1, 1991 through September 30, 2001.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 1994 is \$3,242,000.

The rental expenses for the years ended December 31, 1994 and 1993, were as follows:

	<u>1994</u>	<u>1993</u>
Total Rent Expense	<u>\$592,100</u>	<u>\$567,700</u>
Allocated to:		
A.A. World Services	\$150,900	\$145,600
General Service Board	352,400	336,900
A.A. Grapevine	<u>88,800</u>	<u>85,200</u>
	<u>\$592,100</u>	<u>\$567,700</u>

Note 5 Tax Status

The organizations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c) (3) of the Internal Revenue Code. They are also exempt from the New York State Franchise Tax.

Budget Highlights

1995 G.S.O. Budget

Income: The 1995 sales budget of \$9,335,800 is approximately \$300,000 less than 1994's actual, and \$500,000 greater than the 1994 budget. The 1995 budget reflects increased volume, as exhibited by the favorable 1994 trends, as well as increased distribution of pamphlets and miscellaneous items following the price reductions put in place last October.

Discounts allowed are budgeted at slightly less than one million dollars, approximately \$600,000 more than budgeted for 1994. As a result, net sales are anticipated approximately \$100,000 less than budgeted and \$700,000 less than actual 1994.

Manufacturing, shipping and warehousing are anticipated to be higher due to rising costs, as well as increased units, and Royalties are budgeted somewhat lower.

Gross margin is budgeted \$400,000 less than the 1994 budget and approximately \$900,000 less than 1994 actual results.

Contributions are expected to be approximately the same as 1994 with a minor increase budgeted.

Total Revenue (literature sales less manufacturing, royalties, shipping and warehousing, as well as contributions) is budgeted at \$7,292,500, approximately \$963,000 (11.7 %) less than 1994's actual results.

Total Operating Expenses for 1995 have been budgeted at \$8,023,100, just under 5 % above 1994.

An operating loss of \$730,500 is budgeted prior to a drawdown from the Reserve Fund, which would result in a net for the period of zero. This drawdown allows for an orderly, prudent use of the Reserve Fund earnings, and possibly a portion of principle, at a time when the Reserve Fund is at its upper limit.

During the preparation of the 1995 budget, which lasted approximately eight or nine months, many, many hours of discussion took place in various circles, from the office, to board committees, to boards, to trustees committees, concerning the pricing of literature. Considerable time was spent discussing the favorable effect the current level of the Reserve Fund has on the ability to reduce literature prices.

1995 Grapevine Budget

Net loss of \$109,700 is about \$27,500 higher than the 1994 loss, an increase of 33.6 %.

Gross profit on the magazine, \$847,900, is 57.3 % of revenue, compared to \$845,200, or 58.4 % of revenue in 1994. Paper price increased 40 % and postage increased 20 %.

Gross profit on other publishing income, \$292,000, is 58.2 % as compared to \$288,600, or 57.5 % in 1994.

Total costs and expenses of \$1,329,900 is an increase of \$37,900, or 2.9 % over the 1994 actual.

A price increase for the magazine was considered as costs surged higher. The current subscription prices were held for 1995. Staff levels and salaries, as well as other costs, will be closely monitored and controlled where possible.

The General Service Office 1995 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	1994 Actual	1995 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$ 9,635,074	\$ 9,335,814
Discounts allowed	547,011	986,915
<u>Net Sales</u>	<u>9,088,063</u>	<u>8,348,899</u>
Cost of Literature Distributed		
Manufacturing	2,974,247	3,174,363
Royalties	885,108	818,650
<u>Gross Margin</u>	<u>5,288,708</u>	<u>4,355,886</u>
DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	833,402	954,830
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	<u>4,395,306</u>	<u>3,401,056</u>
Contributions Received	3,855,445	3,890,000
Interest Income	8,590	1,500
<u>Total Revenue</u>	<u>8,259,341</u>	<u>7,292,556</u>
 OPERATING EXPENSES		
Salaries	3,663,438	3,792,000
Insurance	602,080	680,700
Payroll taxes	286,235	292,000
Retirement expense	253,108	270,400
Other program printing	328,466	375,000
Mailing, labor, etc.	110,396	114,700
Packing supplies	253	310
Postage & express	252,715	278,000
Writers' fees	41,696	37,000
Other literature assistance	134,593	140,560
Selling expenses	55,729	62,500
Professional fees	163,253	131,500
Contracted services	75,342	105,050
Occupancy	534,764	551,650
Telephone	107,964	110,000
Furniture & equipment maintenance	52,767	52,800
Furniture & equipment	90,018	74,000
Stationery & office supplies	145,876	166,800
Office service & expense	161,942	163,000
Travel, meals, & accommodations	572,092	605,150
Bad debts	19,712	20,000
<u>TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES</u>	<u>7,652,439</u>	<u>8,023,120</u>
Operating Income (Loss) for period	606,902	(730,564)
Interest drawdown from Reserve Fund	0	730,564
Net Income for period	<u>606,902</u>	<u>-0-</u>

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

1995 BUDGET

	<u>1994 Actual</u>	<u>1995 Budget</u>
PAID CIRCULATION—AVERAGE	<u>120,900</u>	<u>123,000</u>
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE		
Subscription income	\$1,427,524	\$1,476,000
Single copies and back issues	19,144	5,000
<u>Total magazine income</u>	1,446,668	1,481,000
<u>Total direct costs</u>	601,504	633,060
GROSS PROFIT ON MAGAZINE	845,164	847,940
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	501,904	501,770
<u>Total direct costs</u>	213,287	209,795
GROSS PROFIT ON SPECIAL ITEMS	288,617	291,975
<u>TOTAL GROSS PROFIT</u>	1,133,781	1,139,915
COSTS AND EXPENSES		
EDITORIAL COSTS		
Salaries, including temporary help	182,734	185,700
Payroll taxes and benefits	44,122	49,925
Occupancy costs	54,374	58,050
Office supplies and expenses	15,026	16,350
Product development	22,218	52,000
<u>Total Editorial</u>	318,474	362,025
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	492,452	461,620
Payroll taxes and benefits	154,304	151,340
Occupancy costs	54,091	58,050
Office expense	23,810	25,970
Subscriber services	4,261	9,500
Selling expense—regular	85,501	93,500
—GvR program	29,818	32,700
Postage	16,647	17,435
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>	860,884	850,115
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Consultant fees	18,996	4,000
Insurance	4,977	5,975
Professional fees	19,080	19,045
Meetings and conferences	35,950	49,900
Furniture and equipment	3,610	4,035
Canadian exchange and other	29,532	34,750
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>	112,145	117,705
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	1,291,503	1,329,845
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS	(157,722)	(189,930)
Add: Interest earned	76,093	80,250
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	<u>(81,629)</u>	<u>(109,680)</u>

() denotes red figures

1994 Contributions From Groups — by Delegate Area

(in U.S. dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA	AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
1	Ala./N.W. Fla	410	209	50.9%	28,707.00	7,863	\$3.65	59	Pennsylvania						
2	Alaska	238	100	41.9	11,276.00	3,667	3.07	60	East	1,387	748	53.9	101,677.00	33,135	3.07
3	Arizona	804	362	44.9	62,085.00	15,653	3.97	61	West	719	357	49.6	38,609.00	10,605	3.64
4	Arkansas	230	131	56.9	12,905.00	3,661	3.52	62	Rhode Island	229	102	44.4	10,895.00	5,312	2.05
5	California							63	South Carolina	283	184	65.0	26,230.00	5,945	4.41
6	Southern	1,882	734	38.9	105,394.00	61,315	1.72	64	South Dakota	152	58	38.1	5,535.00	3,477	1.59
7	N. Coastal	1,935	1,067	55.0	172,516.00	61,107	2.82	65	Tennessee	471	225	47.8	37,390.00	9,537	3.92
8	N. Interior	640	308	48.1	38,397.00	18,201	2.11	66	Texas						
9	San Diego/Imp.	824	384	46.6	56,355.00	25,684	2.19	67	Northeast	414	205	49.4	46,412.00	15,483	3.00
10	Mid-South	1,755	751	42.7	82,511.00	54,124	1.52	68	Northwest	223	106	47.5	14,396.00	5,831	2.47
11	Colorado	589	326	55.2	44,921.00	15,119	2.97	69	Southwest	533	243	45.6	32,082.00	16,336	1.96
12	Connecticut	1,352	559	41.3	63,037.00	32,055	1.97	70	Southwest	422	192	45.4	34,635.00	9,836	3.52
13	Delaware	185	112	60.4	19,482.00	3,046	6.40	71	Utah	281	188	66.8	24,147.00	4,956	4.87
14	D.C.	440	222	50.5	40,106.00	14,564	2.75	72	Vermont	218	96	43.9	11,778.00	4,309	2.73
15	Florida							73	Virginia	1,110	607	54.6	80,622.00	22,011	3.66
16	North	616	350	56.7	58,439.00	13,829	4.23	74	Washington	1,354	688	50.7	101,719.00	30,505	3.33
17	South/Bahamas/ V.I.	1,449	792	54.7	119,367.00	29,472	4.05	75	West Virginia	294	122	41.4	9,920.00	3,545	2.80
18	Georgia	679	464	68.2	65,350.00	16,947	3.86	76	Wisconsin						
19	Hawaii	253	162	63.9	31,737.00	5,219	6.08	77	N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.	606	287	47.3	23,014.00	9,665	2.38
20	Idaho	187	92	49.2	9,884.00	2,857	3.46	78	South	899	422	46.8	38,929.00	17,413	2.24
21	Illinois							79	Wyoming	111	63	56.8	4,674.00	1,919	2.44
22	Chicago	1,129	347	30.7	43,924.00	26,283	1.67	80	Puerto Rico	121	69	57.0	5,097.00	1,579	3.23
23	North	971	358	36.9	34,431.00	20,624	1.67	81	Alberta/N.W.T.	578	234	40.5	29,648.00	7,750	3.83
24	South	439	206	46.8	26,429.00	7,348	3.60	82	B.C./Yukon	718	394	54.8	56,152.00	13,254	4.24
25	Indiana							83	Manitoba	148	66	44.5	5,275.00	4,111	1.28
26	North	655	291	44.4	30,884.00	10,558	2.93	84	N.B./P.E.I.	215	102	47.3	8,054.00	3,526	2.28
27	South	520	279	53.6	29,432.00	10,337	2.85	85	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	264	110	41.6	9,439.00	3,630	2.60
28	Iowa	631	324	51.3	35,320.00	12,620	2.80	86	Ontario						
29	Kansas	369	194	52.6	22,453.00	9,501	2.36	87	East	590	291	49.2	43,294.00	14,295	3.02
30	Kentucky	621	347	55.9	56,232.00	10,805	5.20	88	Northwest	169	60	35.5	8,334.00	2,281	3.65
31	Louisiana	531	219	41.1	29,050.00	10,550	2.75	89	Northwest	87	78	89.7	7,209.00	1,418	5.08
32	Maine	461	171	37.0	15,250.00	7,860	1.94	90	West	501	185	36.9	29,928.00	9,939	3.01
33	Maryland	867	394	45.3	53,633.00	13,542	3.96	91	Quebec ¹						
34	Massachusetts							92	Southwest	578	308	53.3	30,284.00	14,970	2.02
35	East	1,525	572	37.5	75,623.00	52,017	1.45	93	Southeast	229	138	60.2	9,437.00	3,288	2.87
36	West	237	125	52.6	14,831.00	5,273	2.81	94	Northeast	366	359	98.0	19,807.00	6,913	2.87
37	Michigan							95	Northwest	394	237	60.2	35,910.00	7,880	4.55
38	Central	543	217	40.0	32,998.00	12,331	2.68	96	Saskatchewan	325	164	50.5	15,791.00	4,205	3.76
39	Southeast	624	282	45.1	54,360.00	16,311	3.33	97	Total U.S./ Canada	54,576	25,728	47.1	\$3,409,190.00	1,223,017	2.79
40	West	432	213	49.3	31,807.00	9,443	3.37	98	Individual, in memoriam, & special meetings				174,334.00		
41	Minnesota							99	Specials				240,185.00		
42	North	536	252	46.9	19,168.00	8,275	2.32	100	Total for U.S. & Canada				3,823,709.00		
43	South	960	418	43.5	46,238.00	21,168	2.18								
44	Mississippi	238	124	52.1	13,179.00	3,836	3.44								
45	Missouri														
46	East	559	275	49.2	38,310.00	8,921	4.29								
47	West	192	106	55.2	13,075.00	5,934	2.20								
48	Montana	293	138	47.1	15,202.00	4,456	3.41								
49	Nebraska	690	370	53.5	50,084.00	14,986	3.34								
50	Nevada	360	165	45.8	15,171.00	8,078	1.88								
51	New Hampshire	522	214	41.0	21,775.00	8,503	2.56								
52	New Jersey														
53	North	1,254	458	36.4	62,090.00	30,735	2.02								
54	South	460	259	56.2	38,866.00	8,464	4.59								
55	New Mexico	339	152	44.7	18,809.00	5,617	3.35								
56	New York														
57	Central	694	295	42.4	43,745.00	10,992	3.98								
58	H.M./B.	756	276	36.4	25,695.00	11,324	2.27								
59	Southeast	1,776	798	44.8	158,844.00	54,469	2.92								
60	West	302	107	35.3	9,096.00	5,140	1.77								
61	North Carolina	812	474	58.3	75,373.00	12,756	5.91								
62	North Dakota	168	80	47.5	6,475.00	3,324	1.95								
63	Ohio														
64	Cent. & S.E.	593	168	28.2	16,076.00	8,456	1.90								
65	Northeast	1,171	302	25.7	37,554.00	23,970	1.57								
66	N.W. Ohio/ S.E. Mich.	271	125	46.0	13,500.00	3,799	3.55								
67	S.W. Ohio	529	223	42.2	31,150.00	10,770	2.89								
68	Oklahoma	376	237	63.0	30,729.00	6,403	4.80								
69	Oregon	713	360	50.4	43,537.00	13,996	3.11								

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1994-1993

(in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. & Canada						
1994	54,576	25,728	47.1%	\$3,409,190.00 ²	1,223,017	\$2.79
U.S. & Canada						
1993	55,828	26,620	47.7%	\$3,359,470.00 ²	1,231,271	\$2.73
Increase (Decrease)	(1,252)	(892)	-0.5%	\$49,720.00	(8,254)	\$0.06

¹ Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists of percentages submitted by areas).

² Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as special, individual, in-memoriam, and special meetings.

1995 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Jeannot Bouchard
Bill Clark
²Karl Lamberg
Doreen Mathison
¹Charles Matthews
George O'Neil
Rodney Rabren
Martha Wright

Secretary: Valerie O'Neill

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Jack Connors
Diana Habbe
Aime Imbeault
Doug Mead
Will Ruliffson
¹Wil Scarborough
Jim Tims
²Mike Ward

Secretary: Joanie Moncrief

Correctional Facilities

Jesse Leming
¹Mary Ellen O'Brien
Alex Palmer
Eva Sanchez
William Schmertz
Ed Wolf
²Charles Williams
Jim Wilson

Secretary: Richard Bush

Finance

Norm Ames
¹Linda Bluth
Linda Fredricks
JoAnne Frey
John Goldberg
Ray Massey
²Don Popejoy
Valerie Wethered

Secretary: Donald Meurer

Grapevine

¹Sandy Champ
Jeanne Ertmann
Matt Hartman
Jim Madger
Clifford Riggins
Pearl Runyon
²Randy Sellers
Doug Thompson
Dawson Young

Secretary: Ames Sweet

International Conventions/ Regional Forums

Mary Ann Boggess
Jeannot Bouchard
Tom Finn
Joe Quinlan
Roger Smith
Mark Sullivan
David Wilson
Martha Wright

Co-secretaries: Eileen Gatz
Sarah Price

Literature

Charles Bartell
Georges Bellefeuille
²Linda Bridge
Phyllis McCoy
Marvin Rumery
Ann Santen
Paul Sherman
¹David Wilson

Secretary: Susan Ulseth

Policy/Admissions

William Anderson
¹Larry Cagnina
Dan Eberlein
Billie Hobart
²Fernand Lachaine
Ernie Mills
Ike Treadwell
Karen Williams

Secretary: Pat Rosenstiel

Public Information

²Judy Allard
Julio Colón
Sandra Kelly
Jeanne Mattis
Charles Nalepa
Dorothy Neurohr
Joe Quinlan
Sonny Sampson
¹Manuel Ysais

Secretary: Helen Turnquest

Report and Charter

²Bruce Bates
Mary Bridges
¹Betty Mac James
Robert Reynolds
Jack Sanderson
Bob Simmons
Roger Smith
Inez Yoakum

Secretary: Sarah Price

Treatment Facilities

¹Mary Ann Boggess
Kevin Ernst
Tom Finn
Clark Fisher
Don Johnson
Pam Reising
Rikki Schock
Anton Taschner

Secretary: Phyllis Masback

Trustees

Sandy Clunies
Shawn D'Luhy
Kevin Doyle
Robert Hickey
Raymond Mitchell
Jim Redemske
²Marco Roman
¹Mark Sullivan
Russ VanDran

Secretary: Lois Fisher

1996 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS³

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Rodney Rabren, SE Texas	George O'Neil, NE Ohio
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Diana Habbe, S. Florida/Bahamas/V.I.	Jim Tims, NE Texas
Correctional Facilities	Eva Sanchez, So. California	Alex Palmer, British Columbia/Yukon
Finance	JoAnne Frey, Eastern Massachusetts	Norm Ames, NW Ontario
Grapevine	Butch Riggins, No. Indiana	Jim Madger, California, Northern Coastal
Literature	Paul Sherman, SE New York	Charles Bartell, Louisiana
Policy/Admissions	Ernie Mills, Washington	Dan Eberlein, No. Florida
Public Information	Charles Nalepa, Hawaii	Sandra Kelly, Central Michigan
Report and Charter	Robert Reynolds, North Carolina	Robert Simmons, No. New Jersey
Treatment Facilities	Tony Taschner, Connecticut	Pam Reising, SE Michigan
Committee on Trustees	Kevin Doyle, Nevada	Ray Mitchell, E. Ontario

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³The 1995 Committee chairs rotated at the end of the 45th General Service Conference.

1995 Trustees' Committees

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John King, *chairperson*
William Bungay
Jacques Filteau
Jacob Ham
Tom Maguire
David O'Leary
Gerry Ouellette
Francine Ward
Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

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Chuck Crist
Jacques Filteau
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John King
Michael McPherson
Julian Rhinehart
Donald Weaver
Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community

John Hartley Smith, M.D.,
chairperson
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Jacques Filteau
*Anne Geller, M.D.
Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
Fran Polek
Julian Rhinehart
*Ray Stiver
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Correctional Facilities

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*Roy Drake, S.J.
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David O'Leary
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Peter Roach
Richard Roughton
*Warren Stafford
*Martha Watson
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Chuck Crist
Jacob Ham
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senior advisor
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Larry Nelson
Fran Polek
Peter Roach
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
John Grant, *secretary*

International Conventions/ Regional Forums

Les Leuthaeuser, *chairperson*
Gerry Flegel
Gay Garner
Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
*Tom Maguire
Larry Nelson
David O'Leary
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Eileen Gatz, *secretary*
—*International Convention*
Sarah Price, *secretary*
—*Regional Forums*

Literature

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Gay Garner
Gary Glynn
Michael McPherson
Julian Rhinehart
Richard Roughton
Francine Ward
Donald Weaver
Vincina McCarthy, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Susan Ulseth, *secretary*

Nominating

Jacob Ham, *chairperson*
Ann Bruning
Gerry Flegel
Gary Glynn
Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
John King
Larry Nelson
Jane Murphy Schulberg
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

Public Information

Gerry Flegel, *chairperson*
Peter Brock
Ann Bruning
*Sarah Holland
*Tom Maguire
Gerry Ouellette
Peter Roach
Jane Murphy Schulberg
*Ben Shapiro
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Helen Turnquest, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.,
chairperson
Peter Brock
John N. Chappel, M.D.
Gay Garner
*Joyce King
Les Leuthaeuser
*Terry Lindgren
Peter Roach
Richard Roughton
Phyllis Masback, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Larry Nelson, *chairperson*
Pat Rosentiel, *secretary*

All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."



Officers of the General Service Board

Chairperson
Jim Estelle
First vice-chairperson
John H. Smith, M.D.
Second vice-chairperson
John King
Secretary
Ann Bruning
Treasurer
Gary Glynn
Assistant secretary
Pat Rosenstiel
Assistant treasurer
Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers
is given on page 37

*Denotes appointed committee members
Jim Estelle and George Dorsey are ex officio members of all committees.

1995 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr. (3681 Mesa Verde Dr., El Dorado Hills, CA 95762) was elected chairman of the board at the meeting following the 1993 Conference. Jim was director of the Texas Department of Corrections for 12 years, and brought his background in correctional administration to the board when he served as a Class A trustee, 1977-1986. Now retired, he is involved in many professional societies on criminal justice and corrections and is on the board of a California service organization that serves the needs of the families of indigent jail and prison inmates.

John N. Chappel, M.D. (School of Medicine, University of Nevada, Reno, NV 89557) was elected to the board in 1989. A graduate of the University of Alberta Medical School, John has been professor of psychiatry, University of Nevada School of Medicine, since 1974. He serves as consultant to many professional organizations and is widely published in the field of alcoholism. John chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, Treatment Facilities, and International Committees.

Gary A. Glynn (1112 Park Ave., New York, NY 10128) was elected to the board in April 1993 after serving as a consultant to the trustees' Finance Committee, A.A.W.S.'s Employee's Retirement Committee and the A.A.W.S. Board. A graduate of the University of Vermont and the Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania, he has been an investment analyst and portfolio manager for over 20 years, and is active in various professional organizations and committees. Gary is treasurer of the General Service Board and chairs the Finance & Budgetary Committee; he also is a member of the trustees' Literature, Nominating and Conference Committees.

Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D. (6631 Hunters Wood Circle, Catonsville, MD 21228) was elected to the board in May 1992. A graduate of Morgan State University, Baltimore, and the University of Maryland, Elaine has a distinguished background in the fields

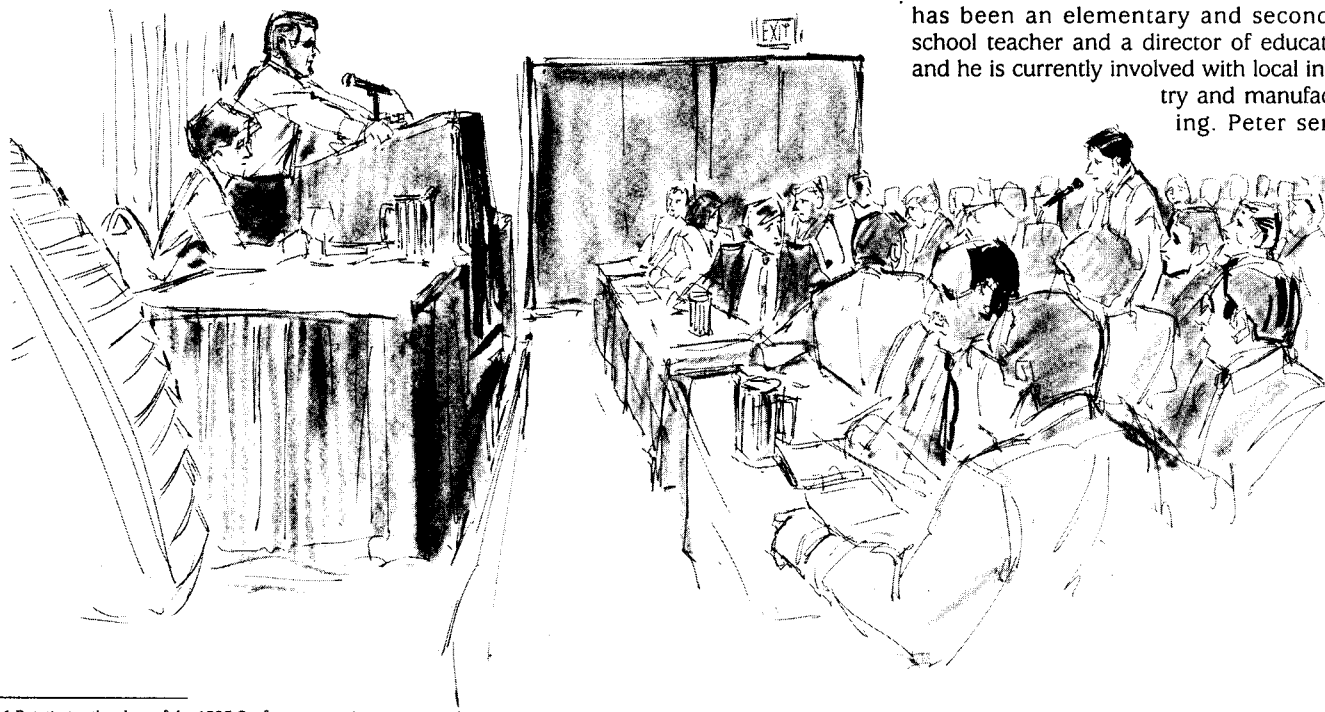
of alcoholism and substance abuse. She has lectured widely, been a consultant to regional and government agencies and published many articles in professional journals. Elaine is director of the Center for Substance Abuse Prevention, which is a component of the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration under the Public Health Services. Elaine chairs the Treatment Facilities Committee and also serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, International Convention and Nominating Committees.

John E. King (423 Hawthorn, Fayetteville, AR 72701) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of St. Mary's College, Kentucky, and Tulane University, Louisiana, John was an ordained priest and has a background in social work. Currently, he is on the faculty of the University of Arkansas in the Social Work Program, where he serves as a consultant to many local, state, and regional agencies as well as in a treatment capacity. John has received numerous awards and honors for his professional and civic/community service. John chairs the Archives Committee and also serves on the Nominating and Conference Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Arthur L. Knight, Jr. (865 Church Rd., Lake Forest, IL 60045) was elected to the board in 1995. Art's professional background is in the field of business, where he has held positions as president, director, and chief executive officer of manufacturing, distribution and financial services companies. He is a graduate of Dartmouth College and holds an M.B.A. from the University of New York, Buffalo. Retired in 1994, Art serves on a variety of professional and civic boards.

Robert Oran Miller, D.D. (Episcopal Diocese of Alabama, 521 N. 20th St., Birmingham, AL 35203) was elected to the board in 1995. Elected ninth Bishop of the Diocese of Alabama, in 1988. Robert has served as deacon and rector in several parishes in Alabama and held positions on various councils of the Episcopal church. He received an honorary Doctorate of Divinity from the University of the South, where he serves on the board of trustees.

Peter Roach (1332 Edmison Dr., Peterborough, ON K9H 6V3, Canada) was elected to the board in 1994. Peter has been an elementary and secondary school teacher and a director of education, and he is currently involved with local industry and manufacturing. Peter serves



1 Rotating at the close of the 1995 Conference meeting.
2 New trustee, elected by the General Service Board, May 1995.

on the Correctional Facilities, International, Public Information and Treatment Facilities Committees.

John Hartley Smith, M.D. (5060 Maple Street, Vancouver, BC V6M 3T1, Canada) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of the Queens' University Medical School, Belfast, he has specialized in occupational medicine and public health and has served on many professional committees and advisory councils, both local and national. John was appointed assistant deputy minister in the British Columbia Ministry of Health in 1979; in 1986 he was appointed senior medical consultant in occupational and environmental health to the government. In 1988 he resigned to do private consulting. He was also a director of the American Board of Preventive Medicine, 1978-87, and is a part-time clinical associate professor in the Faculty of Medicine at the University of British Columbia. John chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee and serves on the International and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

C. Peter Brock (4625 S. 34th St., Arlington, VA 22206) was elected general service trustee in April 1994. Peter has served as an A.A.W.S. director, and has served on the trustees' C.P.C., P.I., Treatment and Literature Committees. With a professional background in the education, financial and health fields, he is currently a director of alcoholism and mental health programs. Peter serves on the Financial and Budgetary, Public Information and Treatment Facilities Committees, and is treasurer of the A.A.W.S. Board.

'Ann Bruning (10728 Hunters Point Rd., Fort Smith, AR 72903), who was a Panel 37 delegate, was elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in April 1991. Ann has also served her area as G.S.R., area chair, and has been active in P.I. work, mostly in schools. A registered nurse, Ann now works at an in-hospital hospice, and serves on the boards of several community organi-

zations, as well as presenting workshops for various organizations. Ann chairs the Conference Committee and serves on the Nominating, International Conventions/Regional Forums and Public Information Committees.

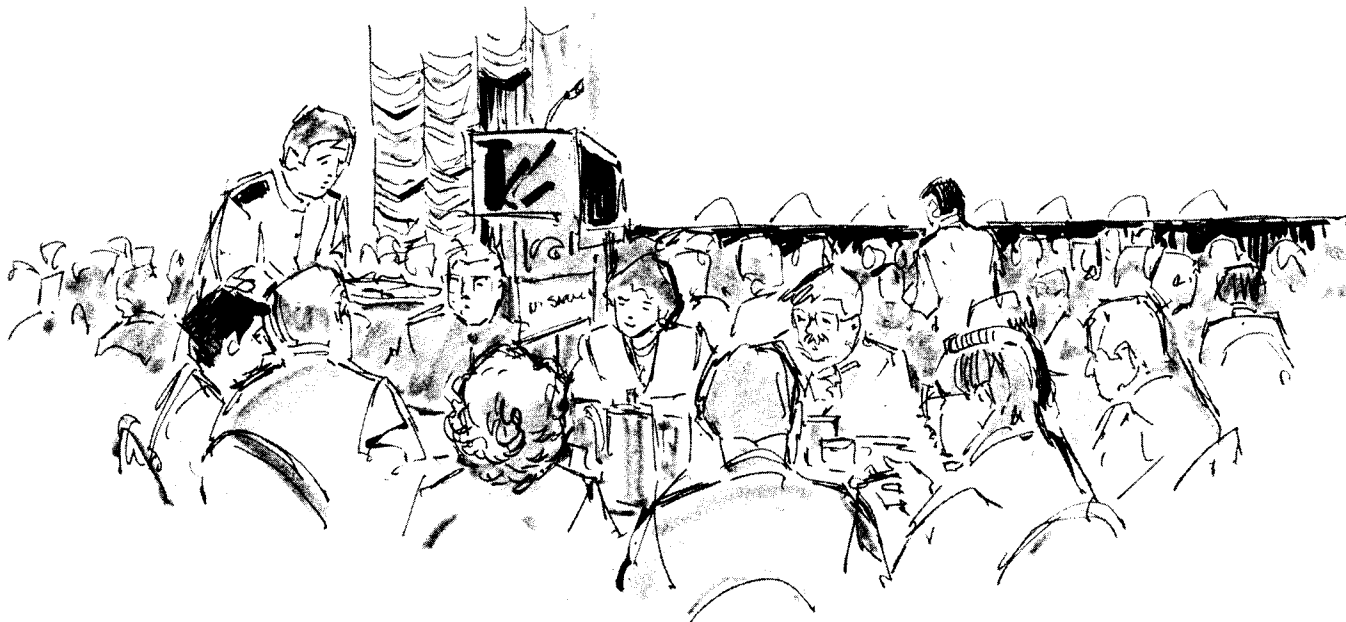
William Bungay (24 Johnson's Ave., Corner Brook, Newfoundland, A2H 1V8, Canada) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1994. Bill, a Panel 39 delegate, has a background in accounting and business. He serves on the Archives, Finance and Budgetary and Literature Committees.

Gerry Flegel (Box 1246, Humboldt, Saskatchewan, S0K 2A0 Canada), elected Western Canada regional trustee in May 1992, is a former Panel 38 delegate. Gerry is enjoying retirement after teaching math, computer science and accounting in Saskatchewan high schools for the past 30 years. He chairs the Public Information Committee, serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Gay Garner (528 Hammet Dr., Decatur, GA 30032) was elected Southeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1993. A former Panel 38 delegate, Gay has also served her area as G.S.R., D.C.M. and area chairperson and has been active in local P.I./C.P.C. activities. Her professional background is in the entertainment business, management and advertising sales. Gay serves on the Literature, Treatment Facilities and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

²Michel Girard (67, Aubert Blvd., Repentigny, Quebec, J6A 4N9, Canada), a Panel 42 delegate, was elected trustee-at-large Canada in May 1995. He has been active in service in his area and served on the boards of French Publications and *La Vigne*. Michel is now retired from a 30-year position with a telecommunications company.

'Jacob B. "Jake" Ham (RFD 1, Box 1400, Winthrop, ME 04364) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1991. Jake began his service work in California as G.S.R., D.C.M., and H&I coordinator. After returning to his home state of Maine in 1980, Jake served in similar service jobs, including Maine area chair, and was a Panel 38 delegate. In his spare time, away from his





job with the U.S. Postal Service, he enjoys carpentry, gardening and camping. Jake is chairman of the Nominating Committee and also serves on the Archives, Finance & Budgetary and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Les Leuthaeuser (1912 Ave. B, Scottsbluff, NE 69361) was elected West Central U.S. regional trustee in May 1992. In service work for over 20 years, Les was a Panel 30 delegate and has served as area chair and area finance committee chair. He is self-employed in the home improvement/repair business. Les chairs the International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee and serves on the Treatment Facilities and Correctional Facilities Committees and the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Michael McPherson (315 W. 86th St., New York, NY 10024) was elected general service trustee in April 1993. Prior to that Michael was an A.A.W.S. director, where he served as chair for the A.A.W.S. Publications Subcommittee and was a member of the trustees' Finance Committee. He is chief administrative officer for a large nonprofit corporation. Michael chairs the A.A.W.S. Board and also serves on the Conference, Finance & Budgetary and Literature Committees.

²**Raul Marin** (234 Addax Dr., San Antonio, Texas) was elected Southwest regional trustee in May 1995. Raul has long been active in the southwest Texas area as G.S.R., D.C.M., area chair and delegate (Panel 30). He has been involved in starting bilingual Spanish groups, conferences and intergroups. Raul is an architect, now semi-retired.

Larry Nelson (192 Elm Ave., Imperial Beach, CA 91932) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 1993. A former Panel 38 delegate, Larry has been active in many service activities in his area. He is a pharmacist on the staff of a large health maintenance organization clinic. Larry serves on the International, Nominating, and International Convention Committees, and chairs the General Sharing Sessions on board weekends.

¹**David O'Leary** (37 Wabush Pl., St. John's, Newfoundland, A1E 5V5, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 1991. A Panel 35 delegate from Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/ Labrador, David has remained active in his area, serving on intergroup, convention and institutions committees. He is a maintenance technician with a large corporation. David chairs the International Committee and also serves on the Archives,

Correctional Facilities, Nominating and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Fran Polek (2301 E. 61st Ave., Spokane, WA 99223) was elected general service trustee in May 1992, after serving four years as a Grapevine director. A Panel 27 delegate, Fran also served as area chair. During his time as a director, he served as a treasurer of the Grapevine Corporate Board and as a member of the trustees' Literature Committee and International Committee. Fran is a university professor, involved in teaching, research, lecturing, and writing. Fran chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community and International Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Julian Rhinehart (1127 Seno Court, Boulder City, NV 89005) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 1994. Julian was a Panel 41 delegate, where he chaired the Conference P.I. Committee. He has long been active in area service. Retiring from the Federal Government in 1994 after a 25-year career in public relations, he now does freelance writing and consulting work. Julian serves on the Literature, Conference, Cooperation With the Professional Community and Correctional Facilities Committees.

²**MaryJane Roy** (430 Moonstone Beach Rd., Wakefield, RI) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in May 1995. MaryJane began her service work in young people's groups, local central offices and at the group level. She was a Panel 42 delegate, and chaired the Conference C.P.C. Committee. MaryJane, a physician's assistant, is clinical director of a vascular lab.

Jane Murphy Schulberg (138 E. 38th St., New York, NY 10016) was elected a general service trustee in April 1993, after serving four years as a director on the Grapevine Corporate Board. Jane, who is a producer/writer with a television media house, has been active at many levels of local A.A. She chairs the Grapevine Corporate Board and also serves on the Finance and Budgetary, Nominating and Public Information Committees.

Donald Weaver (1325 Seemore, Kalamazoo, MI 49001) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 1993. Don currently chairs a prison meeting and has held many service jobs in his area, including Panel 34 delegate. A landscaper, he is also involved with various community activities. Don serves on the Conference and Literature Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

A.A. World Services Directors

Michael McPherson, *chairperson*,
general service trustee
 Peter Brock, *nontrustee director*
 George Dorsey,
G.S.O. general manager
 Jacques Filteau, *nontrustee director*
 Gerry Flegel, *regional trustee*

Gay Garner, *regional trustee*
 Gerard Ouellette, *nontrustee director*
 Pat Rosenstiel,
G.S.O. staff member
 Richard Roughton,
nontrustee director

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Jane Murphy Schulberg, *chairperson*,
general service trustee
 Chuck Crist, *nontrustee director*
 John King, *Class A trustee*
 Les Leuthaeuser, *regional trustee*
 Thomas Maguire, *nontrustee director*

Fran Polek,
general service trustee
 Francine Ward, *nontrustee director*
 Donald Weaver, *regional trustee*
 Ames Sweet,
Grapevine managing editor
 Ann Warner,
Grapevine executive editor

General Service Office Staff

George Dorsey, *general manager*
 Richard Bush
 Lois Fisher
 Eileen Gatzka
 John Grant
 Phyllis Masback
 Joanie Moncrief
 Daniel Mooney

Valerie O'Neill
 Sarah Price
 Pat Rosenstiel
 Helen Turnquest
 Susan Ulseth
 Tom Jasper, *services director*
 Frank Mauser, *archivist*

Grapevine Staff

Ames Sweet, *managing editor*

Ann Warner, *executive editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Caryl Bertolino, *staff assistant*
 Rosa Blanco, *financial secretary*
 Daniel Brown, *typesetter*
 Joseph Dennen, *staff assistant*
 John de Stefano, *editor*
 Yee Eng, *staff assistant*
 Al Herr, *artist*, Conference Report
 Margie Janicek, *receptionist*
 Cynthia Keyworth, *GV editorial asst.*
 John Kirwin Jr., *assistant controller/business administration*
 Steve Linek, *purchasing*
 Vinnie McCarthy, *publications director*
 Phyllis Masback, *G.S.O. staff*
 Lynda Maziarz, *staff assistant*
 Don Meurer, *controller, A.A.W.S.*
 Lilianna Murphy, *data processing manager*
 Paul Murphy, *GV editorial staff asst.*
 Ramona Ortiz, *staff assistant*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *staff assistant*
 Miguel Rodriguez, *copy dept.*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Bob Scherer, *Grapevine controller*
 Frank Segui, *staff assistant*
 Elaine Soroka, *special projects manager*
 Naomi Strassberg, *Grapevine administrative assistant*
 Cynthia White, *staff assistant*
 Andre Washington, *purchasing*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor*, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report

Trustees emeritus

Michael Alexander
 Gordon Patrick

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 44th Conference includes Panel 44 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 45 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	45	Clark Fisher 2104 Gusmus Ave. Muscle Shoals, AL 35661-3010
Alaska	2	44	Larry G. Cagnina 1445 Lacey St. Fairbanks, AK 99701
Arizona	3	44	Linda Bluth 1124 East 12th St. Casa Grande, AZ 85222
Arkansas	4	45	Mary Bridges 137 Valley Dr. Camden, AR 71701
California Southern	5	45	Eva Sanchez 2119 De La Vina, No. H Santa Barbara, CA 93105
Northern Coastal	6	45	James (Jim) Madger 4368 Ridgecrest Pl. Eureka, CA 95503
Northern Interior	7	44	Inez Yoakum 5626 Palm Ave. Sacramento, CA 95841
San Diego/Imperial	8	44	Marco Antonio Roman 5555 Las Alturas Terrace San Diego, CA 92114
Mid-Southern	9	44	Manuel Ysaia 1015-A W. First St. Santa Ana, CA 92703
Colorado	10	45	Linda B. Fredricks 11665 Valle Verde Dr. Colorado Springs, CO 80926
Connecticut	11	45	Anton (Tony) W. Taschner 16 Cindy Lane Berlin, CT 06037
Delaware	12	44	Douglas (Doug) Thompson 39 Duchess Circle Dover, DE 19901
District of Columbia	13	45	Sandy Clunies 6 Briardale Ct. Derwood, MD 20855-2027
Florida North	14	45	Dan Eberlein Box 494 Orange Lake, FL 32681
S. Florida/ Bahamas/V.I.	15	45	Diana R. Habbe 5009 W. Colonial Dr., #3 Tampa, FL 33611
Georgia	16	44	Randy Sellers Rt. 1, Box 346 A 3605 Johnny Minchew Rd. Waycross, GA 31503
Hawaii	17	45	Charles (Charlie) Nalepa Box 190 Kahului, HI 96732
Idaho	18	44	Michael (Mike) Ward 2823 Polaris Caldwell, ID 83605

State	Area no.	Panel		State	Area no.	Panel	
Illinois				Montana	40	44	Mark Sullivan 6336 Highway 93 South Whitefish, MT 59937
<i>Chicago</i>	19	45	John M. Goldberg 1211 North LaSalle Dr., #802 Chicago, IL 60610				
<i>Northern</i>	20	44	Russell (Russ) VanDran 115 Greenwood St., Toulon, IL 61483	Nebraska	41	44	Marvin Rumery 1812 W. Arlington Lincoln, NE 68522
<i>Southern</i>	21	45	Ann Santen 1395 Alice St. Collinsville, IL 62234	Nevada	42	45	Kevin Doyle 449 B North Lamb Blvd. Las Vegas, NV 89110
Indiana				New Hampshire	43	44	Karl Lamberg 32 East Auburn Rd. Hooksett, NH 03106
<i>Northern</i>	22	45	Clifford (Butch) Riggins 700 W. 60th St. Anderson, IN 46013				
<i>Southern</i>	23	44	James (Jim) A. Wilson 115 N. 5th Ave. Beech Grove, IN 46107	New Jersey <i>Northern</i>	44	45	Robert (Bob) Simmons 941 Roosevelt Ave. Union, NJ 07083
Iowa	24	45	James (Jim) Redemske 513 Third St., S.E. Clarion, IA 50525	<i>Southern</i>	45	44	Isaac (Ike) Treadwell 491 W. Hanover St. Trenton, NJ 08618
Kansas	25	44	Don Popejoy 826 N. Durham Ulysses, KS 67880	New Mexico	46	44	Jesse Leming 12813 Granite N.E. Albuquerque, NM 87112
Kentucky	26	44	Charles Williams 407 Bromwell Dr. Louisville, KY 40245-4614	New York <i>Central</i>	47	45	Edward (Ed) Wolf 440 Foster Valley Rd. Owego, NY 13827
Louisiana	27	45	Charles (Charlie) Bartell 3935 Lennox Blvd. New Orleans, LA 70131	<i>Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire</i>	48	44	Jeanne Mattis Box 431 Rome, NY 13442-0431
Maine	28	44	Willard (Will) A. Ruliffson Box 307 Houlton, ME 04730	<i>Southeast</i>	49	45	Paul Sherman 863 Artic St. Lindenhurst, NY 11757
Maryland	29	44	Valerie Wethered 3015 Kenyon Ave. Baltimore, MD 21213	<i>Western</i>	50	44	Shawn D'Luhny Box 1524 Niagara University, NY 14109
Massachusetts				North Carolina	51	45	Robert (Bob) Reynolds 28 Misty Mountain Rd. Franklin, NC 28734
<i>Eastern</i>	30	45	JoAnne Frey 386 Thurston St. Wrentham, MA 02093				
<i>Western</i>	31	44	Linda Bridge 15 Wallop School Rd. Enfield, CT 06082	North Dakota	52	44	Dorothy Neurohr Box 102 Gladstone, ND 58630-0102
Michigan				Ohio			
<i>Central</i>	32	45	Sandra Kelly 208 Cloverland Dr. Lansing, MI 48910	<i>Central Southeast</i>	53	45	William (Bill) Schmertz 136 E. Weisheimer Rd. Columbus, OH 43214
<i>Southeast</i>	33	45	Pamela (Pam) Reising 29646 Pleasant Trail Southfield, MI 48076	<i>Northeast</i>	54	45	George O'Neil 331 Granview Hubbard, OH 44425
<i>Western</i>	34	44	Pearl Runyon 523 Howard S.E. Grand Rapids, MI 49507	<i>NW Ohio/SE Mich.</i>	55	44	Roger Smith 5937 Sylvan Green Sylvania, OH 43560
Minnesota				<i>Southwest</i>	56	44	Jack Connors 991 Corliss Ave., Hamilton, OH 45011-4443
<i>Northern</i>	35	44	Bruce Bates 4505 Robinson St. Duluth, MN 55804	Oklahoma	57	45	Phyllis D. McCoy 6910 S. 32nd West Ave. Tulsa, OK 74132
<i>Southern</i>	36	45	Douglas (Doug) Mead 212 W. Woodley Northfield, MN 55057	Oregon	58	44	Donald (Don) Johnson 247282 E. Highway 26 Prineville, OR 97754
Mississippi	37	44	Joyce (Billie) Hobart 529 McAllister St., Apt. 40 Greenville, MS 38701				
Missouri				Pennsylvania			
<i>Eastern</i>	38	45	Jeanne Ertmann 65 Midland Dr. Wright City, MO 63390	<i>Eastern</i>	59	45	Joseph (Joe) Quinlan Rear 519 Birch St. Scranton, PA 18505
<i>Western</i>	39	45	Karen Williams 817 West Seminole Springfield, MO 65807	<i>Western</i>	60	45	Matt Hartman 714 Western Ave. Beaver, PA 15009

State	Area no.	Panel	
Rhode Island	61	44	Betty (Mac) James 25 Linden Rd. Narragansett, RI 02882
South Carolina	62	44	Wil Scarborough 2335 Herndon Dr. Charleston, SC 29414
South Dakota	63	44	Kevin Ernst 2616 Bobbi Dr. Aberdeen, SD 57401
Tennessee	64	44	Charles E. Matthews 2323 Paddock Court Murfreesboro, TN 37130
Texas			
 Northeast	65	45	James (Jim) Tims Rt. 1, Box 226 Whitesboro, TX 76273
 Northwest	66	44	Mary Ann Boggess 3200 Fleetwood Dr., #A9 Amarillo, TX 79109
 Southeast	67	45	Rodney Rabren 224 First St. Brazoria, TX 77422
 Southwest	68	44	Sandy Champ Box 546 Little River, TX 76554
Utah	69	45	Thomas (Tom) Finn 1218 E. 2550 N. North Ogden, UT 84414
Vermont	70	44	Mary Ellen O'Brien 16 Giorgetti Blvd. Rutland, VT 05701
Virginia	71	45	Robert (Bob) Hickey 209 Ridgewell Circle Norfolk, VA 23503
Washington	72	45	Ernie Mills 15822 Eighth Ave. N.E. Seattle, WA 98155
West Virginia	73	45	Martha (Marty) Wright 817 Main St. Belpre, OH 45714
Wisconsin			
 No. WI/ Up Penn. MI	74	44	Doreen Mathison 725A Hazel St. Oshkosh, WI 54901
 Southern	75	45	William (Bill) Anderson 8569 N. Granville Rd., #213 Milwaukee, WI 53224-2322
Wyoming	76	44	William (Bill) Clark 1100 Georgia Way Green River, WY 82935
Puerto Rico	77	44	Julio Colón Box 1036 Morovis, PR 00687

CANADA

Province	Area no.	Panel	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	44	Raymond (Ray) Massey 28 Whiteram Close N.E. Calgary, AB T1Y 5X8
B.C./Yukon	79	45	Alexander (Alex) Palmer 33439 Huggins Ave. Abbotsford, BC V2S 2R8
Manitoba	80	44	David Wilson 50 Barnstaple Cove Winnipeg, MB R3R 2W3
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	44	*Rikki Schock R.R. #3, Belle River P.O. Belle River, PEI C0A 1B0
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Lab.	82	45	**Charles (Sonny) Sampson Gen. Delivery Boylston Guysborough, NS B0H 1G0
Ontario			
 Eastern	83	45	Raymond (Ray) Mitchell 78 Brookdale Ave. Toronto, ON M5M 1P3
 Northeast	84	45	Jack Sanderson 306-94 Allard St. Sault Ste. Marie, ON P6B 5E9
 Northwest	85	45	Norman (Norm) Ames P.O. Box 134 Dryden, ON P8N 2Y7
 Western	86	44	Judy Allard 128 Victoria St. Sarnia, ON N7T 2T1
Quebec			
 Southwest	87	44	George Bellefeuille 7375 Roi Rene Anjou, PQ H1K 3G7
 Southeast	88	45	Aime Imbeault 208, de la Montagne Notre-Dame du Portage PQ G0L 1Y0
 Northeast	89	45	Jeannot Bouchard 6779 boul. Des Gradins Quebec, PQ G2J 1B1
 Northwest	90	44	Fernand Lachaine 160, Rue Cloutier, App. 303 Rosemere, PQ J7A 5Y5
Saskatchewan	91	44	Dawson A. Young 25-189 Lockwood Rd. Regina, SK S4S 3G6

* Alternate delegate was seated.
Raymond Steeves, delegate, was unable to attend due to illness.

** Alternate delegate was seated.
Bert Gills, delegate, was unable to attend due to illness.